

CLAT Express - April 2026: Practice Quizzes

MCQ: +1 for a correct answer, -0.25 for a wrong answer. TITA (type-in-the-answer): +1, no negative marking.

Multiple-choice passages

VP Visit: Ties and Schemes

Vice President C. P. Radhakrishnan made the first-ever bilateral visit to Sri Lanka and held talks with President Anura Kumara Dissanayake in Colombo. The visit highlighted several areas where India and Sri Lanka work together. India has been Sri Lanka's largest trade partner and largest source of tourists, and the two countries signed a free trade agreement in 2000. Cooperation also extends to development projects, including the construction of a solar power plant at Sampur in Sri Lanka. Defence ties are expressed through joint exercises between the armed forces, such as SLINEX, MITRA SHAKTI and MILAN. The visit also brought the Overseas Citizen of India scheme into focus. During this period Sri Lanka joined the International Big Cat Alliance. The two neighbours are separated by the Palk Strait, and the uninhabited island of Katchatheevu lies in that strait. Regional forums such as BIMSTEC and SAARC also feature in the India-Sri Lanka relationship. Sri Lanka's President is Anura Kumara Dissanayake, while its Prime Minister is Harini Amarasuriya. Together, trade, development, defence, diaspora and regional cooperation form the main dimensions of the bilateral relationship discussed during the visit.

Q1.

In which year was the Overseas Citizen of India (OCI) scheme introduced?

- (A) 1955
- (B) 1974
- (C) 2015
- (D) 2005

Q2.

Which two schemes were merged in 2015?

- (A) OCI and the Citizenship Act
- (B) OCI and the Indian Housing Project
- (C) NRI and PIO schemes
- (D) PIO and OCI schemes

Q3.

Match List I with List II:

List I	List II
I. SLINEX	A. Multi-lateral naval exercise
II. MITRA SHAKTI	B. Regional energy and industrial hub
III. MILAN	C. Army joint exercise
IV. Trincomalee	D. Naval exercise

Rows are two lists side by side, not matched pairs; work out the correct pairing.

- (A) I-A, II-D, III-C, IV-B
- (B) I-D, II-C, III-A, IV-B
- (C) I-A, II-B, III-C, IV-D
- (D) I-C, II-D, III-B, IV-A

Q4.

Consider the following statements about Katchatheevu Island:

- I. The island is an uninhabited island located in the Palk Strait.
- II. The Indo-Sri Lankan Maritime Agreement of 1974 was signed under Rajiv Gandhi as Prime Minister.
- III. The Additional Agreement of 1976 prevented both countries from fishing in each other's Exclusive Economic Zones.

Which of the above statements is/are correct?

- (A) I only
- (B) II and III only
- (C) I and II only
- (D) I and III only

Q5.

Consider the following statements about Overseas Citizen of India (OCI) status:

- I. Minor children of eligible persons are also eligible for OCI.
- II. Persons who had ever been citizens of Pakistan or Bangladesh are not eligible for OCI.
- III. OCI holders can acquire agricultural or plantation properties in India.
- IV. OCI holders are exempted from police reporting for any length of stay.

How many of the above statements are correct?

- (A) Only one
- (B) Only two
- (C) Only three
- (D) All of the above

Q6.

Under which Indian Prime Minister did India agree to cede Katchatheevu Island to Sri Lanka?

- (A) Rajiv Gandhi
- (B) Jawaharlal Nehru
- (C) Lal Bahadur Shastri
- (D) Indira Gandhi

Q7.

Which city houses the Legislature of Sri Lanka?

- (A) Colombo
- (B) Kandy
- (C) Jaffna
- (D) Sri Jayawardenepura Kotte

Bill and Lok Sabha expansion: practice MCQs

In April 2026, the government proposed the Constitution (131st Amendment) Bill, 2026 along with a Delimitation Bill, 2026. Delimitation is the process of redrawing constituency boundaries so that each constituency has a roughly equal population and representation keeps pace with population change. For the Lok Sabha, the proposal is to change the number of seats and to decide which census should serve as the population base for allocating them. Because population growth has been uneven across regions, a fresh allocation could shift the share of seats held by different states. States that grew faster could gain seats, while states with slower population growth could see their share fall. The Bill is also linked to women's reservation, which an earlier law set out but tied to the completion of a census and a delimitation exercise. Supporters say the Bill would bring the House closer to a fair and representative structure. Critics argue that the choice of population data and the discretion given to Parliament could weaken federal balance and invite political influence over boundary-making. The debate therefore centres on how the House should grow, which data should count, and who should control the process.

Q1.

To how many seats does the Constitution (131st Amendment) Bill, 2026 propose to expand the Lok Sabha?

- (A) 850
- (B) 800
- (C) 750
- (D) 650

Q2.

Of the proposed Lok Sabha seats, how many are allocated to Union Territories?

- (A) 50
- (B) 25
- (C) 15
- (D) 35

Q3.

Which Census does the Bill propose to use for seat allocation and delimitation?

- (A) 1971 Census
- (B) 1981 Census
- (C) 2001 Census
- (D) 2011 Census

Q4.

Assertion (A): The Bill proposes to amend Article 82 to lift the freeze on redrawing constituency boundaries.

Reason (R): Article 82 mandates Parliament to pass a Delimitation Act after every Census.

- (A) Both A and R are true and R is the correct explanation of A
- (B) Both A and R are true but R is not the correct explanation of A
- (C) A is true but R is false
- (D) A is false but R is true

Q5.

Match List I with List II:

List I	List II
I. Proposed Lok Sabha seats	A. 15
II. Current SC reserved Lok Sabha seats	B. 850
III. Current ST reserved Lok Sabha seats	C. 84
IV. Validity of women's reservation (years)	D. 47

Rows are two lists side by side, not matched pairs; work out the correct pairing.

- (A) I-B, II-C, III-D, IV-A
- (B) I-D, II-C, III-B, IV-A
- (C) I-A, II-D, III-B, IV-C
- (D) I-D, II-B, III-A, IV-C

Q6.

Consider the following statements about women's reservation under the Bill:

- I. The reservation is valid for 15 years and can be extended by Parliament.
- II. Reserved constituencies for women are rotated only once, at the first delimitation.
- III. Within SC/ST reserved seats, one-third are reserved for SC/ST women.

Which of the above statements is/are correct?

- (A) I only
- (B) II and III only
- (C) I and III only
- (D) I, II and III

Q7.

How many of the following statements about the Delimitation Commission under the Delimitation Bill, 2026 are correct?

- I. It is chaired by a Supreme Court Judge.
 - II. It has civil court powers to summon witnesses and access public records.
 - III. Its orders can be challenged in courts.
- (A) Only one
 - (B) Only two
 - (C) Only three
 - (D) None

Q8.

Under Article 75(1A), Ministers are capped at what percentage of Lok Sabha strength?

- (A) 10%
- (B) 25%
- (C) 20%
- (D) 15%

Phase I digital census practice set

India has launched Phase I of Census 2027, which is described as the world's largest population count and the first fully digital enumeration exercise in the country. This first phase is a House Listing and Housing Census, and it is carried out in States and Union Territories that have been notified for the exercise. Digital technology runs through the process, and a self-enumeration option allows citizens to provide their own census details. Population counting has a long history in India. Ancient texts such as the Arthashastra, the Ain-e-Akbari and the Rig Veda mention population counts. The modern census is supported by law. The Census Act, 1948 provides the legal mandate and makes participation mandatory, and the Union has the power to conduct the census under the Constitution. The work is managed by the Registrar General and Census Commissioner of India. Since Independence, India has held several censuses. Unlike sample surveys, the census offers comprehensive population data, which is useful for planning healthcare, education and infrastructure. The data also helps track changes in population over time. The census also supports progress towards the Sustainable Development Goals with robust data on health, education and poverty indicators. Phase I therefore builds on a long record of counting while bringing new digital methods to the process.

Q1.

Which of the following is listed as a key focus area of the data collected in Census 2027 Phase I?

- (A) Migration history of each family
- (B) Caste and religion of every household
- (C) Income levels of all earning members
- (D) Housing conditions, household amenities, assets and infrastructure

Q2.

Assertion (A): Digital mapping tools make the creation of house-listing blocks more accurate.

Reason (R): Web mapping and GIS tools help in accurate house-listing block creation and efficient data collection.

- (A) Both A and R are true and R is the correct explanation of A
- (B) Both A and R are true but R is not the correct explanation of A
- (C) A is true but R is false
- (D) A is false but R is true

Q3.

Match List I with List II:

List I	List II
I. Self-enumeration begins	A. 16 languages
II. Field exercise starts	B. 15 May 2026
III. Field exercise ends	C. 1 April 2026
IV. Self-enumeration languages	D. 16 April 2026

Rows are two lists side by side, not matched pairs; work out the correct pairing.

- (A) I-A, II-B, III-C, IV-D
- (B) I-C, II-A, III-B, IV-D
- (C) I-C, II-D, III-B, IV-A
- (D) I-B, II-C, III-A, IV-D

Q4.

Consider these statements about Census 2027:

- I. Self-enumeration opened on 1 April 2026.
- II. Self-enumeration is available in 22 languages.
- III. Self-enumeration is open to residents currently abroad.

Which of the above statements is/are correct?

- (A) I and II only
- (B) II and III only
- (C) I, II and III
- (D) I only

Q5.

How many of the following statements about Census 2027 are correct?

- I. The field exercise runs from 16 April to 15 May 2026.
- II. The questionnaire contains 40 questions.
- III. Self-enumeration is available in 16 languages.

- (A) Only one
- (B) Only two
- (C) Only three
- (D) None of the above

Q6.

Which limitation on the coverage of Census 2027 is stated in the booklet?

- (A) Only residents currently present in India are covered
- (B) Only households in urban areas are covered
- (C) Only households with Aadhaar cards are covered
- (D) Only households in Assam are covered

Q7.

Through which channel can citizens fill in their own census details under Census 2027?

- (A) Postal forms sent to the Registrar General
- (B) Toll-free telephone interviews
- (C) Door-to-door interviews by teachers
- (D) A secure web portal

Q8.

How many questions does the Census 2027 questionnaire contain?

- (A) 33
- (B) 24
- (C) 28
- (D) 40

Origins and Causes Check

Left Wing Extremism, commonly known as Naxalism, is a movement that seeks social and political change through revolutionary methods. Its followers aim to overthrow the central government through armed revolution, relying on violence and guerrilla warfare. Their long-term goal is to establish a communist state based on Maoist principles. The movement's support has deep roots in the lives of tribal communities. Large numbers of tribal people have been displaced as development projects and mining operations expanded into their homelands. Many tribal families also resent laws that limit their access to forest resources. Poverty and a lack of sustainable means of earning a living push many people towards the movement, and a lack of effective governance is also identified as a contributing factor. Any government response therefore has to address the economic and administrative gaps that the movement draws on, alongside security operations. Development work in tribal areas, including basic housing, water and services, is part of this wider approach.

Q1.

The Naxalite movement derives its name from which place?

- (A) Naxalbari district, Odisha
- (B) Naxalbari town, Jharkhand
- (C) Naxalbari village, Bihar
- (D) Naxalbari village, West Bengal

Q2.

Assertion (A): Poverty and lack of sustainable means have pushed people to join the Naxalite movement.

Reason (R): Insufficient technical intelligence against Naxalism is listed among the factors responsible for the movement.

- (A) Both A and R are true and R is the correct explanation of A
- (B) Both A and R are true but R is not the correct explanation of A
- (C) A is true but R is false
- (D) A is false but R is true

Q3.

Match List I with List II:

List I	List II
I. Infrastructure integration	A. 9,000+ mobile (4G) towers
II. Information warfare	B. Surrender-cum-Rehabilitation Policy
III. Human capital strategy	C. NIA and Enforcement Directorate asset seizures
IV. Financial crackdown	D. 12,000 km of all-weather roads

Rows are two lists side by side, not matched pairs; work out the correct pairing.

- (A) I-D, II-B, III-A, IV-C
- (B) I-A, II-C, III-B, IV-D
- (C) I-A, II-B, III-C, IV-D
- (D) I-D, II-A, III-B, IV-C

Q4.

Consider the following statements about Left Wing Extremism:

- I. Its ideology seeks to establish a communist state based on Maoist principles.
- II. It originated from a 1967 uprising in Naxalbari, Bihar.
- III. The Forest (Conservation) Act 1980 allows tribes to harvest forest resources.

Which of the above statements is/are correct?

- (A) II and III only
- (B) I only
- (C) I and III only
- (D) I, II and III

Q5.

Consider the following statements about government initiatives against LWE:

- I. Dharti Aaba Janjatiya Gram Utkarsh Abhiyan covers more than 63,000 tribal villages.
- II. PM-JANMAN targets 175 PVTGs.
- III. Van Dhan Vikas Kendra has more than 2,200 clusters promoting minor forest produce value addition.

How many of the above statements are correct?

- (A) Only one
- (B) Only two
- (C) Only three
- (D) None

Q6.

Which state is the Greyhounds, an elite commando force, associated with?

- (A) Andhra Pradesh
- (B) Chhattisgarh
- (C) Jharkhand
- (D) Odisha

Q7.

Which ministry officially declared India Naxal-Free?

- (A) Ministry of Defence
- (B) Ministry of Tribal Affairs
- (C) Ministry of Rural Development
- (D) Ministry of Home Affairs

Q8.

Consider the following statements:

- I. Kerala is among the states named in the Red Corridor.
- II. Gujarat is among the states named in the Red Corridor.

Which of the above statements is/are correct?

- (A) I only
- (B) II only
- (C) Both I and II
- (D) Neither I nor II

Gujarat UCC Provisions Check

Gujarat has passed the Uniform Civil Code Bill 2026, and with this step it has become the second state to enact a Uniform Civil Code. The idea behind such a code is that the laws on marriage, divorce and inheritance should be the same for all citizens, irrespective of their religious affiliation, instead of being governed by separate religious personal laws. The Gujarat code creates one civil framework for these areas. It places strong emphasis on gender equality and aims to remove discriminatory practices against women. The code also brings in mandatory registration

requirements for both marriages and live-in relationships, and it lays down a formal process for separations. Personal laws have long been a sensitive matter in India because many civil laws are closely linked with religious beliefs. For this reason, the code makes room for certain exceptions. Communities whose customary practices and cultural identity need to be preserved are kept outside its scope. Goa has followed a form of common civil code for a long time, and it is often cited as an example of how such a code can work in practice. Uttarakhand, which came before Gujarat, was the first state to adopt such a code after pre-Independence Goa.

Q1.

Under the Gujarat UCC, within how many days must a live-in relationship be registered?

- (A) 15 days
- (B) 45 days
- (C) 60 days
- (D) 30 days

Q2.

Assertion (A): The Gujarat UCC sets different registration periods for marriages and live-in relationships.

Reason (R): Marriages must be registered within 60 days, while live-in relationships must be registered within 30 days.

- (A) Both A and R are true and R is the correct explanation of A
- (B) Both A and R are true but R is not the correct explanation of A
- (C) A is true but R is false
- (D) A is false but R is true

Q3.

Match List I with List II:

List I	List II
I. Marriage registration period	A. Scheduled Tribes
II. Live-in registration period	B. Civil Courts
III. Forum for processing separations	C. 30 days
IV. Group exempted to preserve customary practices	D. 60 days

Rows are two lists side by side, not matched pairs; work out the correct pairing.

- (A) I-C, II-A, III-B, IV-D
- (B) I-D, II-C, III-B, IV-A
- (C) I-C, II-B, III-A, IV-D
- (D) I-A, II-D, III-C, IV-B

Q4.

Consider the following statements about the Gujarat UCC:

- I. Marriage must be registered within 60 days.
- II. Live-in relationships must be registered within 60 days.
- III. Scheduled Tribes are excluded from the code.

Which of the above statements is/are correct?

- (A) I and II only
- (B) I, II and III
- (C) II and III only
- (D) I and III only

Q5.

How many of the following statements about the Gujarat UCC are correct?

- I. The code ensures equal inheritance rights for sons and daughters.
- II. All separations must be processed through Revenue Courts.
- III. The monogamy rule prohibits polygamy and bigamy.

- (A) Only two
- (B) Only one
- (C) All three
- (D) None

Q6.

Which of the following is NOT one of the four Hindu Code Bills?

- (A) Hindu Property Rights Act, 1956
- (B) Hindu Succession Act, 1956
- (C) Hindu Marriage Act, 1955
- (D) Hindu Adoptions and Maintenance Act, 1956

Q7.

Under the judicial exclusivity in divorce provision of the Gujarat UCC, where must all separations be processed?

- (A) Revenue Courts
- (B) District Family Counselling Centres
- (C) Religious Tribunals
- (D) Civil Courts

Q8.

Under which civil code does Goa practise its form of common civil code?

- (A) Portuguese Civil Code of 1867
- (B) British Civil Code of 1858
- (C) French Civil Code of 1804
- (D) Indian Civil Code of 1872

Dispute Background Check

The Mahanadi water dispute is a conflict between Odisha and Chhattisgarh over how the river's waters should be shared. Odisha, the downstream state, says that extensive upstream constructions in Chhattisgarh have reduced the water flowing into its territory. In Odisha's view, this decline threatens irrigation, drinking water supply, fisheries and the ecological sustainability of the state. Chhattisgarh, the upstream state, argues that it has a legitimate right to utilise river waters. It points out that it accounts for a larger share of the basin's catchment area. It also says its projects are necessary for regional development and water security. The conflict is most sharp during the non-monsoon season, when water availability downstream becomes critically important. A central obstacle is that the two states have no formal water-sharing agreement between them. The dispute grew more serious after upstream infrastructure work expanded, and Odisha took the matter forward by approaching the highest court of the country. Efforts at negotiation have so far not produced a shared formula. Both states continue to hold firmly to their positions, and the question of how the water should be divided remains open.

Q1.

Around which year did the Mahanadi water dispute between Odisha and Chhattisgarh significantly escalate?

- (A) 2008
- (B) 2012
- (C) 2019
- (D) 2016

Q2.

Under which Act was the Mahanadi Water Disputes Tribunal constituted?

- (A) Inter-State River Water Disputes Act, 1956
- (B) River Boards Act, 1956
- (C) Water (Prevention and Control of Pollution) Act, 1974
- (D) National Water Policy Act, 2002

Q3.

Match List I with List II:

List I	List II
I. Entry 17 (State List)	A. Boards for inter-state rivers and river valleys
II. River Boards Act, 1956	B. Regulate and develop inter-state rivers in public interest
III. Entry 56 (Union List)	C. Tribunal constituted if consultation between states fails
IV. Inter-State River Water Disputes Act, 1956	D. Water supplies, irrigation, canals, drainage, embankments

Rows are two lists side by side, not matched pairs; work out the correct pairing.

- (A) I-D, II-C, III-A, IV-B
- (B) I-B, II-A, III-C, IV-D
- (C) I-D, II-A, III-B, IV-C
- (D) I-D, II-B, III-C, IV-A

Q4.

- I. The Mahanadi Water Disputes Tribunal was constituted in 2016.
- II. The Mahanadi Water Disputes Tribunal was constituted in 2018 for Chhattisgarh and Odisha.
- III. The Krishna Water Disputes Tribunal II was constituted in 2004 for four states.

Which of the above statements is/are correct?

- (A) I and II only
- (B) II and III only
- (C) I and III only
- (D) I, II and III

Q5.

- I. The Tribunal has issued a final ultimatum asking the two states to present a settlement by May 2.
- II. The Supreme Court can question the award or formula given by the Tribunal.
- III. No River Board has been created so far under the River Boards Act, 1956.

How many of the above statements are correct?

- (A) Only one
- (B) Only two
- (C) Only three
- (D) None

Q6.

What is the significance of the Hirakud Dam built on the Mahanadi River?

- (A) It is the tallest concrete dam in India
- (B) It is the first hydroelectric dam in India
- (C) It is the largest reservoir in Asia by surface area
- (D) It is the longest earthen dam in the world

73rd Amendment: framework and provisions

Grassroots democracy in India received a major constitutional boost when a bill to amend the Constitution was introduced in the Lok Sabha in 1991. The aim was to bring governance closer to

the people by giving local bodies a clear and permanent place in the Constitution. The amendment added a new part dealing with panchayats and laid down a common framework that States were expected to follow. Among its provisions are rules on how members and chairpersons are chosen, how seats are reserved for weaker sections and women, and how long a panchayat may function before fresh elections must be held. It also assigned the supervision of panchayat elections to a dedicated authority and required a body to review the finances of panchayats at regular intervals. Certain regions were kept outside this framework because of their special social and administrative character, and separate laws were made for some tribal areas. The rules were also extended to Union Territories, with the President empowered to specify exceptions. Local bodies were also expected to plan development for their own areas, which encouraged a bottom-up approach to planning. Regular elections became a central feature of local government under the new framework. The amendment was implemented in stages, and its adoption by individual States showed how a national framework could be translated into local practice across a federal country.

Q1.

On which date did the 73rd Constitutional Amendment Act come into force?

- (A) 26 January 1993
- (B) 24 April 1992
- (C) 2 October 1959
- (D) 24 April 1993

Q2.

What is the minimum age to contest an election to Panchayati Raj bodies?

- (A) 21 years
- (B) 25 years
- (C) 18 years
- (D) 30 years

Q3.

How many of the following statements about the 73rd Constitutional Amendment are correct?

1. A panchayat has a term of five years unless it is dissolved earlier.
 2. Not less than one-third of the seats in panchayats must be reserved for women.
 3. Reservation of seats for Scheduled Castes applies in Arunachal Pradesh.
- (A) Only one
 - (B) Only two
 - (C) Only three
 - (D) None

Q4.

Under Article 243-K, who appoints the State Election Commissioner?

- (A) Chief Minister of the State
- (B) Chief Justice of the High Court
- (C) President of India
- (D) Governor of the State

Q5.

Consider the following statements:

- I. Members of panchayats at the village, intermediate and district levels are elected directly by the people.
- II. A State having a population not exceeding 20 lakh may skip the intermediate-level panchayat.
- III. Part IX of the Constitution applies to Delhi as a Union Territory.

Which of the above statements is/are correct?

- (A) I only
- (B) II and III only
- (C) I and II only
- (D) I, II and III

Q6.

How many subjects are contained in the 11th Schedule added by the 73rd Constitutional Amendment Act?

- (A) 29 subjects
- (B) 18 subjects
- (C) 20 subjects
- (D) 25 subjects

Q7.

Match List I with List II:

List I	List II
I. Article 243-E	A. Extension of Part IX to Union Territories
II. Article 243-M	B. Finance Commission constituted every five years
III. Article 243-L	C. Five-year term of a panchayat
IV. Article 243-I	D. Exempted areas such as Nagaland and Mizoram

Rows are two lists side by side, not matched pairs; work out the correct pairing.

- (A) I-B, II-A, III-C, IV-D
- (B) I-C, II-D, III-A, IV-B
- (C) I-D, II-B, III-A, IV-C
- (D) I-C, II-A, III-D, IV-B

Monetary Policy Committee Check

The Monetary Policy Committee is the body that sets the benchmark policy rate of the Reserve Bank of India, known as the Repo Rate. Its central purpose is to keep inflation within a specified target level, so that prices remain stable while the economy grows. The committee was created as a statutory body, and the central government holds the power to set up its composition. Its meetings are not occasional events, since the committee comes together regularly through the year to review the economic situation. Recently, the committee faced a difficult environment. Rising geopolitical tensions in West Asia increased global uncertainty, with volatile energy prices and disrupted trade flows. India was also experiencing a supply-side shock that raised input costs without necessarily reflecting excess domestic demand. Retail inflation stayed within the mandated band, and core inflation remained stable, which reduced the urgency for tightening. Trade agreements with several major partners were expected to boost exports and investment over the medium term. After weighing these factors, the committee chose to keep the Repo Rate unchanged at 5.25 per cent. The chosen stance was cautious and steady, in line with the goal of price stability. Such decisions shape borrowing costs for banks, businesses and households across the country, and they are closely followed by investors and students of the economy alike.

Q1.

In case of a tie in an MPC vote, who has the casting vote?

- (A) RBI Governor
- (B) Central Government nominee
- (C) Deputy Governor in charge of monetary policy
- (D) Finance Secretary

Q2.

How many of the following statements about the Monetary Policy Committee are correct?

- a. Its decisions are binding on banks.
 - b. The Deputy Governor is its ex-officio chairperson.
 - c. Three of its members are appointed by the Central Government.
 - d. Its decisions require a two-thirds majority.
- (A) Only one
 - (B) Only two
 - (C) Only three
 - (D) None

Q3.

Who is the ex-officio Chairperson of the Monetary Policy Committee?

- (A) RBI Governor
- (B) Central Government nominee
- (C) Deputy Governor in charge of monetary policy
- (D) Finance Secretary

Q4.

Consider the following statements about the Monetary Policy Committee:

- I. It meets at least four times each year.
- II. Its quorum is at least four members.
- III. Its decisions require unanimous agreement of all members.

Which of the above statements is/are correct?

- (A) I and II only
- (B) II and III only
- (C) I only
- (D) I, II and III

Q5.

Match List I with List II:

List I	List II
I. Ex-officio chairperson of MPC	A. Four times a year
II. Members appointed by Central Government	B. RBI Governor
III. Minimum meetings each year	C. One RBI officer
IV. Member nominated by Central Board	D. Three

Rows are two lists side by side, not matched pairs; work out the correct pairing.

- (A) I-C, II-B, III-D, IV-A
- (B) I-C, II-D, III-B, IV-A
- (C) I-B, II-D, III-A, IV-C
- (D) I-D, II-C, III-B, IV-A

Q6.

How many members does the Monetary Policy Committee have?

- (A) Four
- (B) Five
- (C) Eight
- (D) Six

Q7.

Assertion (A): Decisions of the Monetary Policy Committee are binding on commercial banks.

Reason (R): MPC decisions are taken by a majority vote.

Which of the following is correct?

- (A) Both A and R are true and R is the correct explanation of A
- (B) Both A and R are true but R is not the correct explanation of A
- (C) A is true but R is false
- (D) A is false but R is true

Q8.

Which MPC member is in charge of monetary policy?

- (A) Central Government nominee
- (B) RBI officer nominated by Central Board
- (C) Finance Secretary
- (D) Deputy Governor in charge of monetary policy

MC14 and WTO Basics Quiz

The fourteenth Ministerial Conference of the World Trade Organization, known as MC14, was held in Yaoundé, Cameroon. The meeting ended without consensus, leaving several contentious issues unresolved. Members were divided over the moratorium on customs duties on electronic transmissions, and over agriculture and transparency norms. Because no agreement was reached, the pending issues were passed on to the WTO General Council, which meets in Geneva. The WTO is an intergovernmental organisation that manages and encourages international trade. It succeeded the General Agreement on Tariffs and Trade and was built on the results of the Uruguay Round negotiations. Its member countries work through several bodies, which share the work of running the organisation and handling trade disputes. Trade ministers and senior officials attend its main gatherings, and the organisation maintains strong relations with the United Nations. Trade disputes form a major part of the WTO's work, and the system for resolving them has been under strain. Members have been debating how to restore a binding system with two tiers. They have also discussed a permanent solution for public stockholding for food security, a demand that India and African nations have repeatedly raised. Fisheries subsidies and support for countries losing Least Developed Country status were also on the agenda.

Q1.

How often does the WTO Ministerial Conference meet, at minimum?

- (A) Once every two years
- (B) Once every three years
- (C) Once every year
- (D) Once every five years

Q2.

Where was the last Ministerial Conference before MC14 held?

- (A) Abu Dhabi
- (B) Nairobi
- (C) Buenos Aires
- (D) Geneva

Q3.

Under which agreement was the WTO established?

- (A) Tokyo Round Agreement
- (B) Bali Package
- (C) Doha Declaration
- (D) Marrakesh Agreement

Q4.

- I. The e-Commerce Moratorium on customs duties on electronic transmissions has been in place since 1998 and expired at MC14.
- II. The Appellate Body has been non-functional since 2019.
- III. The Investment Facilitation for Development Agreement was launched at MC13 in Abu Dhabi.

Which of the above statements is/are correct?

- (A) II and III only
- (B) I and II only
- (C) I, II and III
- (D) I and III only

Q5.

- I. It is a plurilateral agreement binding only on its signatories.
- II. It is based on the Most-Favoured-Nation principle.
- III. It excludes investor-state dispute settlement.
- IV. It covers market access.

How many of the above statements about the IFD Agreement are correct?

- (A) Only one
- (B) Only two
- (C) Only three
- (D) All of the above

Q6.

The safeguard against which type of complaints lapsed alongside the e-Commerce Moratorium?

- (A) Non-violation complaints under TRIPS
- (B) Anti-dumping complaints under GATT
- (C) Currency manipulation complaints
- (D) Climate-related trade complaints

Global findings check

Air quality around the world is often measured by the concentration of fine particulate matter, known as PM2.5. Health agencies set a guideline for the annual average level of these particles, and a global assessment checks how many places meet it. The assessment discussed here is prepared by a technology company that measures air quality and reports the results. The findings are sobering. Only a small share of cities met the annual guideline in the latest year, and that share fell from the previous year. Most of the countries and territories assessed did not meet safe air quality standards. Only a handful of places met the guideline, and at least one city recorded very low particle levels, which shows that clean air is still possible.

Q1.

Assertion (A): Pakistan was the most polluted country in 2025.

Reason (R): Its PM2.5 level in 2025 was below the WHO annual guideline.

- (A) Both A and R are true and R is the correct explanation of A
- (B) Both A and R are true but R is not the correct explanation of A
- (C) A is true but R is false
- (D) A is false but R is true

Q2.

Consider the following statements about India in the World Air Quality Report 2025:

- I. India was ranked the 6th most polluted country in 2025.
- II. India's ranking improved from 5th in 2024.
- III. India accounted for 50 of the world's 100 most polluted cities in 2024.

How many of the above statements are correct?

- (A) Only one
- (B) Only two
- (C) Only three
- (D) None

Q3.

Which city was recorded as the World's Cleanest City in the 2025 report?

- (A) Helsinki, Finland
- (B) Reykjavik, Iceland
- (C) Canberra, Australia
- (D) Nieuwoudtville, South Africa

Q4.

Match List I with List II:

List I	List II
I. World's cleanest city	A. Pakistan
II. Most polluted country	B. New Delhi
III. Most polluted city	C. Nieuwoudtville (South Africa)
IV. World's most polluted capital	D. Loni, Uttar Pradesh

Rows are two lists side by side, not matched pairs; work out the correct pairing.

- (A) I-A, II-B, III-C, IV-D
- (B) I-C, II-A, III-D, IV-B
- (C) I-D, II-C, III-A, IV-B
- (D) I-B, II-A, III-C, IV-D

Q5.

In which year was IQAir, the organisation behind the report, founded?

- (A) 1963
- (B) 1958
- (C) 1971
- (D) 1985

Q6.

Which edition of the World Air Quality Report was released in 2025?

- (A) 8th Edition
- (B) 7th Edition
- (C) 6th Edition
- (D) 9th Edition

Q7.

Consider the following statements about the World Air Quality Report 2025:

- I. 130 of 143 countries and territories failed to meet safe air quality standards.
- II. Central and South Asia remain the most polluted regions globally.
- III. Five of the world's ten most polluted cities are located in Pakistan.

Which of the above statements is/are correct?

- (A) I only
- (B) II and III only
- (C) I and II only
- (D) I, II and III

Q8.

Approximately how many times higher than WHO guidelines was PM_{2.5} in Loni, the most polluted city?

- (A) 22 times
- (B) 10 times
- (C) 15 times
- (D) 30 times

Criticality and reactor choices

A nuclear reactor produces useful power only when its chain reaction keeps going on its own. Whether this happens depends on the neutrons inside the core, because each fission releases neutrons that can trigger further fissions. Engineers track how many neutrons are produced in each round compared with the round before. If this ratio falls below the level needed, the reaction fades away. If it holds at that level, the power stays steady. If it climbs above, the output grows quickly and must be brought under control.

India's nuclear programme is designed to make the most of its resources over a long period. Early reactors use the fuel the country can readily supply, while later designs aim to create more fuel than they consume. The prototype reactor at Kalpakkam is a test of one such design, and its progress is being followed closely by scientists and policymakers.

Building a reactor that breeds fuel is demanding. Its core must be surrounded by material that captures neutrons and turns into new fuel. Its coolant must remove heat efficiently and be chosen with care, because the choice affects how the neutrons behave. These decisions shape the reactor's cost, its safety record and the amount of waste it leaves behind.

Regulation also matters. Nuclear and radiation facilities must follow national rules, and an expert body oversees their activities so that they run in a controlled way.

Q1.

Consider the following statements:

- I. The PFBR uses Mixed Oxide fuel derived from reprocessed spent fuel.
- II. Stage I reactors breed Plutonium-239.
- III. Kudankulam is the oldest nuclear power plant in India.

Which of the above statements is/are correct?

- (A) I and II only
- (B) II and III only
- (C) I only
- (D) I, II and III

Q2.

Assertion (A): Liquid sodium is used as the coolant in the PFBR because it slows neutrons effectively for fission.

Reason (R): Liquid sodium has high thermal conductivity and does not slow neutrons.

- (A) Both A and R are true and R is the correct explanation of A
- (B) Both A and R are true but R is not the correct explanation of A
- (C) A is true but R is false
- (D) A is false but R is true

Q3.

Which agency is responsible for building the Prototype Fast Breeder Reactor at Kalpakkam?

- (A) Atomic Energy Regulatory Board (AERB)
- (B) Indira Gandhi Centre for Atomic Research
- (C) Department of Atomic Energy
- (D) Bharatiya Nabhikiya Vidyut Nigam Limited (BHAVINI)

Q4.

Compared with traditional Pressurized Heavy Water Reactors (PHWRs), by roughly how many times does the PFBR extract more energy from natural uranium?

- (A) About 6 times
- (B) About 16 times
- (C) About 60 times
- (D) About 600 times

Q5.

Consider the following statements about India's nuclear power sector:

- I. Tarapur is India's first and oldest nuclear power plant.
- II. India presently has 24 nuclear power reactors operating in 6 states.
- III. The PFBR at Kalpakkam has an installed capacity of 8780 MWe.

How many of the above statements are correct?

- (A) Only one
- (B) Only two
- (C) Only three
- (D) None

Q6.

What is the capacity of the Prototype Fast Breeder Reactor at Kalpakkam?

- (A) 500 MWe
- (B) 200 MWe
- (C) 700 MWe
- (D) 1000 MWe

Q7.

Which Indian law governs the establishment and use of nuclear facilities and radioactive sources?

- (A) Atomic Energy Act, 1962
- (B) Atomic Energy Act, 1982
- (C) Atomic Energy Act, 1992
- (D) Atomic Energy Act, 2002

Q8.

Match List I with List II:

List I	List II
I. Stage I	A. Uranium-233 from thorium
II. Stage II	B. Liquid sodium
III. Stage III	C. Mixed Oxide (MOX) fuel
IV. PFBR coolant	D. Natural uranium fuel

Rows are two lists side by side, not matched pairs; work out the correct pairing.

- (A) I-B, II-C, III-A, IV-D
- (B) I-D, II-B, III-C, IV-A
- (C) I-D, II-C, III-A, IV-B
- (D) I-C, II-D, III-B, IV-A

Aridaman Submarine Practice Set

India has commissioned a new submarine that adds to its strategic forces at sea. The vessel is a ballistic missile submarine, a category that is typically the largest and most complex type of nuclear-powered submarine. Such a vessel can carry missiles that may be nuclear armed, and its design focuses on stealth, which comes from low noise. Operators also value the ability to remain submerged for long periods and the improved survivability it offers. The submarine belongs to a family of Indian submarines that began with an earlier vessel and grew through later additions. Its construction was linked to a programme launched in the 1980s, which aimed to create an indigenous fleet of such submarines with Russian assistance. Several government bodies managed that programme, so the work drew on more than one organisation. The vessel also supports a sea-based leg of India's nuclear forces, alongside weapons delivered from land and from the air. Its role is tied to India's doctrine of not using nuclear weapons first and to the idea of a credible minimum deterrent. Readers preparing for examinations should note how these design goals, the programme history and the strategic role fit together. Taken as a whole, the vessel shows how India combines indigenous development with support from partners over several decades. Each of these points connects back to the submarine programme and the wider defence strategy.

Q1.

What type of reactor powers INS Aridaman?

- (A) 40 MW Heavy Water Reactor
- (B) 100 MW Fast Breeder Reactor
- (C) 83 MW Pressurised Compact Light-Water Reactor
- (D) 60 MW Boiling Water Reactor

Q2.

Where was INS Aridaman built?

- (A) Mazagon Dock, Mumbai
- (B) Cochin Shipyard, Kerala
- (C) Garden Reach Shipbuilders, Kolkata
- (D) Ship Building Centre, Visakhapatnam

Q3.

What does the acronym SSBN stand for?

- (A) Ship Submersible Ballistic Nuclear
- (B) Strategic Submarine Ballistic Network
- (C) Stealth Submarine Battle Navy
- (D) Sub-Surface Ballistic Nuclear

Q4.

Consider the following statements:

- I. The 30-year Submarine Building Plan was approved by the Cabinet Committee on Security after the Kargil War in 1999.
- II. Project 75I was the first project under the Strategic Partnership Model.
- III. Project 751 submarines can stay submerged for up to 48 hours.

Which of the above statements is/are correct?

- (A) I and II only
- (B) II and III only
- (C) I and III only
- (D) I, II and III

Q5.

How many of the following statements about INS Aridaman are correct?

- I. It is equipped with 8 vertical launch systems.
- II. It was built by Cochin Shipyard Limited.
- III. It can carry K-4 missiles with a range of 3,500 km.

- (A) Only one
- (B) Only two
- (C) Only three
- (D) None

Q6.

Which organisations together manage the ATV Project?

- (A) ISRO, Indian Navy and Ministry of Defence
- (B) HAL, BARC and Indian Air Force
- (C) DRDO, Ministry of Finance and Indian Navy
- (D) DRDO, Department of Atomic Energy and Indian Navy

Artemis Programme and Accords

NASA's Artemis Programme takes its name from the Moon Goddess of Greek mythology. Its central goal is to send humans back to the Moon, including the first woman and the first person of colour to stand on its surface. The programme is carried out in stages. The first stage was an unmanned mission that launched the Orion spacecraft. A later mission carries a crew around the Moon on a flyby, after which the astronauts return to Earth. The crew will not land on the lunar surface during that flight. The crewed flight is expected to last about ten days and will end with a splashdown in the Pacific Ocean. Launches take place from the Kennedy Space Center in Florida. Plans also include a station near the Moon called the Lunar Gateway, which would serve as a docking point for astronauts and support scientific research. Several space agencies are partners in the programme, including the European Space Agency, the Japan Aerospace Exploration Agency and the Canadian Space Agency. Alongside this programme, the Artemis Accords set out shared principles for peaceful exploration of space, the Moon, Mars, comets and asteroids. Many countries have joined these principles, and they were built on an older international agreement on outer space. The Artemis Accords are a framework for cooperation, and they guide how countries behave when they explore space together.

Q1.

In which year is the Lunar Gateway Station planned to be established?

- (A) 2024
- (B) 2027
- (C) 2029
- (D) 2032

Q2.

Which was NASA's last mission to the Moon before Artemis II?

- (A) Apollo 17 (1972)
- (B) Apollo 15 (1971)
- (C) Apollo 16 (1972)
- (D) Apollo 18 (1973)

Q3.

Who is the Commander of the Artemis II crew?

- (A) Victor Glover
- (B) Christina Koch
- (C) Jeremy Hansen
- (D) Reid Wiseman

Q4.

Read the statements and choose the correct option.

Assertion (A): The Artemis Accords have 63 member countries.

Reason (R): India joined the Artemis Accords in 2023 as its 27th member.

- (A) Both A and R are true and R explains A
- (B) Both A and R are true but R does not explain A
- (C) A is true but R is false
- (D) A is false but R is true

Q5.

Match List I with List II:

List I	List II
I. Chandrayaan-1	A. Slated for launch in 2028
II. Chandrayaan-2	B. Launched in 2023
III. Chandrayaan-3	C. Launched in 2019
IV. Chandrayaan-4	D. Launched in 2008

Rows are two lists side by side, not matched pairs; work out the correct pairing.

- (A) I-A, II-D, III-B, IV-C
- (B) I-B, II-A, III-D, IV-C
- (C) I-D, II-C, III-B, IV-A
- (D) I-D, II-B, III-C, IV-A

Q6.

Consider the following statements about the Artemis Accords:

I. The Artemis Accords were announced by NASA in 2020.

II. India joined the Artemis Accords in 2023 as its 27th member.

III. Russia and China are members of the Artemis Accords.

Which of the above statements is/are correct?

- (A) II and III only
- (B) I and II only
- (C) I only
- (D) I, II and III

Q7.

How many of the following statements about the Gaganyaan Mission are correct?

- I. It is India's first human spaceflight programme.
- II. It plans to launch a three-person crew on a three-day mission to a 400 km orbit.
- III. All four astronaut designates will fly on the final mission.

- (A) Only one
- (B) Only two
- (C) Only three
- (D) None

Q8.

Which nation became the first to soft-land on the lunar South Pole?

- (A) China
- (B) Japan
- (C) United States
- (D) India

Vaishali and the chess landscape

Indian Grandmaster R. Vaishali won the FIDE Women's Candidates Tournament 2026, held in Nicosia, Cyprus. She clinched the title by defeating Kateryna Lagno of Russia in the final round, finishing the event with 8.5 points out of 14. With this win she became the first Indian woman to claim the Candidates title. She will now challenge the reigning champion, Ju Wenjun of China, for the Women's World Chess Championship later in 2026. Her achievement comes in a strong period for Indian chess. Viswanathan Anand, often described as India's most successful chess player, has won the FIDE World Chess Championship several times. In 2024, Gukesh Dommaraju became the World Chess Champion, making him the second Indian to win the title after Anand. Koneru Humpy, India's highest-rated female chess player, has also won major honours in the sport. The sport itself is run globally by FIDE, the International Chess Federation. FIDE acts as the global governing authority for chess, oversees all major international competitions and sets the rules and rating standards that players follow. Its motto, Gens una Sumus, means 'We are One Family'. The World Chess Championship has a long history, with its first official champion crowned in the nineteenth century. Chess players from many countries take part in its events.

Q1.

How many times did Viswanathan Anand win the FIDE World Chess Championship?

- (A) 3
- (B) 4
- (C) 5
- (D) 6

Q2.

Who is the Deputy President of FIDE?

- (A) Viswanathan Anand
- (B) Arkady Dvorkovich
- (C) Kateryna Lagno
- (D) Ding Liren

Q3.

Assertion (A): Viswanathan Anand is the Deputy President of FIDE.

Reason (R): FIDE is headquartered in Paris.

- (A) Both A and R are true and R is the correct explanation of A
- (B) Both A and R are true but R is not the correct explanation of A
- (C) A is true but R is false
- (D) A is false but R is true

Q4.

Consider the following statements:

- I. Viswanathan Anand has won the FIDE World Chess Championship five times.
- II. Gukesh Dommaraju defeated Ding Liren to win the FIDE World Chess Championship in 2024.
- III. Chess originated in Northern India during the Mughal Empire as 'Chaturanga'.

Which of the above statements is/are correct?

- (A) I only
- (B) I and II only
- (C) II and III only
- (D) I, II and III

Q5.

Consider the following statements:

- I. Divya Deshmukh won the FIDE Women's World Cup 2025 in Batumi, Georgia.
- II. India hosted the Chess World Cup 2025 in Hyderabad.
- III. Koneru Humpy clinched the Women's World Rapid Chess Championship title in 2019.

How many of the above statements are correct?

- (A) Only one
- (B) Only two
- (C) Only three
- (D) None

Q6.

Which Indian Grandmaster won the FIDE World Junior Chess Championship 2025 held in Montenegro?

- (A) Pranav Venkatesh
- (B) Pentala Harikrishna
- (C) Abhijeet Gupta
- (D) Viswanathan Anand

Q7.

Where was the FIDE World Chess Championship 2024 held, in which Gukesh Dommaraju won the title?

- (A) Dubai, UAE
- (B) Mumbai, India
- (C) Shanghai, China
- (D) Singapore

Digital Platforms Check

Digital platforms faced major legal and regulatory scrutiny in April 2026. A jury in the United States found Meta Platforms and YouTube liable for designing addictive products, such as endless scrolling and algorithm-driven feeds. The ruling treated the problem as one of platform design rather than the content users posted. The court did not apply the usual shield under Section 230 of the Communications Decency Act, and the platforms were treated as products. Liability was divided between the two companies.

In India, the government has notified rules for online gaming that take effect from 1 May 2026. These rules work alongside a law that prohibits online money gaming, meaning betting and wagering, while allowing e-sports and social or casual games. Games are assessed through a determination test, and registered platforms receive a digital certificate of registration. The framework also bans advertising of money gaming and requires banks and payment gateways to block transactions linked to prohibited platforms.

The Unified Payments Interface completed ten years in 2026 and shows how digital payments are growing. It allows instant bank-to-bank transfers through mobile phones and supports both peer-to-peer and peer-to-merchant payments. Its family of products extends to several other services designed for different users.

Q1.

Which body regulates online gaming under the new framework?

- (A) Online Gaming Authority of India
- (B) Reserve Bank of India
- (C) National Payments Corporation of India
- (D) Ministry of Corporate Affairs

Q2.

What is the maximum imprisonment under the online gaming penalty provisions?

- (A) Up to 1 year
- (B) Up to 2 years
- (C) Up to 3 years
- (D) Up to 5 years

Q3.

Assertion (A): Online money gaming is prohibited under the new framework.

Reason (R): Registered e-sports with pre-declared prize pools are exempt from the monetary ban.

Choose the correct option.

- (A) Both A and R are true and R is the correct explanation of A
- (B) Both A and R are true but R is not the correct explanation of A
- (C) A is true but R is false
- (D) A is false but R is true

Q4.

Match List I with List II:

List I	List II
I. Regulator of online gaming	A. UPI 123Pay
II. Operator of UPI	B. UPI Lite
III. Low-value offline payments without PIN	C. Online Gaming Authority of India
IV. UPI service for feature phones	D. National Payments Corporation of India

Rows are two lists side by side, not matched pairs; work out the correct pairing.

- (A) I-D, II-C, III-A, IV-B
- (B) I-C, II-A, III-B, IV-D
- (C) I-A, II-B, III-D, IV-C
- (D) I-C, II-D, III-B, IV-A

Q5.

Consider the following statements:

I. Online money gaming is prohibited under the Act.

II. An appeal lies first to the Online Gaming Authority of India and then to the Secretary of MeitY.

III. The digital certificate of registration is valid for up to 15 years.

Which of the above statements is/are correct?

- (A) II and III only
- (B) I and III only
- (C) I and II only
- (D) I, II and III

Q6.

Consider the following statements about the social media case:

- I. The verdict treated the issue as platform design rather than content.
- II. The court applied Section 230 to protect the platforms.
- III. Meta Platforms bore about 70 per cent of the liability.

How many of the above statements are correct?

- (A) Only one
- (B) Only two
- (C) Only three
- (D) None

Q7.

What was the total compensation in the social media addiction case?

- (A) USD 1 million
- (B) USD 2 million
- (C) USD 3 million
- (D) USD 6 million

Q8.

In which year was UPI launched?

- (A) 2016
- (B) 2014
- (C) 2018
- (D) 2020

Energy and Freight Infrastructure MCQs

India's energy and freight networks drew attention in April 2026. The Ministry of New and Renewable Energy highlighted the country's progress in renewable energy capacity, policy reforms and the wider energy transition. Solar power forms the largest part of the national energy mix, and India has built up a large stock of non-fossil capacity. The country also reported strong additions to its non-fossil capacity during the last financial year, adding to a broader push towards cleaner power. The same review also covered policy reforms, which the ministry presented as part of the country's energy transition.

Hydropower is also being revived. The Jammu and Kashmir government has moved to restore the Mohra Power Project, a historic plant on the Jhelum River in Uri, Baramulla. The move is meant to boost hydropower capacity at a time when the Indus Waters Treaty faces uncertainty. The plant is a hydroelectric power plant in the Kashmir Valley, and its revival is being pursued by the state government.

Freight infrastructure also reached a milestone. The Ministry of Railways completed the Western Dedicated Freight Corridor, which links the Jawaharlal Nehru Port Terminal in Maharashtra with Dadri in Uttar Pradesh. The Eastern Dedicated Freight Corridor runs from Ludhiana in Punjab to Sonnagar in Bihar. Both corridors are being implemented by the Dedicated Freight Corridor Corporation of India Limited.

Q1.

In which year was the Mohra Power Project commissioned?

- (A) 1947
- (B) 1975
- (C) 1905
- (D) 2008

Q2.

What is the length of the Western Dedicated Freight Corridor?

- (A) 1337 km
- (B) 1256 km
- (C) 1506 km
- (D) 1605 km

Q3.

In which year was the Dedicated Freight Corridor project approved by the Cabinet?

- (A) 2005
- (B) 2018
- (C) 2021
- (D) 2008

Q4.

Match List I with List II:

List I	List II
I. Eastern Dedicated Freight Corridor	A. 1506 km
II. Western Dedicated Freight Corridor	B. 54.7 per cent
III. Mohra Power Project	C. 1337 km
IV. Solar share of India's energy mix	D. Commissioned in 1905

Rows are two lists side by side, not matched pairs; work out the correct pairing.

- (A) I-A, II-D, III-B, IV-C
- (B) I-D, II-A, III-C, IV-B
- (C) I-C, II-A, III-D, IV-B
- (D) I-B, II-D, III-C, IV-A

Q5.

Consider the following statements:

- I. The Mohra Power Project is also known as the Mahura Power Project.
- II. The Eastern Dedicated Freight Corridor is longer than the Western Dedicated Freight Corridor.
- III. Wind accounts for a larger share of India's energy mix than large hydro does.

Which of the above statements is/are correct?

- (A) I and II only
- (B) II and III only
- (C) I and III only
- (D) I, II and III

Q6.

Consider the following statements:

- I. India achieved its 50 per cent non-fossil power capacity target five years ahead of 2030.
- II. India ranks third globally in renewable energy capacity.
- III. Bioenergy is the largest contributor to India's energy mix.

How many of the above statements are correct?

- (A) Only one
- (B) Only two
- (C) All three
- (D) None

Q7.

How much non-fossil capacity did India add in FY 2025-26? (in GW)

- (A) 54.7 GW
- (B) 274.68 GW
- (C) 283.46 GW
- (D) 55.29 GW

PIO and OCI Schemes: MCQ Practice

Persons of Indian Origin (PIO) and Overseas Citizens of India (OCI) are two schemes that link people of Indian heritage living abroad with India. The OCI scheme was introduced through an amendment to the Citizenship Act, 1955. The PIO and OCI schemes were later merged into a single arrangement. The booklet presents the two categories side by side under the heading PIO VS OCI.

A foreign citizen can qualify as a PIO if a parent, grandparent or great-grandparent was born in India and was a permanent resident of India. The definition also covers a foreign citizen who is the spouse of a citizen of India or of a PIO, and it carves out exceptions for nationals of certain countries. PIO card holders enjoy parity with NRIs in economic, financial and educational benefits, and any future benefits given to NRIs are also available to PIO card holders.

OCI registration is open to certain foreign nationals with links to India, and minor children of such persons are also eligible. Registered OCI holders receive a multipurpose, multiple-entry, lifelong visa. This visa allows the holder to visit India at any time, for any length of time and for any purpose.

The booklet sets out who qualifies for each category and what benefits each one provides, with separate sections for each.

Q1.

Nationals of which of the following countries are excluded from the definition of a Person of Indian Origin (PIO)?

- (A) Pakistan
- (B) Japan
- (C) Myanmar
- (D) Maldives

Q2.

For how many years from the date of issue does a PIO card holder need no visa to visit India?

- (A) 5
- (B) 10
- (C) 20
- (D) 15

Q3.

Which right is excluded from the parity that OCI holders enjoy with NRIs in economic, financial and education fields?

- (A) Industrial property
- (B) Residential property
- (C) Commercial property
- (D) Agricultural or plantation properties

Q4.

Assertion (A): A PIO card holder whose stay in India is up to 180 days is exempt from registration at FRRO/FRO.

Reason (R): OCI holders are exempt from police reporting for any length of stay in India.

In the light of the above statements, choose the correct answer.

- (A) Both A and R are true and R is the correct explanation of A
- (B) A is true but R is false
- (C) Both A and R are true but R is not the correct explanation of A
- (D) A is false but R is true

Q5.

Match List I with List II:

List I	List II
I. Reference date for persons eligible to become an Indian citizen (OCI)	A. 15.08.1947
II. Days to register with FRRO/FRO after a stay exceeds 180 days (PIO)	B. OCI
III. Date after which a territory became part of India (OCI)	C. 30 days
IV. Scheme whose holders are exempt from police reporting	D. 26.01.1950

Rows are two lists side by side, not matched pairs; work out the correct pairing.

- (A) I-B, II-C, III-A, IV-D
- (B) I-B, II-C, III-D, IV-A
- (C) I-D, II-C, III-A, IV-B
- (D) I-A, II-B, III-C, IV-D

Q6.

Consider the following statements about PIO and OCI:

- I. A person who was ever a citizen of Bangladesh is not eligible for OCI registration.
- II. PIO card holders need no visa to visit India for 15 years from the date of issue of the card.
- III. OCI holders have the right to acquire agricultural or plantation properties.

Which of the above statements is/are correct?

- (A) I, II and III
- (B) I only
- (C) II and III only
- (D) I and II only

Q7.

Consider the following statements:

Nationals of Nepal are excluded from the definition of a PIO.

A PIO card holder staying in India for 200 days must register with FRRO/FRO within 30 days.

OCI holders must report to the police for any stay longer than 180 days.

How many of the above statements are correct?

- (A) Only one
- (B) Only two
- (C) Only three
- (D) All of the above

Sri Lanka Profile: MCQ Practice

The booklet covers Sri Lanka's capital, leaders and ties with India, and its profile of the country names the Palk Strait as the border between the two countries. Colombo is the executive capital of Sri Lanka, and Harini Amarasuriya serves as its Prime Minister. The Vice President made his first-ever bilateral visit to Sri Lanka and held talks in Colombo. The booklet records this visit under the heading Why in News.

The booklet describes India's cooperation with Sri Lanka in several areas, including development projects and maritime rescue. India and Sri Lanka jointly commission a Maritime Rescue Coordination Centre in Sri Lanka. Sri Lanka also takes part in multilateral cooperation, which includes BIMSTEC, SAARC and the Colombo Security Conclave.

The Liberation Tigers of Tamil Eelam (LTTE) was formed as a self-styled 'National Freedom Movement of People of Tamil Eelam'. The group undertook terrorist activities in Sri Lanka. The booklet also links the LTTE to the assassination of Rajiv Gandhi, a former Prime Minister of India.

Chinese vessels named Shi Yan-6 and Yuan Wang-5 conduct data collection, which the booklet describes as potentially supporting military operations against India. This topic appears in the April 2026 issue of the booklet, under the International Relations and News chapter.

Q1.

In which year was the Liberation Tigers of Tamil Eelam (LTTE) formed?

- (A) 1976
- (B) 1972
- (C) 1980
- (D) 1983

Q2.

Who is the President of Sri Lanka?

- (A) Harini Amarasuriya
- (B) Ranil Wickremesinghe
- (C) Mahinda Rajapaksa
- (D) Anura Kumara Dissanayake

Q3.

What is the currency of Sri Lanka?

- (A) Indian Rupee
- (B) Pakistani Rupee
- (C) Sri Lankan Rupee
- (D) Nepalese Rupee

Q4.

Assertion (A): The 13th Amendment of the Sri Lankan Constitution led to Provincial Councils with power-sharing for all 9 provinces.

Reason (R): China's growing influence in Sri Lanka runs through financial aid and Hambantota Port.

In the light of the above statements, choose the correct answer.

- (A) Both A and R are true but R is not the correct explanation of A
- (B) Both A and R are true and R is the correct explanation of A
- (C) A is true but R is false
- (D) A is false but R is true

Q5.

Match List I with List II:

List I	List II
I. Joint naval exercise between India and Sri Lanka	A. MITRA SHAKTI
II. Joint army exercise between India and Sri Lanka	B. Indian Ocean Rim Association
III. Multi-lateral naval exercise	C. SLINEX
IV. Regional forum of the Indian Ocean rim	D. MILAN

Rows are two lists side by side, not matched pairs; work out the correct pairing.

- (A) I-B, II-A, III-C, IV-D
- (B) I-D, II-C, III-A, IV-B
- (C) I-A, II-D, III-B, IV-C
- (D) I-C, II-A, III-D, IV-B

Q6.

Consider the following statements:

- I. India supports the development of Trincomalee as a Regional Energy and Industrial Hub.
- II. The Sampur Solar Power Plant is being constructed in Sri Lanka.
- III. The LTTE undertook terrorist activities mainly against Tamils.

Which of the above statements is/are correct?

- (A) I only
- (B) I and II only
- (C) II and III only
- (D) I, II and III

Q7.

Consider the following statements:

- I. Sri Lanka joins the International Big Cat Alliance.
- II. SLINEX is an army exercise conducted between India and Sri Lanka.
- III. The India-Sri Lanka Free Trade Agreement was signed in 2000.

How many of the above statements are correct?

- (A) All of the above
- (B) Only one
- (C) Only two
- (D) Only three

Delimitation and the Commission: Practice Quiz

Delimitation is the process of drawing the boundaries of territorial constituencies so that representation stays fair as population changes. Over time, some constituencies grow much larger than others, which means that a vote in one area can carry less weight than a vote in another. For this reason, boundaries are not drawn once and left alone. Each redrawing exercise is carried out by a body called a Delimitation Commission, which is set up for that purpose. Such Commissions have been created under several Acts passed over a period of decades. They have not been appointed after every census, and at certain points the seat allocation among States was frozen to protect States that had controlled their population growth. Later changes to the Constitution continued these freezes. The same principle of fair representation also applies to the division of constituencies for State Assemblies, which follows its own constitutional provisions. Because the freeze was tied to population counts, the timing of the next redrawing has become a central question in the present debate over expanding the Lok Sabha. The question is not only how many seats exist but also how they are spread across regions. This makes the process both technical and politically sensitive, since every change in boundaries affects the candidates and voters in each area.

Q1.

Which Article governs the division of constituencies for State Assemblies?

- (A) Article 81
- (B) Article 332A
- (C) Article 170
- (D) Article 239AA

Q2.

After which two Censuses was no Delimitation Commission formed?

- (A) 1981 and 1991
- (B) 1971 and 1981
- (C) 1991 and 2001
- (D) 2001 and 2011

Q3.

Which amendment extended the seat freeze until the first Census after 2026?

- (A) 73rd Amendment (1992)
- (B) 42nd Amendment (1976)
- (C) 84th Amendment (2002)
- (D) 106th Amendment (2023)

Q4.

Consider the following assertion and reason.

Assertion (A): The President appoints the Delimitation Commission in consultation with the Election Commission.

Reason (R): Article 82 requires Parliament to pass a Delimitation Act after every Census.

- (A) A is true but R is false
- (B) A is false but R is true
- (C) Both A and R are true and R is the correct explanation of A
- (D) Both A and R are true but R is not the correct explanation of A

Q5.

Match List I with List II:

List I	List II
I. Article 82	A. Division of constituencies for State Assemblies
II. Article 170	B. Consultation with the Election Commission
III. 84th Amendment (2002)	C. Parliament to pass a Delimitation Act after every Census
IV. Appointment of the Delimitation Commission	D. Extended the freeze until the first Census after 2026

Rows are two lists side by side, not matched pairs; work out the correct pairing.

- (A) I-D, II-B, III-A, IV-C
- (B) I-C, II-D, III-A, IV-B
- (C) I-C, II-A, III-D, IV-B
- (D) I-D, II-B, III-C, IV-A

Q6.

Consider the following statements about the Delimitation Commission:

- I. The Commission's functions include allocating seats among States.
- II. Commissions have been formed under Acts of 1952, 1962 and 1972 only, with none under a later Act.
- III. Rapid migration has overcrowded some urban constituencies.

Which of the above statements is/are correct?

- (A) I and III only
- (B) II and III only
- (C) I and II only
- (D) I, II and III

Q7.

How many of the following statements about the Delimitation Commission are correct?

- I. A Delimitation Commission was formed under an Act of 1972.
- II. The Commission's decisions are final and not subject to modification by Parliament or State Assemblies.
- III. A Delimitation Commission was formed after the 1981 Census.

- (A) Only one
- (B) Only two
- (C) Only three
- (D) All of the above

Concerns and Consequences: Practice Quiz

The proposed expansion of the Lok Sabha has been debated mainly for its effects on different parts of the country. Supporters of the change argue that a larger House would bring elected representatives closer to the people they serve, making it easier for citizens to raise their problems and seek a response. Critics reply that the benefits are not shared evenly, because the new seat arrangement would affect States differently depending on how their populations have grown over time. Some argue that the population figures used for the exercise may no longer match present conditions, and that the effects could last for many years. Others point to the design of the framework itself and ask how much room the rules leave for choices made at different stages. The discussion has also drawn in committees, public commentary and political parties, each setting out its own view of the reform. Taken together, these views show a debate about how representation, federal balance and effective governance should be weighed against one another. Each side supports its position with a different set of concerns about the design of the change and its likely results in the years ahead. Local perspectives on the issue also vary across regions, and this variation is part of why the debate remains open.

Q1.

Match List I with List II:

List I	List II
I. Decline in legislative deliberation	A. Political weight may influence Finance Commission allocations
II. Fiscal federal concerns	B. MPs handle smaller constituencies and make more efficient use of their development funds
III. Better local development targeting	C. Committee specialisation and policy expertise
IV. Improved parliamentary functioning	D. Reduced speaking time per MP and weaker Question Hour scrutiny

Rows are two lists side by side, not matched pairs; work out the correct pairing.

- (A) I-C, II-D, III-B, IV-A
- (B) I-D, II-B, III-C, IV-A
- (C) I-A, II-D, III-B, IV-C
- (D) I-D, II-A, III-B, IV-C

Q2.

Consider the following statements about the proposed Lok Sabha changes:

- I. Smaller constituencies may improve grievance redressal.
- II. Joint sittings are said to strengthen the Rajya Sabha's federal role.
- III. Expansion may inflate the size of the Executive.

Which of the above statements is/are correct?

- (A) I and II only
- (B) II and III only
- (C) I and III only
- (D) I, II and III

Q3.

How many of the following statements about the proposed Lok Sabha changes are correct?

- I. Economically efficient but less populous States may be disadvantaged in Finance Commission allocations.
- II. Census dependency is one reason women's reservation has been delayed.
- III. Expansion increases the average size of constituencies.

- (A) Only one
- (B) Only two
- (C) Only three
- (D) All of the above

Q4.

Which chamber's federal role is said to be diluted by Lok Sabha dominance in joint sittings?

- (A) Lok Sabha
- (B) State Legislative Assembly
- (C) Rajya Sabha
- (D) Legislative Council

Q5.

Which negative consequence is linked to Parliament's discretion over which population data to use?

- (A) Politicisation of delimitation
- (B) Smaller constituencies
- (C) Higher MPLADS allocation
- (D) Lower Finance Commission transfers

Q6.

What approximate share of Lok Sabha seats is the Southern States' share projected to fall to under the proposed delimitation?

- (A) About 24.3%
- (B) About 14.4%
- (C) About 33.3%
- (D) About 20.7%

Q7.

Consider the following assertion and reason.

Assertion (A): Gerrymandering is identified as a risk in the proposed framework.

Reason (R): Judicial review of the delimitation process has been removed, leaving no court challenge.

- (A) Both A and R are true and R is the correct explanation of A
- (B) Both A and R are true but R is not the correct explanation of A
- (C) A is true but R is false
- (D) A is false but R is true

Constitutional and legal framework: MCQ practice

Census 2027 rests on a set of constitutional and legal provisions. The Union holds the power to conduct a census, and the count is connected with how seats in the Lok Sabha are distributed and how delimitation is handled after 2026. A separate central statute gives the exercise its legal mandate and decides whether residents must take part. The census is managed by a senior official who holds the posts of Registrar General and Census Commissioner of India. Its data also serves as a basis for updating the National Population Register and for preparing a register of citizens across the country. The same count is used for planning healthcare, education and infrastructure. Because it covers the whole population, the census provides a reference point against which other surveys can be measured. Phase I of the census is described as a house listing and housing census, and the exercise as a whole is described as the world's largest fully digital enumeration. The booklet also describes it as the first fully digital census in India. In that sense, the legal and administrative structure behind the count matters for representation, governance and welfare alike, and the framework connects a single national exercise to several different public purposes.

Q1.

On which census's data was Lok Sabha seat allocation frozen under the 84th Constitutional Amendment Act, 2002?

- (A) 1951 Census
- (B) 1961 Census
- (C) 1971 Census
- (D) 1981 Census

Q2.

Until when does that freeze on Lok Sabha seat allocation last?

- (A) Until the first census conducted after 2026
- (B) Until the first census conducted after 1971
- (C) Until the Census Act, 1948 is amended
- (D) Until the next Lok Sabha general election

Q3.

Who is named in the booklet as Registrar General and Census Commissioner of India for Census 2027?

- (A) Vivek Joshi
- (B) Sailesh
- (C) Mritunjay Kumar Narayan
- (D) Ashutosh Shukla

Q4.

Consider the following.

Assertion (A): Articles 81 and 82 relate to Lok Sabha seat distribution and delimitation after 2026.

Reason (R): The Census Act, 1948 provides the legal mandate for the census and makes participation mandatory.

- (A) Both A and R are true and R is the correct explanation of A
- (B) Both A and R are true but R is not the correct explanation of A
- (C) A is true but R is false
- (D) A is false but R is true

Q5.

Match List I with List II:

List I	List II
I. Article 246 and Entry 69	A. Legal mandate and mandatory participation
II. 84th Constitutional Amendment Act, 2002	B. Lok Sabha seat distribution and delimitation after 2026
III. Articles 81 and 82	C. Freeze on Lok Sabha seat allocation
IV. Census Act, 1948	D. Union's power to conduct the census

Rows are two lists side by side, not matched pairs; work out the correct pairing.

- (A) I-C, II-B, III-D, IV-A
- (B) I-D, II-C, III-B, IV-A
- (C) I-D, II-A, III-B, IV-C
- (D) I-C, II-A, III-B, IV-D

Q6.

Consider the following statements about the legal framework.

- I. The Union has power to conduct the census under Article 246 and Entry 69 of the Union List.
- II. Lok Sabha seat allocation is frozen until the first census conducted after 1971.
- III. The Census Act, 1948 makes participation in the census mandatory.

Which of the above statements is/are correct?

- (A) I and II only
- (B) II and III only
- (C) I, II and III
- (D) I and III only

Q7.

How many of the statements below about the legal framework are correct?

- I. Articles 81 and 82 deal with Lok Sabha seat distribution and delimitation after 2026.
 - II. The Registrar General and Census Commissioner of India is Vivek Joshi.
 - III. The 84th Constitutional Amendment Act, 2002 froze seat allocation using 1971 Census data.
- (A) Only one
 - (B) Only two
 - (C) Only three
 - (D) All of the above

Purpose and challenges: MCQ practice

Census 2027 is designed to produce population information that policymakers can use across many areas. Caste is one of the categories for which information is gathered, and the booklet presents caste data as an input for targeting government programmes at marginalised groups. Census data is also used in electoral planning, including the allocation of seats. The exercise is large and is organised in phases, beginning with house listing and a housing census. Officials have to organise fieldwork across the country and coordinate with other agencies. The process also involves

covering areas in the notified States and Union Territories. The exercise is described in the booklet as the world's largest fully digital enumeration, which relies on mobile applications and web-based data collection. The census is also described as a foundation for planning in several sectors, including the design of public services for growing and moving populations. Several practical and public difficulties accompany a count of this size, and the booklet discusses them alongside the purposes of the exercise. The booklet places the census in a long history of population counting, from ancient texts to colonial-era enumerations. Phase I is one step within the larger Census 2027 programme. The exercise is described as the world's largest population count.

Q1.

Which category does the booklet use for limited rural access to digital tools?

- (A) Logistical
- (B) Public trust
- (C) Technological
- (D) Administrative capacity

Q2.

Which two welfare schemes does the booklet name as examples that caste data could help sharpen?

- (A) PM Awas Yojana and Skill India
- (B) Ayushman Bharat and Swachh Bharat
- (C) Jan Dhan and Mudra
- (D) PM Kisan and Ujjwala

Q3.

Match List I with List II:

List I	List II
I. Data classification	A. Funds, staffing and inter-agency coordination
II. Logistical	B. Fears around NPR/NRC linkages
III. Administrative capacity	C. Avoiding duplication and inconsistencies in caste data
IV. Public trust	D. Large-scale training and coverage of remote areas

Rows are two lists side by side, not matched pairs; work out the correct pairing.

- (A) I-C, II-D, III-A, IV-B
- (B) I-B, II-C, III-A, IV-D
- (C) I-A, II-C, III-B, IV-D
- (D) I-A, II-D, III-C, IV-B

Q4.

Consider the following statements about the purposes of Census 2027.

- I. Unlike sample surveys, the census offers comprehensive population data.
- II. The census is used only to count households and does not inform planning.
- III. Demographic data from the census is vital for planning healthcare, education and infrastructure.

Which of the above statements is/are correct?

- (A) I and II only
- (B) II and III only
- (C) I and III only
- (D) I, II and III

Q5.

Of the statements below, how many are correct?

- I. Fears around NPR/NRC linkages are listed as a public trust challenge.
 - II. Census forms are used to prepare the Aadhaar number database.
 - III. The census is considered a reliable benchmark for other surveys.
- (A) Only one
 - (B) Only two
 - (C) Only three
 - (D) All of the above

Q6.

Progress towards which global framework does the booklet say census data advances?

- (A) Millennium Development Goals
- (B) Paris Agreement targets
- (C) Digital India mission targets
- (D) Sustainable Development Goals

Government Response to LWE

Left Wing Extremism refers to armed movements that seek societal and political change through revolutionary methods. Its supporters aim to overthrow the central government through armed revolution and guerrilla warfare, and to establish a communist state based on Maoist principles. The movement is traced to an uprising in 1967. The booklet links it to several factors. Displacement of tribal populations, caused by development projects and mining operations, is one of them. Tribal dissatisfaction with the Forest (Conservation) Act 1980 is another, because that law prohibits tribes from harvesting forest resources. Poverty and a lack of sustainable means also drive people towards the movement, while lack of effective governance and insufficient technical intelligence are listed as further factors. The booklet describes a Red Corridor of states where the movement has been most severe. The government's response has several strands. It has adopted a national policy and action plan, and it works through a doctrine called SAMADHAN, which is built from a set of elements that guide operations. Development programmes for tribal regions form another strand, and these include the Dharti Aaba Janjatiya Gram Utkarsh Abhiyan, PM-JANMAN and the Van Dhan Vikas Kendra. The government set 31 March 2026 as the deadline to eliminate Left Wing Extremism, and India has since been declared Naxal-Free.

Q1.

The National Policy and Action Plan to address Left Wing Extremism is dated to which year?

- (A) 2006
- (B) 2010
- (C) 2015
- (D) 2026

Q2.

In the SAMADHAN doctrine, what does the letter M stand for?

- (A) Motivation and Training
- (B) Mobile Units
- (C) Military Command
- (D) Mining Control

Q3.

What does the Van Dhan Vikas Kendra promote?

- (A) Value addition to minor forest produce
- (B) Honey production
- (C) Handloom weaving
- (D) Solar power installation

Q4.

Match List I with List II:

List I	List II
I. Van Dhan Vikas Kendra	A. Local recruits who know the language and terrain
II. PM-JANMAN	B. Value addition to minor forest produce
III. Bastariya Battalion	C. Framework of the national response to Left Wing Extremism
IV. National Policy and Action Plan	D. Basic infrastructure and healthcare in remote habitations

Rows are two lists side by side, not matched pairs; work out the correct pairing.

- (A) I-C, II-A, III-B, IV-D
- (B) I-C, II-D, III-A, IV-B
- (C) I-A, II-D, III-B, IV-C
- (D) I-B, II-D, III-A, IV-C

Q5.

Consider the following statements about the Bandyopadhyay Committee and SAMADHAN:

- I. The Bandyopadhyay Committee recommended tribal-friendly land acquisition and rehabilitation.
- II. Bastariya Battalion is based in Jharkhand.
- III. In SAMADHAN, N stands for No access to Financing.

Which of the above statements is/are correct?

- (A) I and II only
- (B) II and III only
- (C) I and III only
- (D) I, II and III

Q6.

Consider the following statements about the SAMADHAN doctrine and PM-JANMAN:

- I. PM-JANMAN targets 75 PVTGs.
- II. The D in SAMADHAN stands for Development of tribal villages.
- III. The H in SAMADHAN stands for Harnessing Technology.

How many of the above statements are correct?

- (A) Only one
- (B) Only two
- (C) Only three
- (D) All of the above

UCC Background: MCQ Practice

Gujarat has passed the Uniform Civil Code Bill 2026, becoming the second state after Uttarakhand to enact such a code. The need for a uniform law was first considered during the colonial period, and the question has been debated in different forms ever since. Personal laws govern matters such as marriage, divorce and succession, and the Gujarat code aims to replace diverse religious personal laws on these matters. The Constitution contains a provision that urges the state to establish a uniform civil code for all citizens. Historically, the adoption of such a code has been controversial. The Law Commission has revived the idea in recent years and has gathered public views on it. Uttarakhand's code incorporates elements from existing laws but leaves out certain concepts found in other personal laws. The Supreme Court has also called for implementing a uniform code in many cases. The Gujarat law also seeks to ensure equal inheritance rights for sons and daughters, and its monogamy rule prohibits polygamy and bigamy. The booklet notes that the code is a progressive reform, but that it risks deepening societal divisions in the context of upcoming elections, where justice should take precedence over the pursuit of uniformity.

Q1.

Under which Article does the Constitution urge the state to establish a uniform civil code?

- (A) Article 25
- (B) Article 368
- (C) Article 371
- (D) Article 44

Q2.

In 1948, who was chosen to chair the sub-committee developing the Hindu Code Bill?

- (A) Sardar Vallabhbhai Patel
- (B) C. Rajagopalachari
- (C) Dr. B. R. Ambedkar
- (D) B. N. Rau

Q3.

The Hindu Succession Act, 1956 codified intestate succession among which communities?

- (A) Hindus only
- (B) Hindus, Buddhists, Jains and Sikhs
- (C) Hindus, Christians and Parsis
- (D) Hindus and Muslims

Q4.

Assertion (A): The provision urging a uniform civil code can be enforced by courts against the state.

Reason (R): That provision is part of the Directive Principles of State Policy, which are not enforceable.

- (A) Both A and R are true and R is the correct explanation of A
- (B) Both A and R are true but R is not the correct explanation of A
- (C) A is true but R is false
- (D) A is false but R is true

Q5.

Match List I with List II:

List I	List II
I. Lex Loci Report	A. 1956
II. B N Rau Committee	B. 1840
III. Hindu Succession Act	C. 1948
IV. Sub-committee for the Hindu Code Bill	D. 1941

Rows are two lists side by side, not matched pairs; work out the correct pairing.

- (A) I-B, II-D, III-A, IV-C
- (B) I-C, II-D, III-B, IV-A
- (C) I-D, II-C, III-B, IV-A
- (D) I-D, II-A, III-B, IV-C

Q6.

I. The principle underlying a UCC is that laws should be gender-neutral and religion-neutral.

II. Personal laws on marriage, divorce and succession are placed in the Concurrent List.

III. The B N Rau Committee was formed by the Constituent Assembly in 1941.

Which of the above statements is/are correct?

- (A) II and III only
- (B) I and III only
- (C) III only
- (D) I and II only

Q7.

- I. Article 44 is part of the Directive Principles of State Policy.
- II. Personal laws on marriage, divorce and succession fall under the Concurrent List.
- III. The principle of the UCC is that laws should be religion-based.

Which option gives the number of correct statements above?

- (A) Only two
- (B) Only one
- (C) Only three
- (D) All of the above

UCC Arguments: MCQ Practice

Supporters present the Uniform Civil Code as a progressive goal, and the Gujarat Bill is part of that case. The Gujarat law seeks to replace diverse personal laws on marriage, divorce and inheritance with a single civil framework that applies across the state. The Gujarat Bill follows Uttarakhand, which was the first state after pre-Independence Goa to adopt such a code.

The case for the code rests on the idea that personal laws should not lead to unequal treatment of citizens in family life. Supporters also say the code can address unfair treatment within families, and that a common law would let citizens rely on the same rules in family matters, whatever their background.

The Central Government has described different property and matrimonial laws for different communities as a threat to the nation's unity, and it has favoured a common code. The Constitution also contains a provision that urges the state to work towards such a code, so the idea has a constitutional basis.

Critics, however, have raised concerns about the code's effect on individual freedoms in matters of faith. The booklet notes that the subject carries risks in the context of upcoming elections, and it argues that justice should come before uniformity.

Q1.

The UCC is presented as a way to align the law with which feature of the Indian state?

- (A) Federal structure
- (B) Preservation of the Concurrent List
- (C) Expansion of the Directive Principles
- (D) Secular nature

Q2.

Critics argue that a UCC goes against the right to freedom of religion guaranteed under which Articles?

- (A) Articles 14-18
- (B) Article 13
- (C) Articles 25-28
- (D) Article 44

Q3.

- I. The UCC is presented as a means to eliminate discriminatory practices against women.
- II. Critics note that some civil laws are inseparably connected with religious beliefs and practices.
- III. The UCC is expected to fully accommodate the unique customs of every community.

Which of the above statements is/are correct?

- (A) I and III only
- (B) I and II only
- (C) II and III only
- (D) I, II and III

Q4.

- I. Supporters see the UCC as a step towards gender equality.
- II. Critics fear that the UCC could be politically exploited.
- III. The UCC is presented as a means to promote a religion-specific civil code.

Which option gives the number of correct statements above?

- (A) Only one
- (B) Only three
- (C) Only two
- (D) All of the above

Q5.

The UCC is presented as a way to reform which kind of practices?

- (A) Outdated and regressive practices
- (B) Electoral practices
- (C) Tribal land practices
- (D) Civil service practices

Q6.

Critics say a UCC might not adequately accommodate what of different communities?

- (A) Customs and sensitivities
- (B) Constitutional amendment procedures
- (C) Fiscal arrangements
- (D) Judicial appointments

Q7.

Assertion (A): Critics argue that implementation of a UCC could be politically exploited.

Reason (R): Supporters argue that a UCC promotes gender equality.

- (A) Both A and R are true and R is the correct explanation of A
- (B) Both A and R are true but R is not the correct explanation of A
- (C) A is true but R is false
- (D) A is false but R is true

Legal framework: MCQ practice

The Mahanadi dispute between Odisha and Chhattisgarh concerns how the river's water is shared, especially in the non-monsoon season, when water flowing downstream becomes critically important. The absence of a formal inter-state water-sharing agreement has added to the conflict, and Odisha has argued that upstream construction in Chhattisgarh has reduced the flow reaching its own territory. Chhattisgarh, for its part, maintains that it has a legitimate right to use river waters and that its projects serve regional development.

Such disputes are handled through a separate arrangement. The Constitution provides for them, and the law built on it allows a tribunal to be set up when a dispute needs adjudication. The tribunal then issues its decision, and the matter is decided on the basis of available evidence and legal principles.

The Mahanadi tribunal has expressed concern about repeated adjournments and the lack of substantive progress in talks. It has observed that no concrete proposals have been placed on record, despite assurances of settlement efforts. The tribunal has therefore given both states a final opportunity to agree on a formula.

Other river disputes in the country have also been handled through tribunals, each set up for a particular river. Read together, these cases show that water sharing between states is governed by a special framework rather than by routine legal channels.

Q1.

When a state approaches the Centre seeking a tribunal, what does the Centre first do?

- (A) Consults the aggrieved states
- (B) Constitutes a tribunal at once
- (C) Refers the matter to the Supreme Court
- (D) Transfers the dispute to a River Board

Q2.

How often must a River Board meet under the River Boards Act, 1956?

- (A) Once a year
- (B) Twice a year
- (C) At least thrice a year
- (D) Once every five years

Q3.

Entry 56 of which list empowers the Union to regulate and develop inter-state rivers in public interest?

- (A) State List
- (B) Concurrent List
- (C) Union List
- (D) Central List

Q4.

Assertion (A): The Supreme Court cannot question the award or formula given by an inter-state water tribunal.

Reason (R): The Supreme Court can question the working of such a tribunal.

- (A) Both A and R are true and R is the correct explanation of A
- (B) Both A and R are true but R is not the correct explanation of A
- (C) A is true but R is false
- (D) A is false but R is true

Q5.

Match List I with List II:

List I	List II
I. Article 262	A. Boards for inter-state rivers set up in consultation with states
II. River Boards Act, 1956	B. Regulation and development of inter-state rivers in public interest
III. Entry 17 (State List)	C. Parliament adjudicates disputes relating to inter-state rivers
IV. Entry 56 (Union List)	D. Water supplies, irrigation, canals, drainage and embankments

Rows are two lists side by side, not matched pairs; work out the correct pairing.

- (A) I-D, II-C, III-B, IV-A
- (B) I-A, II-B, III-D, IV-C
- (C) I-A, II-D, III-B, IV-C
- (D) I-C, II-A, III-D, IV-B

Q6.

Consider the following statements:

- I. Entry 17 of the State List covers irrigation and drainage.
- II. Article 262 allows Parliament to exclude courts' jurisdiction in inter-state river disputes.
- III. The Supreme Court may set aside the award of a tribunal.

Which of the above statements is/are correct?

- (A) II and III only
- (B) I and III only
- (C) I only
- (D) I and II only

Q7.

Consider the following statements:

- I. A River Board must meet at least thrice a year.
- II. Entry 56 lies in the State List.
- III. Consultation among aggrieved states comes before a tribunal is constituted.

How many of the statements given above are correct?

- (A) Only two
- (B) Only one
- (C) Only three
- (D) All of the above

River course: MCQ practice

The Mahanadi is at the centre of a long-running dispute because its water supports many activities along its course. Downstream areas rely on the river for irrigation, drinking water, fisheries and the wider ecology of the area. When flow declines, these uses come under strain, and the concern becomes most acute during the non-monsoon season.

The river is fed by a network of tributaries that join it along its length. Its waters therefore reflect conditions across a large catchment, and activities in upstream areas can affect what reaches the lower reaches. Upstream construction is one such activity, and it has been cited as a reason for falling downstream flow. Water reaching any point along the river thus depends on conditions upstream.

Large infrastructure also lies on the river. Among these works is a dam that has been a major point of attention in discussions of the river. The presence of such structures makes it harder to assess the river's flow without reliable information. Such works are discussed in relation to the river's flow and its sharing among states.

The booklet includes a map of the river, which helps readers follow its path through the region. Its course is described in a short section that covers the river's main features. The booklet's summary is brief, so the map and text together give a basic picture of the river.

Q1.

Where does the Mahanadi originate?

- (A) Amarkantak Hills, Madhya Pradesh
- (B) Satpura Range, Maharashtra
- (C) Sihawa Hill, Raipur, Chhattisgarh
- (D) Vindhya Hills, Uttar Pradesh

Q2.

Into which water body does the Mahanadi finally empty?

- (A) Arabian Sea
- (B) Gulf of Mannar
- (C) Bay of Bengal
- (D) Gulf of Kutch

Q3.

Which set of tributaries joins the Mahanadi from its right bank?

- (A) Shivrath, Hasdeo, Mand and Ib
- (B) Ib, Jonk, Shivrath and Ong
- (C) Hasdeo, Ong, Mand and Tel
- (D) Jonk, Ong and Tel

Q4.

Assertion (A): The Mahanadi originates in Odisha.

Reason (R): The river flows through Odisha before emptying into the Bay of Bengal.

- (A) Both A and R are true and R is the correct explanation of A
- (B) Both A and R are true but R is not the correct explanation of A
- (C) A is true but R is false
- (D) A is false but R is true

Q5.

Which left-bank tributary of the Mahanadi is listed last?

- (A) Shivrath
- (B) Hasdeo
- (C) Ib
- (D) Mand

Q6.

Consider the following statements:

- I. Tel is a right bank tributary of the Mahanadi.
- II. Mand is a right bank tributary of the Mahanadi.
- III. The Mahanadi empties into the Arabian Sea.

Which of the above statements is/are correct?

- (A) I only
- (B) I and II only
- (C) II and III only
- (D) I, II and III

Q7.

Consider the following statements:

- I. Ib is a left bank tributary of the Mahanadi.
- II. Jonk is a left bank tributary of the Mahanadi.
- III. The river empties into the Gulf of Kutch.

How many of the statements given above are correct?

- (A) All of the above
- (B) Only two
- (C) Only three
- (D) Only one

Other tribunals: MCQ practice

India has several inter-state water tribunals, and each one has been set up for a particular river dispute. The booklet lists tribunals formed at different points over the years, and each entry links a tribunal to the states involved in that dispute. Several states appear in more than one tribunal, so

disputes over different rivers can involve the same state.

The Mahanadi tribunal is one of the bodies in the table. It was set up to resolve the sharing of the Mahanadi's waters between the two states along the river. The tribunal has been dissatisfied with repeated adjournments and a lack of progress, and it has granted both states a final opportunity to reach a formula.

The booklet presents the tribunals in a table with three columns: the name of each tribunal, its year of formation, and the states involved. The table covers five tribunals in total. Each entry records the name, the year and the states, so the table gives a compact summary of the disputes it covers.

Taken together, these entries show that India has used separate tribunals for separate rivers, each tied to its own set of states. The table is part of a wider discussion in the booklet about inter-state river disputes and the legal framework for resolving them.

Q1.

In which year was the Krishna Water Disputes Tribunal II formed?

- (A) 1986
- (B) 2004
- (C) 2010
- (D) 2016

Q2.

How many states are involved in the Ravi & Beas Water Tribunal?

- (A) 2
- (B) 4
- (C) 3
- (D) 5

Q3.

Which tribunal includes Telangana among the states involved?

- (A) Krishna Water Disputes Tribunal II
- (B) Mahadayi Water Disputes Tribunal
- (C) Vansadhara Water Disputes Tribunal
- (D) Ravi & Beas Water Tribunal

Q4.

Assertion (A): Karnataka is a party to the Vansadhara Water Disputes Tribunal.

Reason (R): Karnataka is one of the states in the Mahadayi Water Disputes Tribunal.

- (A) Both A and R are true and R is the correct explanation of A
- (B) Both A and R are true but R is not the correct explanation of A
- (C) A is true but R is false
- (D) A is false but R is true

Q5.

Match List I with List II:

List I	List II
I. Ravi & Beas Water Tribunal	A. Odisha and Andhra Pradesh
II. Mahadayi Water Disputes Tribunal	B. Rajasthan, Haryana and Punjab
III. Vansadhara Water Disputes Tribunal	C. Andhra Pradesh, Maharashtra, Telangana and Karnataka
IV. Krishna Water Disputes Tribunal II	D. Karnataka, Goa and Maharashtra

Rows are two lists side by side, not matched pairs; work out the correct pairing.

- (A) I-D, II-C, III-B, IV-A
- (B) I-D, II-A, III-C, IV-B
- (C) I-D, II-B, III-A, IV-C
- (D) I-B, II-D, III-A, IV-C

Q6.

Consider the following statements:

- I. The Vansadhara Water Disputes Tribunal was formed in 2010.
- II. The Ravi & Beas Water Tribunal involves Punjab.
- III. The Krishna Water Disputes Tribunal II involves Odisha.

Which of the above statements is/are correct?

- (A) I only
- (B) I and II only
- (C) II and III only
- (D) I, II and III

Q7.

Consider the following statements:

- I. The Mahadayi Water Disputes Tribunal was formed in 2010.
- II. The Krishna Water Disputes Tribunal II involves four states.
- III. The Mahanadi Water Disputes Tribunal involves Punjab.

How many of the statements given above are correct?

- (A) Only one
- (B) Only three
- (C) Only two
- (D) All of the above

Event details of National Panchayati Raj Day

National Panchayati Raj Day is an occasion to reflect on local self-government in India. The day marks the enforcement of a constitutional amendment that was aimed at strengthening grassroots democracy and decentralised governance. The bill for this amendment was introduced in the Lok Sabha in September 1991, when a Congress government was in office. The amendment is described as having several important effects. Inclusive development ensures the participation of marginalised groups in local decisions. Localised planning promotes need-based development in villages and districts. Digital transformation is also listed among its significant effects. The amendment added a new Part to the Constitution, titled The Panchayats, and a new schedule that lists subjects for panchayats. It provides for a three-tier structure of panchayats at the village, intermediate and district levels. The amendment also provides that a state with a population not exceeding twenty lakh may skip the intermediate level of panchayats. It also provides for reservation of seats for Scheduled Castes and Scheduled Tribes. Madhya Pradesh was the first state to implement the amendment. The amendment's provisions are set out in Articles 243 to 243-O of the Constitution. Its provisions also deal with the term of panchayats, their finances and

the conduct of their elections. Panchayats are the basic units through which these goals are pursued.

Q1.

Which ministry organised the 17th National Panchayati Raj Day?

- (A) Ministry of Rural Development
- (B) Ministry of Panchayati Raj
- (C) Ministry of Home Affairs
- (D) NITI Aayog

Q2.

Which index measures grassroots development and tracks panchayat performance?

- (A) National Panchayat Awards
- (B) e-GramSwaraj
- (C) Panchayat Advancement Index 2.0
- (D) Panchayat Dharohar Initiative

Q3.

What is e-GramSwaraj used for, according to the booklet?

- (A) Transparent monitoring and data-driven governance
- (B) Collection of panchayat taxes
- (C) Election of panchayat members
- (D) Reservation of seats for women

Q4.

Assertion (A): The National Panchayat Awards recognise best-performing panchayats.

Reason (R): Panchayat Advancement Index 2.0 measures grassroots development and tracks panchayat performance.

- (A) Both A and R are true and R is the correct explanation of A
- (B) Both A and R are true but R is not the correct explanation of A
- (C) A is true but R is false
- (D) A is false but R is true

Q5.

Match List I with List II:

List I	List II
I. National Panchayat Awards	A. Sashakt Panchayat, Sarvangeen Vikas
II. Panchayat Advancement Index 2.0	B. Transparent monitoring and data-driven governance
III. e-GramSwaraj	C. Measures grassroots development and tracks panchayat performance
IV. Theme of the 17th National Panchayati Raj Day	D. Recognises best-performing panchayats

Rows are two lists side by side, not matched pairs; work out the correct pairing.

- (A) I-B, II-A, III-C, IV-D
- (B) I-C, II-D, III-B, IV-A
- (C) I-D, II-C, III-B, IV-A
- (D) I-C, II-B, III-D, IV-A

Q6.

Read the statements about the 17th National Panchayati Raj Day:

- I. The event was held at Vigyan Bhawan.
- II. e-GramSwaraj is used for transparent monitoring and data-driven governance.
- III. The theme of the day was 'Gram Swaraj, Viksit Bharat'.

Which of the above statements is/are correct?

- (A) I and II only
- (B) I and III only
- (C) II and III only
- (D) I, II and III

Q7.

Examine the statements below about the 17th National Panchayati Raj Day.

- I. The event was observed in 2026.
- II. The Ministry of Panchayati Raj organised the day.
- III. The theme of the day was 'Viksit Panchayat, Samridh Bharat'.

How many of the statements are correct?

- (A) Only one
- (B) Only three
- (C) All of the above
- (D) Only two

Elections, reservation and oversight in panchayats

Panchayati Raj institutions are the system of local self-government that the amendment established in rural areas. The amendment added a new Part to the Constitution, titled The Panchayats, and its provisions are set out in Articles 243 to 243-O. Under this framework, panchayats function at three levels, namely the village, intermediate and district levels. The framework also provides for reservation of seats for women, so that women hold a set share of seats and offices in panchayats at each level. A panchayat can be dissolved before it completes its period, and when this happens fresh elections are needed to constitute a new panchayat. Such elections must be completed within a set period, and where the remaining period is short, an election need not be held. The amendment also added an 11th Schedule that lists subjects for panchayats. The bill for it was introduced in the Lok Sabha in September 1991 under a Congress government. The amendment's significance is described in three heads: inclusive development, which ensures the participation of marginalised groups; localised planning, which promotes need-based development; and digital transformation. Madhya Pradesh was the first state to implement the amendment. The framework was built to strengthen grassroots democracy and decentralised governance.

Q1.

Not less than what share of the total seats in panchayats is reserved for women?

- (A) One-fourth
- (B) One-third
- (C) One-half
- (D) Two-fifths

Q2.

Within what period after a panchayat is dissolved must fresh elections be completed?

- (A) Three months
- (B) Nine months
- (C) Six months
- (D) Twelve months

Q3.

The chairperson of a panchayat at which level is elected in the manner the State Legislature determines?

- (A) Village
- (B) Intermediate
- (C) District
- (D) All three levels

Q4.

Assertion (A): Chairpersons at the intermediate and district levels of panchayats are elected indirectly.

Reason (R): They are elected by and from amongst the elected members.

- (A) A is true but R is false
- (B) A is false but R is true
- (C) Both A and R are true but R is not the correct explanation of A
- (D) Both A and R are true and R is the correct explanation of A

Q5.

Match List I with List II:

List I	List II
I. State Election Commission	A. Five years, unless dissolved earlier
II. Finance Commission	B. Not applicable in Arunachal Pradesh
III. Seat reservation for Scheduled Castes	C. Supervises electoral rolls and the conduct of panchayat elections
IV. Duration of a panchayat	D. Reviews panchayat finances

Rows are two lists side by side, not matched pairs; work out the correct pairing.

- (A) I-C, II-A, III-D, IV-B
- (B) I-C, II-D, III-B, IV-A
- (C) I-C, II-A, III-B, IV-D
- (D) I-A, II-C, III-B, IV-D

Q6.

Read the statements about panchayat elections and reservation:

- I. All members of panchayats at the village, intermediate and district levels are elected directly.
- II. Seats are reserved for Scheduled Castes and Scheduled Tribes in proportion to their population.
- III. Chairpersons at the intermediate level are appointed by the State Government.

Which of the above statements is/are correct?

- (A) II and III only
- (B) I and III only
- (C) I and II only
- (D) I, II and III

Q7.

Examine the statements below about panchayat reservation and terms.

- I. Not less than one-third of seats are reserved for women.
- II. Reservation of seats for Scheduled Castes is not applicable to Arunachal Pradesh.
- III. Fresh elections may be held up to twelve months after dissolution.

How many of the statements are correct?

- (A) Only one
- (B) Only two
- (C) Only three
- (D) All of the above

Exemptions, Union Territories and PESA

The Constitution's panchayat provisions do not apply uniformly to every part of India. Certain states and areas are exempted from the framework, and the amendment's rules set out these exemptions directly. These exemptions cover some states as well as some areas within other states. The framework was added as a new Part titled The Panchayats, consisting of provisions from Articles 243 to 243-O. Its provisions give panchayats a three-tier structure at the village, intermediate and district levels, and they provide for elections and for reservation of seats. The amendment also provides that a state with a population not exceeding twenty lakh may skip the intermediate level of panchayats. The amendment's significance is described under three heads: inclusive development, localised planning and digital transformation. The amendment also added an 11th Schedule that lists subjects for panchayats. Madhya Pradesh was the first state to implement it, and the bill was introduced in the Lok Sabha in September 1991 under a Congress government. Its provisions also deal with the duration of panchayats and their finances. The provisions are meant to strengthen grassroots democracy and decentralised governance. Each of these features forms part of the framework described above.

Q1.

Which Union Territory is excluded from the application of the panchayat provisions?

- (A) Puducherry
- (B) Ladakh
- (C) Delhi
- (D) Jammu and Kashmir

Q2.

Which Act, enacted under Article 243-M, is popularly known as the PESA Act?

- (A) Provisions of the Panchayats (Extension to the Scheduled Areas) Act, 1996
- (B) Panchayats (Extension to Tribal Areas) Act, 1993
- (C) Panchayati Raj (Scheduled Areas) Act, 1992
- (D) Tribal Panchayats Act, 1996

Q3.

Which of the following is NOT listed in the booklet as a Sixth Schedule state?

- (A) Assam
- (B) Tripura
- (C) Mizoram
- (D) Sikkim

Q4.

Assertion (A): The PESA Act, 1996 does not apply to Sixth Schedule areas.

Reason (R): The PESA Act, 1996 was enacted under Article 243-M.

- (A) Both A and R are true, and R is not the correct explanation of A
- (B) A is true but R is false
- (C) Both A and R are true, and R correctly explains A
- (D) A is false but R is true

Q5.

Match List I with List II:

List I	List II
I. Article 243-L	A. District Councils exist there
II. PESA Act, 1996	B. Enables the President to extend Part IX to Union Territories
III. Darjeeling district	C. Enacted under Article 243-M
IV. Hill Areas of Manipur	D. Darjeeling Gorkha Hill Council exists there

Rows are two lists side by side, not matched pairs; work out the correct pairing.

- (A) I-D, II-B, III-A, IV-C
- (B) I-B, II-C, III-D, IV-A
- (C) I-C, II-B, III-D, IV-A
- (D) I-C, II-D, III-A, IV-B

Q6.

Read the statements about the exemptions and the framework:

- I. Part IX applies to Union Territories subject to exceptions the President may specify.
- II. Nagaland, Meghalaya and Mizoram are exempted from the provisions.
- III. The PESA Act, 1996 was enacted under Article 243-L.

Which of the above statements is/are correct?

- (A) I and III only
- (B) II and III only
- (C) I, II and III
- (D) I and II only

Q7.

Examine the statements below about exemptions.

- I. Scheduled Areas in Fifth and Sixth Schedule states are exempted.
- II. Darjeeling district is exempted because the Darjeeling Gorkha Hill Council exists.
- III. Assam is not a Sixth Schedule state.

How many of the statements are correct?

- (A) Only one
- (B) Only two
- (C) Only three
- (D) All of the above

Repo Rate and the Economy: Practice Set

The Reserve Bank of India is the central bank responsible for managing the country's financial system. Its roles include acting as the monetary authority, lender of last resort, banker to the government and custodian of foreign exchange reserves, and it aims to maintain price stability while promoting economic growth. Its supervisory role covers issuing bank licences and inspecting commercial banks. The Repo Rate is one of the main instruments of monetary policy used by the RBI. Because it governs the cost at which money moves between the central bank and commercial banks, changes to it affect banks and borrowers across the economy. The rate is decided by the Monetary Policy Committee, which must meet at least four times each year and takes its decisions by majority vote. Recently, the Committee chose to keep the policy rate steady as tensions in West Asia rose. These tensions have made global energy prices and trade flows more volatile, and India is experiencing a supply-side shock linked to global energy and commodity markets. Such shocks can raise input costs and prices even without excess domestic demand. Retail inflation has stayed within the mandated target band, and core inflation, which excludes food and fuel, has remained stable. The overall stance is described as cautious and steady.

Q1.

In December 2025, by how many basis points did the RBI cut the Repo Rate?

- (A) 15 basis points
- (B) 25 basis points
- (C) 50 basis points
- (D) 75 basis points

Q2.

What was the total reduction in the Repo Rate by the RBI during 2025, in basis points?

- (A) 75
- (B) 100
- (C) 150
- (D) 125

Q3.

According to the booklet, a higher Repo Rate slows which two things in the economy?

- (A) Investment and money supply
- (B) Government revenue and exports
- (C) Foreign reserves and gold holdings
- (D) Tax collection and employment

Q4.

Assertion (A): Lowering the Repo Rate tends to increase borrowing and spending in the economy.

Reason (R): A lower Repo Rate makes loans cheaper for banks and lowers interest rates for borrowers.

- (A) A is true but R is false
- (B) Both A and R are true, but R is not the correct explanation of A
- (C) Both A and R are true and R is the correct explanation of A
- (D) A is false but R is true

Q5.

Match List I with List II:

List I	List II
I. Higher Repo Rate	A. Increases overall supply of money
II. Lower Repo Rate	B. Lowers the Repo Rate
III. RBI's response to high inflation	C. Curbs excessive spending
IV. RBI needs to pump funds into the economy	D. Raises the Repo Rate

Rows are two lists side by side, not matched pairs; work out the correct pairing.

- (A) I-B, II-C, III-A, IV-D
- (B) I-C, II-A, III-D, IV-B
- (C) I-A, II-B, III-D, IV-C
- (D) I-C, II-B, III-D, IV-A

Q6.

Consider the following statements:

- I. The Repo Rate is the rate at which the RBI lends money to commercial banks.
- II. A higher Repo Rate makes loans cheaper for commercial banks.
- III. The Repo Rate is set by the Monetary Policy Committee.

Which of the above statements is/are correct?

- (A) I and II only
- (B) II and III only
- (C) I, II and III
- (D) I and III only

Q7.

Consider the following statements:

- I. Repo stands for 'Repurchasing Option' or 'Repurchase Agreement'.
- II. The December 2025 cut was the second reduction by the RBI.
- III. A lower Repo Rate makes loans costlier for banks.

How many of the above statements are correct?

- (A) Only one
- (B) Only two
- (C) Only three
- (D) All of the above

MC14 Disputes, Farm and Fisheries Talks

The 14th Ministerial Conference of the World Trade Organization was held in Yaoundé, Cameroon, and it ended without consensus. The disagreement reflected a deep North-South divide among members. Several agendas were left unresolved, and the matters that could not be settled were passed on to a later meeting.

The WTO's mandate covers trade in goods, services and intellectual property. Its Ministerial Conference is the highest decision-making body and is made up of trade ministers and senior officials from member nations. It addresses global trade developments. WTO decisions are traditionally sought through agreement among all members.

One of the agendas before the conference was the reform of the WTO's dispute settlement system, which helps resolve trade disputes among members. The reform was among the agendas that remained contested.

Agriculture and food security formed another contested agenda. Food security was treated as a central concern, and positions on the topic differed among members. The discussions reflected the concerns of several countries, including developing ones.

Fisheries was a third agenda. The negotiations dealt with subsidies given to fishing, and members discussed the limits that might apply to them. Some questions on fisheries subsidies were not finished when the conference closed, and the talks were set to continue.

Q1.

Which kind of dispute settlement system is the reform meant to restore?

- (A) Single-tier advisory system
- (B) Two-tier binding system
- (C) Three-tier arbitration system
- (D) Unilateral trade penalty system

Q2.

Where were the key issues left unresolved at MC14 deferred to?

- (A) Yaoundé, Cameroon
- (B) Abu Dhabi, UAE
- (C) Buenos Aires, Argentina
- (D) Geneva, Switzerland

Q3.

On expanding flexibilities for public stockholding (PSH), where do developed countries stand?

- (A) They have already eliminated the flexibilities
- (B) They are eager to expand the flexibilities
- (C) They remain reluctant to expand the flexibilities
- (D) They have referred the matter to a dispute panel

Q4.

Assertion (A): The fisheries talks target a ban on harmful subsidies.

Reason (R): The fisheries talks have already completed such a ban at MC14.

- (A) A is true, but R is false
- (B) Both A and R are true, and R is the correct explanation of A
- (C) Both A and R are true, but R is not the correct explanation of A
- (D) A is false, but R is true

Q5.

Match List I with List II:

List I	List II
I. India and African nations	A. Reducing trade-distorting subsidies
II. Developing countries	B. Permanent solution for public stockholding
III. Agriculture talks	C. Continued negotiations on curbing subsidies
IV. Distant-water fishing fleets	D. Climate-related disruptions

Rows are two lists side by side, not matched pairs; work out the correct pairing.

- (A) I-A, II-D, III-B, IV-C
- (B) I-B, II-D, III-A, IV-C
- (C) I-A, II-C, III-D, IV-B
- (D) I-D, II-C, III-B, IV-A

Q6.

Consider the following statements:

- I. Market access is described as crucial for developing countries like India.
- II. Developed countries have already agreed to expand PSH flexibilities.
- III. The key issues include flexibility for domestic food subsidies and protection against penalties under WTO rules.

Which of the above statements is/are correct?

- (A) I and II only
- (B) I and III only
- (C) II and III only
- (D) I, II and III

Investment Facilitation Agreement Debate

The Investment Facilitation for Development Agreement is one of the WTO's most debated pacts, and its place within the organisation has been contested. Supporters see it as part of a wider shift in the WTO toward plurilateralism. The debate also reflects how investment is governed globally, and the arrangement moves toward standardised investment rules. The agreement is discussed in relation to a balance between investment facilitation and national sovereignty. A concern raised in the debate is that the agreement could dilute core WTO principles and expand the organisation's mandate beyond trade facilitation. Members at different stages of development have a stake in this discussion. The discussion also involves how far investment rules should bind members, and which subjects fall within the WTO's remit. These questions are central to the debate. The WTO's mandate covers trade in goods, services and intellectual property, and the organisation provides a framework for reducing trade restrictions such as tariffs and quotas. It also oversees mechanisms

for resolving trade disputes among members. The Ministerial Conference is the highest decision-making body of the WTO and is made up of trade ministers and senior officials from member nations.

Q1.

How many of the following statements are correct?

- I. The IFD Agreement was launched at MC11 in Buenos Aires.
 - II. The IFD Agreement excludes investor-state dispute settlement.
 - III. The IFD Agreement is based on the principle of reciprocity.
- (A) Only one
 - (B) Only two
 - (C) Only three
 - (D) All of the above

Q2.

Consider the following statements:

- I. The IFD Agreement covers investment facilitation, including procedures, approvals and transparency.
- II. The IFD Agreement includes market access commitments.
- III. The appeal mechanism of the IFD Agreement requires independent tribunals for dispute review.

Which of the above statements is/are correct?

- (A) I only
- (B) I and II only
- (C) I and III only
- (D) II and III only

Q3.

For which group of countries does the IFD's facilitation of foreign direct investment particularly focus?

- (A) Developed countries only
- (B) Island nations of the Pacific
- (C) Members of the European Union
- (D) Developing and least developed countries

Q4.

What is the stated objective of the IFD Agreement?

- (A) To liberalise market access for goods
- (B) To make investment procedures transparent, efficient and predictable
- (C) To protect investors against expropriation
- (D) To replace all bilateral investment treaties

Q5.

Which of the following is excluded from the scope of the IFD Agreement?

- (A) Procedures and approvals
- (B) Transparency of investment rules
- (C) Government procurement
- (D) Investment facilitation

Q6.

Match List I with List II:

List I	List II
I. Firewall clause	A. Most-Favoured-Nation principle
II. Appeal mechanism	B. Under a Joint Statement Initiative at MC11
III. Launch	C. Prevents IFD rules from overriding BITs
IV. Basis of the agreement	D. Requires independent tribunals for dispute review

Rows are two lists side by side, not matched pairs; work out the correct pairing.

- (A) I-B, II-D, III-A, IV-C
- (B) I-A, II-B, III-C, IV-D
- (C) I-C, II-D, III-B, IV-A
- (D) I-B, II-C, III-D, IV-A

Most Polluted Places in the 2025 Report

The World Air Quality Report 2025 was prepared by IQAir, a Swiss company that measures air quality. Its assessments are based on PM2.5, which refers to fine particulate matter measured in micrograms per cubic metre ($\mu\text{g}/\text{m}^3$). The report compares measured concentrations with the air quality guidelines set by the World Health Organisation. The findings are presented as lists of countries, cities and regions, arranged according to how polluted each place is. Each figure is an annual average, so the rankings reflect typical air over a full year rather than a single day. Such lists help readers see at a glance which places have the highest pollution levels. Among countries, the list begins with one nation whose annual PM2.5 level is many times the WHO limit, and several other nations follow it in the ranking. Among cities, the top of the list is a city located in India. The report also notes that many countries fail to meet safe air quality standards, so the problem is widespread rather than confined to a few places. The report also tracks national capitals and regions. One capital has appeared repeatedly at the top of the capitals list, and the regional comparisons show where the heaviest pollution burden falls. Such capital-level comparisons are part of the report's wider coverage.

Q1.

Consider the following statements about the most polluted places in the 2025 report:

- I. India accounted for 74 of the world's 100 most polluted cities in 2024.
- II. Bangladesh was the most polluted country in 2025.
- III. Five of the world's ten most polluted cities are located in India.

Which of the above statements is/are correct?

- (A) I and II only
- (B) I and III only
- (C) II and III only
- (D) I, II and III

Q2.

Consider the following statements about the 2025 report:

- I. Pakistan's annual PM2.5 level is more than thirteen times the WHO limit.
- II. Delhi is the most polluted city in the 2025 report.
- III. India ranked as the most polluted country in 2025.

How many of the above statements are correct?

- (A) Only three
- (B) All of the above
- (C) Only one
- (D) Only two

Q3.

Assertion (A): The most polluted city in the 2025 report is Byrnihat.

Reason (R): Byrnihat is listed among the world's 10 most polluted cities in the 2025 report.

- (A) Both A and R are true and R is the correct explanation of A
- (B) Both A and R are true but R is not the correct explanation of A
- (C) A is true but R is false
- (D) A is false but R is true

Q4.

Which country was placed immediately after Pakistan in the 2025 list of most polluted countries?

- (A) Chad
- (B) Tajikistan
- (C) Bangladesh
- (D) Democratic Republic of Congo

Q5.

What was Pakistan's annual average PM_{2.5} level in the 2025 report?

- (A) 67.3 µg/m³
- (B) 58.4 µg/m³
- (C) 66.1 µg/m³
- (D) 72.1 µg/m³

Q6.

Which region did the 2025 report identify as the most polluted globally?

- (A) Sub-Saharan Africa and East Asia
- (B) Central and South Asia
- (C) Eastern Europe and Latin America
- (D) Southeast Asia and West Africa

Q7.

Which Indian state contains the most polluted city in the 2025 report?

- (A) Haryana
- (B) Bihar
- (C) Uttar Pradesh
- (D) Rajasthan

Measures Against Pollution Sources

Air pollution is tackled through measures that target its different sources rather than through a single rule. One group of measures deals with vehicles, using emission standards that apply across the country and encouraging cleaner types of vehicles so that traffic exhaust is reduced. Another group deals with fuels, including clean cooking fuel for households that otherwise depend on biomass, and fuel produced from agricultural waste. Farming is another source covered by these measures. Waste left on fields after harvest has to be managed, and the report describes two tools developed for this purpose. Construction is also addressed, since one measure covers the way buildings are designed and run. Legal protection forms the final layer. Constitutional provisions and several central statutes deal with pollution of air and water and with the wider environment. The measures listed are not all new; some were introduced decades ago, while others are more recent. Some are aimed at households, others at farmers, and others at legal protection. Each measure comes with a short description of what it does, which helps readers compare the tools side by side. Taken together, the listed measures cover vehicles, fuels, farms, construction and the law. Readers can therefore see how each source of pollution is addressed separately.

Q1.

Which emission standard became mandatory nationwide in 2020, with a leap from BS-IV?

- (A) BS-V
- (B) BS-VI
- (C) BS-III
- (D) Euro VI

Q2.

What does the Turbo Happy Seeder do?

- (A) Converts crop residue into manure
- (B) Generates compressed bio-gas from waste
- (C) Uproots stubble and sows seeds in the cleared area
- (D) Provides LPG to rural households

Q3.

In which year was the Water (Prevention and Control of Pollution) Act enacted?

- (A) 1976
- (B) 1981
- (C) 1986
- (D) 1974

Q4.

Assertion (A): Article 21 has been interpreted to include the right to a healthy environment.

Reason (R): The Environment Protection Act was enacted in 1981.

- (A) Both A and R are true and R is the correct explanation of A
- (B) Both A and R are true but R is not the correct explanation of A
- (C) A is true but R is false
- (D) A is false but R is true

Q5.

Match List I with List II:

List I	List II
I. FAME	A. Promotes compressed bio-gas
II. Pradhan Mantri Ujjwala Yojana	B. Encourages eco-friendly building practices
III. SATAT	C. Provides LPG as clean cooking fuel
IV. GRIHA	D. Promotes electric and hybrid vehicles

Rows are two lists side by side, not matched pairs; work out the correct pairing.

- (A) I-D, II-C, III-A, IV-B
- (B) I-B, II-A, III-C, IV-D
- (C) I-A, II-B, III-D, IV-C
- (D) I-A, II-D, III-C, IV-B

Q6.

Consider the following statements about the measures in the report:

I. The Pusa Bio-Decomposer was developed by the Indian Agricultural Research Institute.

II. The Air (Prevention and Control of Pollution) Act was enacted in 1974.

III. The Pradhan Mantri Ujjwala Yojana promotes electric and hybrid vehicles.

Which of the above statements is/are correct?

- (A) I and II only
- (B) I only
- (C) I and III only
- (D) II and III only

Q7.

Consider the following statements about the measures in the report:

- I. Bharat Stage VI became mandatory nationwide in 2020.
- II. The Pusa Bio-Decomposer uproots stubble and sows seeds in the cleared area.
- III. The Environment Protection Act was enacted in 1986.

How many of the above statements are correct?

- (A) Only two
- (B) Only one
- (C) All of the above
- (D) Only three

PFBR fuel, blanket and coolant

The PFBR at Kalpakkam has achieved first criticality, a milestone that the booklet links with the start of a new phase in India's nuclear programme. Criticality is the state of a nuclear reactor in which the fission chain reaction is self-sustaining. Whether a reactor reaches this state depends on the balance of the neutron population in its core. The multiplication factor, written k , is the ratio of the number of neutrons in one generation to the number of neutrons in the previous generation. The booklet presents this under the heading Criticality in Nuclear Reactors and names three types of criticality, which are distinguished by the value of k . When k is less than 1, the reactor is subcritical: the neutron population decreases over time and the chain reaction dies out. When k equals 1, the reactor is critical: the neutron population remains constant and the chain reaction is steady and self-sustaining. When k is greater than 1, the reactor is supercritical: the neutron population increases exponentially and the power output rises rapidly. The achievement was reported in April 2026 in the booklet's current affairs section. The booklet then turns to the reactor's key technical features, which it lists in a separate section.

Q1.

Which fuel does the PFBR use?

- (A) Natural uranium only
- (B) Enriched uranium-235
- (C) Mixed Oxide of plutonium and uranium
- (D) Thorium-232

Q2.

From what is the reactor's MOX fuel derived?

- (A) Reprocessed spent fuel
- (B) Natural uranium ore
- (C) Heavy water
- (D) Thorium-232

Q3.

What does the Uranium-238 blanket around the core do?

- (A) It absorbs all neutrons
- (B) It slows fast neutrons
- (C) It cools the core
- (D) It converts U-238 into Plutonium-239

Q4.

Assertion (A): The PFBR uses Mixed Oxide fuel.

Reason (R): The PFBR's coolant system uses liquid sodium.

- (A) Both A and R are true and R is the correct explanation of A
- (B) Both A and R are true but R is not the correct explanation of A
- (C) A is true but R is false
- (D) A is false but R is true

Q5.

Match List I with List II:

List I	List II
I. Fuel	A. Uranium-238
II. Coolant	B. Fast Breeder Reactor
III. Reactor type	C. Mixed Oxide (MOX) of plutonium and uranium
IV. Breeder blanket	D. Liquid sodium

Rows are two lists side by side, not matched pairs; work out the correct pairing.

- (A) I-D, II-A, III-C, IV-B
- (B) I-B, II-A, III-D, IV-C
- (C) I-C, II-D, III-B, IV-A
- (D) I-C, II-B, III-A, IV-D

Q6.

Consider the following statements about the PFBR:

- I. Its fuel is a Mixed Oxide of plutonium and uranium.
- II. Its coolant is heavy water.
- III. Its breeder blanket is made of thorium-232.

Which of the above statements is/are correct?

- (A) I only
- (B) II and III only
- (C) I and II only
- (D) I, II and III

Q7.

Consider the following statements:

- I. The fuel is derived from reprocessed spent fuel.
- II. The core is surrounded by a Uranium-238 blanket.
- III. The coolant is pressurised water.

How many of the above statements are correct?

- (A) Only one
- (B) Only two
- (C) Only three
- (D) All of the above

PFBR waste, fuel and efficiency

India's nuclear power programme is organised in three stages, and its purpose is to achieve long-term energy security using the country's uranium and thorium resources. The first is energy security, which maximises the use of limited uranium reserves and unlocks India's large thorium reserves. The second is technological advancement, which positions India among the global leaders in advanced nuclear technology. The third is climate goals, since the programme supports a clean, low-carbon energy transition. The booklet's April 2026 current affairs item focuses on the reactor at Kalpakkam, which is described in its own technical section. That section covers the reactor's type, its design features and the materials used in its core and cooling system. The booklet also gives the reactor's installed capacity, the agency that built it and the department that acts as its nodal agency. A separate three-stage table compares reactor types, fuels, coolants, moderators and breeding processes across the stages. The programme is presented as a tutorial item in the booklet, under the chapter Science and Technology, Defence and Space. Other entries in the same booklet cover India's regulatory bodies, its existing reactors and the laws that govern nuclear facilities.

Q1.

Match List I with List II:

List I	List II
I. Reactor used for energy comparison	A. Volume
II. Long-term property of waste that is reduced	B. Produces more fuel than it consumes
III. Fuel balance of the PFBR	C. Radiotoxicity
IV. Physical measure of waste that is reduced	D. Pressurized Heavy Water Reactor

Rows are two lists side by side, not matched pairs; work out the correct pairing.

- (A) I-C, II-A, III-B, IV-D
- (B) I-A, II-C, III-B, IV-D
- (C) I-D, II-C, III-B, IV-A
- (D) I-B, II-C, III-D, IV-A

Q2.

Compared with its consumption, what is the PFBR's fuel output?

- (A) It consumes more fuel than it produces
- (B) It produces exactly as much fuel as it consumes
- (C) It produces no fuel at all
- (D) It produces more fuel than it consumes

Q3.

Against which reactor type does the booklet compare the PFBR's extraction of energy from natural uranium?

- (A) Pressurized Heavy Water Reactors (PHWRs)
- (B) Light Water Reactors
- (C) Advanced Heavy Water Reactors
- (D) Thermal Breeder Reactors

Q4.

Consider the following statements:

- I. The PFBR recycles spent fuel from Stage I reactors.
- II. The PFBR's energy extraction is compared with that of PHWRs.
- III. The PFBR increases the volume of nuclear waste.

How many of the above statements are correct?

- (A) Only two
- (B) Only one
- (C) Only three
- (D) All of the above

Q5.

Consider the following statements about the PFBR:

- I. It produces more fuel than it consumes.
- II. Recycling spent fuel increases the volume of nuclear waste.
- III. It reduces the long-term radiotoxicity of nuclear waste.

Which of the above statements is/are correct?

- (A) I and II only
- (B) I and III only
- (C) II and III only
- (D) I, II and III

Q6.

What happens to the long-term radiotoxicity of nuclear waste with the PFBR?

- (A) It is increased
- (B) It is reduced
- (C) It is unchanged
- (D) It is eliminated completely

Q7.

Assertion (A): The PFBR increases the long-term radiotoxicity of nuclear waste.

Reason (R): The PFBR reduces the long-term radiotoxicity of nuclear waste.

- (A) Both A and R are true and R is the correct explanation of A
- (B) Both A and R are true but R is not the correct explanation of A
- (C) A is true but R is false
- (D) A is false but R is true

Strategic Significance of INS Aridaman: MCQ

India commissioned INS Aridaman, its third nuclear-powered ballistic missile submarine, and the booklet notes that this milestone brings the number of operational SSBNs at sea to three. Ships of this class are described as carrying ballistic missiles that may be nuclear armed. In the same news item, the stealth frigate INS Taragiri, the fourth ship of Project 17A, was commissioned at Visakhapatnam. The booklet's section on the submarine's importance sets out a number of effects under separate headings. These concern the ways in which nuclear weapons can be delivered, the country's standing among states, the reach of its navy, and the policy framework that guides its use of nuclear weapons. The booklet frames these points under the heading of strategic significance. The booklet compares the three Arihant-class boats, INS Arihant, INS Arighaat and INS Aridaman, and notes that their specifications are classified. Its sketch is only an approximation, credited to Wikimedia Commons. Each boat in that comparison is listed by its commissioning year, displacement and the missiles it is believed to carry. Taken together, these entries give the booklet's overview of the class. The booklet's list of strategic effects gives each point a single line. These pages run from page 56 to page 57 of the booklet.

Q1.

Which doctrine is the submarine's second-strike capability said to support?

- (A) No First Use
- (B) First Use
- (C) Credible Minimum Deterrence
- (D) Strategic Ambiguity

Q2.

According to the booklet, the submarine improves India's strategic reach in which regions?

- (A) Arctic and Atlantic Ocean
- (B) Mediterranean and Black Sea
- (C) South China Sea only
- (D) Indian Ocean Region and Indo-Pacific

Q3.

Which country is NOT listed by the booklet among the countries with operational nuclear triads?

- (A) Russia
- (B) Germany
- (C) China
- (D) France

Q4.

Assertion (A): India can deliver nuclear weapons from land, air and sea.

Reason (R): INS Aridaman completes India's nuclear triad.

- (A) Both A and R are true and R is the correct explanation of A
- (B) Both A and R are true but R is not the correct explanation of A
- (C) A is true but R is false
- (D) A is false but R is true

Q5.

Match List I with List II:

List I	List II
I. Second Strike Capability	A. Improves strategic reach in Indian Ocean Region and Indo-Pacific
II. Completion of Nuclear Triad	B. Places India among countries with operational nuclear triads
III. Enhanced Deterrence	C. Provides assured retaliation capability
IV. Global Strategic Status	D. Enables nuclear delivery via land, air and sea

Rows are two lists side by side, not matched pairs; work out the correct pairing.

- (A) I-D, II-C, III-B, IV-A
- (B) I-D, II-B, III-A, IV-C
- (C) I-C, II-D, III-A, IV-B
- (D) I-B, II-A, III-D, IV-C

Q6.

Consider the following statements:

- I. The submarine boosts Credible Minimum Deterrence.
- II. The booklet lists the UK among countries with operational nuclear triads.
- III. The booklet lists Japan among countries with operational nuclear triads.

Which of the above statements is/are correct?

- (A) I and III only
- (B) II and III only
- (C) I and II only
- (D) I, II and III

Q7.

Of the statements below, how many are correct?

- I. The submarine is said to improve strategic reach in the Arctic region.
- II. The submarine boosts Credible Minimum Deterrence.
- III. The submarine supports the No First Use doctrine.

- (A) Only one
- (B) Only two
- (C) Only three
- (D) All of the above

Submarine Building Programmes: MCQ

The booklet presents India's submarine programme as a long-term effort. After the Kargil War, the Cabinet Committee on Security approved a 30-year Submarine Building Plan with the aim of building conventional submarines indigenously. The booklet describes Project 75 as Phase I of the Indian Navy's 30-year indigenous submarine construction plan. Under this project, diesel-electric attack submarines of the Kalvari class were being built at Mazagon Dock Limited, and the booklet records the commissioning of one of them. Two production lines were planned, using transfer of technology from different foreign manufacturers. The booklet also notes that private Indian firms take part alongside foreign manufacturers under the Make in India initiative in defence. The

booklet also lists Mazagon Dock Shipbuilders Limited, together with Larsen & Toubro Limited, as shortlisted to partner with foreign submarine manufacturers. Mazagon Dock appears in this section both as a builder and as a shortlisted partner. The booklet says conventional diesel-electric submarines of this type come with improved stealth features. The Project 75 entry is followed by a separate entry for the later project. The topic appears in the booklet's April 2026 current affairs section. The booklet's submarine section sits alongside a note on the Indian Navy's ships and its history. Its page on the navy also gives a short history of the force.

Q1.

In which year was Project 75I approved as Phase II of the Indian Navy's 30-year plan?

- (A) 2002
- (B) 2015
- (C) 2017
- (D) 2007

Q2.

Project 75I is the first project under which model?

- (A) Strategic Partnership Model
- (B) Make in India Model
- (C) Transfer of Technology Model
- (D) Joint Venture Model

Q3.

For how long can submarines built under the AIP-based project stay submerged?

- (A) 1 week
- (B) 1 month
- (C) 2 weeks
- (D) 6 weeks

Q4.

Assertion (A): Project 75I is the first project under the Strategic Partnership Model.

Reason (R): Project 75 is Phase I of the Indian Navy's 30-year indigenous submarine plan.

- (A) Both A and R are true and R is the correct explanation of A
- (B) Both A and R are true but R is not the correct explanation of A
- (C) A is true but R is false
- (D) A is false but R is true

Q5.

Match List I with List II:

List I	List II
I. Daewoo Shipbuilding & Marine Engineering	A. Russia
II. Naval Group	B. Germany
III. Rosoboronexport	C. France
IV. Thyssenkrupp Marine Systems (TKMS)	D. South Korea

Rows are two lists side by side, not matched pairs; work out the correct pairing.

- (A) I-A, II-B, III-C, IV-D
- (B) I-B, II-D, III-A, IV-C
- (C) I-D, II-C, III-A, IV-B
- (D) I-D, II-A, III-B, IV-C

Q6.

Consider the following statements:

- I. Project 75I was approved in 2007 as Phase II.
- II. The AIP-based project lets submarines stay submerged for up to 1 month.
- III. Five foreign OEMs were named, including Naval Group of France.

Which of the above statements is/are correct?

- (A) II and III only
- (B) I and II only
- (C) I, II and III
- (D) I and III only

Q7.

Of the statements below, how many are correct?

- I. Project 75 is Phase I of the Indian Navy's 30-year plan.
- II. Conventional diesel-electric submarines need to surface every 24 hours to recharge.
- III. Project 75I aims to procure submarines with fuel cells and AIP.

- (A) Only one
- (B) Only two
- (C) Only three
- (D) All of the above

Artemis Accords: Practice Quiz (MCQ)

NASA's Artemis Programme is named after the Moon Goddess of Greek mythology. Its stated objective is to land humans on the Moon, including the first woman and the first person of colour to stand on the lunar surface. The programme is being carried out in stages. Orion has a crew module and a service module. Artemis II is a crewed mission in which astronauts will travel around the Moon and return to Earth without landing on it. Its crew of four includes the first Canadian and the first non-American to fly on a lunar mission. The mission is expected to last about ten days, following a free-return trajectory before the spacecraft splashes down in the Pacific Ocean. It will lift off from the Kennedy Space Center in Florida, USA. The programme depends on partnerships. The European Space Agency and the Canadian Space Agency are named as its international collaborators. The planned Lunar Gateway Station is meant to serve as a docking point for astronauts and to facilitate scientific research. Artemis III is the stage meant to return humans to the Moon. The Artemis Accords form part of the same international picture.

Q1.

Which of the following is NOT among the founding members of the Artemis Accords?

- (A) Japan
- (B) Canada
- (C) India
- (D) Australia

Q2.

Besides the Moon, which bodies do the common principles of the Artemis Accords cover?

- (A) Only Earth orbit
- (B) Venus and Jupiter
- (C) Only deep-sea floors
- (D) Mars, comets and asteroids

Q3.

Along with NASA, which body established the Artemis Accords?

- (A) US Department of Defense
- (B) US State Department
- (C) European Space Agency
- (D) Indian Space Research Organisation

Q4.

Assertion (A): The Artemis Accords build upon the Outer Space Treaty of 1967.

Reason (R): The Artemis Accords are not legally binding.

- (A) Both A and R are true and R is the correct explanation of A
- (B) Both A and R are true but R is not the correct explanation of A
- (C) A is true but R is false
- (D) A is false but R is true

Q5.

Match List I with List II:

List I	List II
I. Announcement of the Artemis Accords by NASA	A. Not part of the Accords
II. Founding members other than the US State Department and NASA	B. 2020
III. India's entry into the Accords	C. Seven
IV. Russia and China	D. As the 27th member

Rows are two lists side by side, not matched pairs; work out the correct pairing.

- (A) I-B, II-D, III-C, IV-A
- (B) I-C, II-B, III-A, IV-D
- (C) I-B, II-C, III-D, IV-A
- (D) I-C, II-B, III-D, IV-A

Q6.

Consider the following statements about the Artemis Accords:

- I. The United Arab Emirates is one of the founding members of the Artemis Accords.
- II. Russia is one of the founding members of the Artemis Accords.
- III. Luxembourg is one of the founding members of the Artemis Accords.

Which of the above statements is/are correct?

- (A) I and III only
- (B) I and II only
- (C) II and III only
- (D) I, II and III

Q7.

Consider the following statements about the Artemis Accords:

- I. The Artemis Accords set out a set of principles and guidelines for international cooperation in space exploration.
- II. The Artemis Accords are legally binding on their members.
- III. The Indian Space Research Organisation is one of the founding members of the Artemis Accords.

How many of the above statements are correct?

- (A) Only two
- (B) Only one
- (C) Only three
- (D) All of the above

Chandrayaan Missions: Practice Quiz (MCQ)

India's lunar exploration missions are known as the Chandrayaan series. Chandrayaan-1 was India's first lunar mission, and it mapped the surface of the Moon in unprecedented detail. Chandrayaan-4 is India's fourth mission to the Moon, and it follows the earlier missions in the series. Its planned work includes two launches, the development and realisation of its spacecraft, and external Deep Space Network support. Instruments from NASA and the European Space Agency will also be mounted on a rover of Chandrayaan-5, which is planned as a further lunar exploration mission. The Soviet Union was the first nation to land on the Moon, and the United States followed with the Apollo mission, which took place in 1969 and carried astronauts to the lunar surface. Neil Armstrong became the first person to step onto the Moon, and he was joined by Edwin 'Buzz' Aldrin. The United States is also the only country to have landed humans on the Moon. China's Chang'e mission also landed on the Moon. Odysseus was a lander developed in the United States that achieved the first soft lunar landing by a private company. It was the second private attempt to land on the Moon, after the failure of the Peregrine lander.

Q1.

Which country landed on the Moon with the SLIM mission in 2024?

- (A) China
- (B) Japan
- (C) India
- (D) Russia

Q2.

In which year was Chandrayaan-2 launched?

- (A) 2023
- (B) 2028
- (C) 2019
- (D) 2008

Q3.

Which agency is responsible for the lunar rover of Chandrayaan-5?

- (A) JAXA
- (B) ISRO
- (C) NASA
- (D) ESA

Q4.

Assertion (A): Chandrayaan-3 was a second attempt after Chandrayaan-2.

Reason (R): Chandrayaan-2 carried an orbiter, the Vikram lander and the Pragyan rover.

- (A) Both A and R are true and R is the correct explanation of A
- (B) Both A and R are true but R is not the correct explanation of A
- (C) A is true but R is false
- (D) A is false but R is true

Q5.

Match List I with List II:

List I	List II
I. Chandrayaan-1	A. Landing point Shiv Shakti
II. Chandrayaan-3	B. Bringing rock samples back to Earth
III. Chandrayaan-4	C. Joint initiative of ISRO and JAXA
IV. Chandrayaan-5	D. Water ice found in polar craters

Rows are two lists side by side, not matched pairs; work out the correct pairing.

- (A) I-C, II-D, III-B, IV-A
- (B) I-C, II-D, III-A, IV-B
- (C) I-B, II-C, III-D, IV-A
- (D) I-D, II-A, III-B, IV-C

Q6.

Consider the following statements about the Chandrayaan missions:

- I. Chandrayaan-4 is slated for launch in 2028.
- II. Chandrayaan-2 was launched in 2023.
- III. Chandrayaan-3 used the GSLV Mk III launch vehicle.

Which of the above statements is/are correct?

- (A) I and II only
- (B) II and III only
- (C) I and III only
- (D) I, II and III

Q7.

Consider the following statements about the Chandrayaan missions:

- I. Chandrayaan-4 includes special tests for design validation.
- II. Chandrayaan-3 was India's first lunar mission.
- III. The Chandrayaan-5 mission is led by NASA.

How many of the above statements are correct?

- (A) Only one
- (B) Only two
- (C) Only three
- (D) All of the above

FIDE: Leadership and Recent Results

FIDE (Fédération Internationale des Échecs) is the International Chess Federation. It oversees major international competitions and sets the rules and rating standards that players follow. The federation is led by a President, with a Deputy President supporting its work.

Indian players have a long record in the sport. Viswanathan Anand is India's most successful chess player and has won the FIDE World Chess Championship in 2000, 2007, 2008, 2010 and 2012, a span of more than a decade. Koneru Humpy is India's highest-rated female chess player and has won the Women's World Rapid Chess Championship title.

In 2026, R. Vaishali won the FIDE Women's Candidates Tournament, and her win came in the final round of the event. She became the first Indian woman to claim its title. She will now challenge the reigning champion, Ju Wenjun, who currently holds the Women's World Chess Championship title, later in 2026.

Gukesh Dommaraju, India's youngest Grandmaster, became the youngest World Chess Champion

after defeating Ding Liren in the FIDE World Chess Championship 2024. Divya Deshmukh won the FIDE Women's World Cup 2025, defeating Humpy Koneru in the final, and she became the third winner of that title after Alexandra Kosteniuk and Aleksandra Goryachkina.

Q1.

Ju Wenjun, the reigning Women's World Chess Champion, is from which country?

- (A) China
- (B) Russia
- (C) Uzbekistan
- (D) Norway

Q2.

Who is the President of the International Chess Federation (FIDE)?

- (A) Wilhelm Steinitz
- (B) Johannes Zukertort
- (C) Arkady Dvorkovich
- (D) Ju Wenjun

Q3.

Read the statements below about FIDE:

- I. The FIDE motto 'Gens una Sumus' means 'We are One Family'.
- II. FIDE's headquarters is in Paris, France.
- III. FIDE was established in Paris in 1924.

Which of the above statements is/are correct?

- (A) I and II only
- (B) II and III only
- (C) I and III only
- (D) I, II and III

Q4.

In which city was the FIDE Women's Candidates Tournament 2026 held?

- (A) Istanbul, Turkey
- (B) Madrid, Spain
- (C) Vienna, Austria
- (D) Nicosia, Cyprus

Q5.

How many of the following statements are correct?

- I. Arkady Dvorkovich is the President of FIDE.
- II. FIDE's headquarters is in Nicosia, Cyprus.
- III. The theme of International Chess Day 2025 was 'Every Move Counts'.

- (A) Only one
- (B) Only two
- (C) Only three
- (D) All of the above

Q6.

Match List I with List II:

List I	List II
I. FIDE motto 'Gens una Sumus'	A. Every Move Counts
II. FIDE headquarters	B. Kateryna Lagno
III. Theme of International Chess Day 2025	C. Lausanne, Switzerland
IV. R. Vaishali's final-round opponent in 2026	D. We are One Family

Rows are two lists side by side, not matched pairs; work out the correct pairing.

- (A) I-D, II-C, III-A, IV-B
- (B) I-D, II-A, III-C, IV-B
- (C) I-A, II-D, III-C, IV-B
- (D) I-A, II-C, III-D, IV-B

Chess History and Indian Records

Chess has a long history, and the World Chess Championship is one of the major titles in the game. The first official champion was the player who defeated Johannes Zukertort in the early contest for the title. Magnus Carlsen is a former World No. 1 in the sport.

Indian players have had strong results in recent years. Viswanathan Anand, India's most successful chess player, has won the FIDE World Chess Championship in several years, with titles spanning more than a decade. Koneru Humpy is India's highest-rated female chess player, and she has won the Women's World Rapid Chess Championship title.

Divya Deshmukh won the FIDE Women's World Cup 2025 in Georgia, defeating Humpy Koneru in the final. She became the third winner of that title, after Alexandra Kosteniuk and Aleksandra Goryachkina.

In 2026, R. Vaishali won the FIDE Women's Candidates Tournament and became the first Indian woman to claim its title. She clinched the title by defeating Kateryna Lagno of Russia in the final round. Vaishali will challenge Ju Wenjun, the reigning champion from China, for the Women's World Chess Championship later in 2026.

Gukesh Dommaraju, India's youngest Grandmaster, became the youngest World Chess Champion after defeating Ding Liren of China.

Q1.

Under which empire did chess originate in Northern India as 'Chaturanga'?

- (A) Mauryan Empire
- (B) Gupta Empire
- (C) Mughal Empire
- (D) Chola Empire

Q2.

Abhimanyu Mishra, recorded as the world's youngest chess Grandmaster, is from which country?

- (A) Uzbekistan
- (B) India
- (C) Norway
- (D) USA

Q3.

Who won the Chess World Cup 2025 held in Goa?

- (A) Javokhir Sindarov
- (B) Ding Liren
- (C) Gukesh Dommaraju
- (D) Ju Wenjun

Q4.

Assertion (A): India hosted the Chess World Cup 2025 in Goa.

Reason (R): India had earlier hosted the Chess World Cup in Hyderabad in 2002.

- (A) Both A and R are true and R is the correct explanation of A
- (B) Both A and R are true but R is not the correct explanation of A
- (C) A is true but R is false
- (D) A is false but R is true

Q5.

Match List I with List II:

List I	List II
I. Abhimanyu Mishra	A. First classical win over Magnus Carlsen at Norway Chess 2025
II. Anish Sarkar	B. Youngest player to reach a World Cup final
III. R. Praggnanandhaa	C. Youngest chess player ever ranked by FIDE
IV. Gukesh Dommaraju	D. World's youngest chess Grandmaster

Rows are two lists side by side, not matched pairs; work out the correct pairing.

- (A) I-C, II-D, III-B, IV-A
- (B) I-A, II-B, III-D, IV-C
- (C) I-A, II-B, III-C, IV-D
- (D) I-D, II-C, III-B, IV-A

Q6.

Read the statements below about chess history:

- I. Chess originated in Northern India as 'Chaturanga'.
- II. The World Chess Championship was established in 1886.
- III. India hosted the Chess World Cup 2025 in Hyderabad.

Which of the above statements is/are correct?

- (A) II and III only
- (B) I, II and III
- (C) I and II only
- (D) I and III only

Q7.

How many of the following statements are correct?

- I. Gukesh Dommaraju secured his first classical win over Magnus Carlsen at Norway Chess 2025.
 - II. Abhimanyu Mishra is from India.
 - III. The Indian men's and women's teams won their first-ever Olympiad gold in 2024.
- (A) Only one
 - (B) Only two
 - (C) Only three
 - (D) All of the above

Polity and Schemes: MCQ Practice

Polity and governance decisions often turn on precise legal definitions. The Scheduled Caste list is set through an order issued in 1950, and recent court rulings have examined how a person's

religion affects membership of that list. Membership is not the only area where Parliament is active. It has passed legislation that deals with the legal position of a state capital, after an arrangement in which two states shared a common capital came to an end. The government has also extended and expanded several welfare schemes. The PM Internship Scheme offers internships to young people and is run by a central ministry, while PMGSY-III is a road programme for rural habitations that has been extended for a further period. Under the Namo Drone Didi Yojana, drones are provided to rural women for agricultural work such as crop spraying and fertiliser application. Karnataka has been named a top performer under this scheme. Each scheme has a defined objective, such as connecting rural areas with the mainstream economy or empowering women in farming. Many of these programmes depend on state-level agencies to carry out the work on the ground, and their funding is shared between the Centre and the states in fixed proportions.

Q1.

The Constitution (Scheduled Castes) Order, 1950 is issued under which Article of the Constitution?

- (A) Article 14
- (B) Article 341(1)
- (C) Article 370
- (D) Article 280

Q2.

Under the Doctrine of Eclipse, what happens to Scheduled Caste status when a member converts to another religion?

- (A) It is permanently extinguished
- (B) It is transferred to the Scheduled Tribe list
- (C) It is suspended, not permanently extinguished
- (D) It is restored automatically at the time of conversion

Q3.

Under the 2026 amendment, which Act's Section 5(2) was changed to name Amaravati as the capital?

- (A) Andhra Pradesh Reorganisation Act, 2014
- (B) States Reorganisation Act, 1956
- (C) Andhra Pradesh Capital Region Act, 2014
- (D) Constitution (Seventh Amendment) Act, 1956

Q4.

Assertion (A): A Scheduled Caste member who converts to Christianity loses eligibility for SC status.

Reason (R): The Constitution (Scheduled Castes) Order, 1950 restricts SC membership to persons professing Hinduism, Sikhism or Buddhism.

- (A) Both A and R are true and R is the correct explanation of A
- (B) Both A and R are true but R is not the correct explanation of A
- (C) A is true but R is false
- (D) A is false but R is true

Q5.

Match List I with List II:

List I	List II
I. PMGSY-III	A. Department of Agriculture and Farmers Welfare
II. Namu Drone Didi Yojana	B. Ministry of Corporate Affairs
III. PM Internship Scheme	C. Article 341(1)
IV. Constitution (Scheduled Castes) Order, 1950	D. Ministry of Rural Development

Rows are two lists side by side, not matched pairs; work out the correct pairing.

- (A) I-A, II-D, III-C, IV-B
- (B) I-D, II-C, III-B, IV-A
- (C) I-D, II-A, III-B, IV-C
- (D) I-C, II-D, III-B, IV-A

Q6.

Examine the following statements on Scheduled Caste status:

- I. Only Parliament can amend the Scheduled Caste list.
- II. Scheduled Tribe status carries a religion-based bar similar to Scheduled Caste status.
- III. Under the Doctrine of Eclipse, SC status is permanently extinguished on conversion.

Which of the above statements is/are correct?

- (A) II and III only
- (B) I and II only
- (C) I and III only
- (D) I only

Q7.

How many of the following statements are correct?

- I. The Andhra Pradesh amendment names Amaravati as the sole capital.
- II. The PM Internship Scheme's upper age limit is 21 years.
- III. PMGSY-III has been extended till March 2028.

- (A) Only one
- (B) Only two
- (C) Only three
- (D) All of the above

Economy and Climate: MCQ Practice

India's position in global economic rankings is measured using nominal GDP in US dollar terms. The figure depends on domestic output in rupees and on the exchange rate against the dollar, so a weaker rupee lowers the dollar value of GDP. A revision of GDP data with a new base year also changes the figures. Special Additional Excise Duty, or SAED, is a levy on petroleum products that the government adjusts when global crude prices move. It works as a windfall tax in times of price surges, and unlike the GST, its revenue is kept by the Centre. Climate policy is another area of activity. Countries submit self-defined climate action plans under the Paris framework, and these plans are reported regularly. Synthetic gases used in cooling and foam industries are being phased down under an international amendment to the Montreal Protocol. Air conditioners and refrigerators are among the uses of these synthetic gases. Host nations for the UN climate conference are chosen through regional rotation. The rules also require a formal proposal to the UNFCCC Secretariat before a country can be chosen. If no host emerges, the venue shifts to Bonn, the seat of the UNFCCC. Rankings also influence investor sentiment and global confidence.

Q1.

India slipped behind which two economies in the IMF's World Economic Outlook 2026 nominal GDP ranking?

- (A) United Kingdom and Japan
- (B) Germany and France
- (C) China and United States
- (D) Brazil and Canada

Q2.

Under which section of the Finance Act, 2002 is Special Additional Excise Duty levied?

- (A) Section 101
- (B) Section 147
- (C) Section 112
- (D) Section 56

Q3.

Which company leads the first semiconductor fabrication SEZ at Dholera in Gujarat?

- (A) Tata Semiconductor
- (B) Reliance Industries
- (C) Infosys
- (D) Adani Power

Q4.

Assertion (A): India has withdrawn its bid to host COP33 in 2028.

Reason (R): India has hosted the UN climate conference (COP8) only once, in New Delhi in 2002.

- (A) Both A and R are true and R is the correct explanation of A
- (B) Both A and R are true but R is not the correct explanation of A
- (C) A is true but R is false
- (D) A is false but R is true

Q5.

Match List I with List II:

List I	List II
I. NDC 3.0 emission intensity reduction	A. 45 per cent
II. NDC 3.0 non-fossil capacity share	B. 47 per cent
III. NDC 2.0 emission intensity reduction	C. 50 per cent
IV. NDC 2.0 non-fossil capacity share	D. 60 per cent

Rows are two lists side by side, not matched pairs; work out the correct pairing.

- (A) I-A, II-B, III-D, IV-C
- (B) I-D, II-A, III-C, IV-B
- (C) I-D, II-B, III-C, IV-A
- (D) I-B, II-D, III-A, IV-C

Q6.

Examine the following statements on climate and synthetic gases:

- I. HFCs were introduced as replacements for ozone-depleting substances such as CFCs.
- II. Nationally Determined Contributions are legally binding targets under the Paris framework.
- III. The Kigali Amendment is legally binding and recognises differentiated responsibilities.

Which of the above statements is/are correct?

- (A) I and II only
- (B) II and III only
- (C) I and III only
- (D) I, II and III

Q7.

How many of the following statements are correct?

- I. India has slipped to sixth place in nominal GDP in the IMF's World Economic Outlook 2026.
 - II. India ratified the Kigali Amendment in 2021.
 - III. The Kigali Amendment was adopted under the Kyoto Protocol.
- (A) Only one
 - (B) Only three
 - (C) Only two
 - (D) All of the above

Historical Events and Personalities: MCQ Practice

Several episodes in the history of India show how political events shaped public life. A battle near Panipat, in present-day Haryana, is remembered as a turning point in medieval history, and its military methods drew on techniques from West Asia. The Sikh community was shaped by a line of Gurus who built towns and developed their own institutions. Their teachings and practices were preserved and passed on over generations. Protests that followed were linked to laws that allowed detention without trial, and to the arrest of local leaders. An official inquiry criticised the commander but imposed no severe punishment. The gathering had come together for a Baisakhi celebration and to protest against recent arrests. The massacre is still remembered as one of the most brutal episodes of colonial rule. Reformers of the nineteenth and twentieth centuries also worked for social change. One campaigned for the education of women and the rights of lower castes, and another helped draft the Constitution of India. The Non-Cooperation Movement of 1920, led by Gandhi, marked a shift in the freedom struggle. Their work is commemorated through national observances.

Q1.

How many of the following statements are correct?

- I. The First Battle of Panipat marked the foundation of the Mughal Empire in India.
 - II. Shaheed Diwas is observed on 23 March.
 - III. Dr B. R. Ambedkar received the Bharat Ratna in 1956.
- (A) Only one
 - (B) Only two
 - (C) Only three
 - (D) All of the above

Q2.

What official death toll is cited for the Jallianwala Bagh Massacre?

- (A) 200
- (B) 1000 plus
- (C) 379
- (D) 550

Q3.

Assertion (A): Guru Tegh Bahadur was executed in Delhi on the orders of Aurangzeb.

Reason (R): He was executed for defending the freedom of religion.

- (A) A is true but R is false
- (B) A is false but R is true
- (C) Both A and R are true and R is the correct explanation of A
- (D) Both A and R are true but R is not the correct explanation of A

Q4.

Examine the following statements about the Sikh Gurus:

- I. Guru Nanak Dev started the Guru ka Langar.
- II. Guru Tegh Bahadur founded the Khalsa in 1699.
- III. Guru Arjun Dev composed the Adi Granth in 1604.

Which of the above statements is/are correct?

- (A) I and III only
- (B) I and II only
- (C) II and III only
- (D) I, II and III

Q5.

Which military strategy, used in the battle near Panipat, involved dividing the army into flanking units that attacked from the sides and rear?

- (A) Rumi strategy
- (B) Mansabdari system
- (C) Jagirdari system
- (D) Tulughma strategy

Q6.

Who translated Babur's Turkish autobiography into Persian as the Baburnama?

- (A) Abul Fazl
- (B) Abdur Rahim Khan-i-Khana
- (C) Amir Khusrau
- (D) Ziauddin Barani

Q7.

Match List I with List II:

List I	List II
I. Battle of Khanwa (1527)	A. Reginald Dyer
II. Battle of Chanderi (1528)	B. Ibrahim Lodi
III. First Battle of Panipat (1526)	C. Rana Sanga
IV. Jallianwala Bagh Massacre (1919)	D. Medini Rai

Rows are two lists side by side, not matched pairs; work out the correct pairing.

- (A) I-A, II-B, III-C, IV-D
- (B) I-C, II-A, III-D, IV-B
- (C) I-D, II-A, III-C, IV-B
- (D) I-C, II-D, III-B, IV-A

Liquidity and Enforcement Bodies

Banks in India need steady access to funds, and the Reserve Bank of India uses several tools to provide it. One of these is the Variable Rate Repo, which the RBI operates under its Liquidity Management Framework. The tool helps address temporary liquidity shortages in the banking system. For year-end banking stability, the RBI announced a liquidity infusion of 21.25 Lakh Crore through VRR auctions. Under this mechanism, banks borrow short-term funds from the RBI, and the process is run through auctions. The VRR is therefore a tool for temporary shortages, operated within the RBI's framework. The booklet also describes the bodies that deal with money and cyber crime. The Financial Intelligence Unit - India shares intelligence with law enforcement agencies. The Indian Cyber Crime Coordination Centre serves as the central agency for cybercrime coordination in the country. Cross-border work is led by the GlobE Network, which is designed to facilitate swift cooperation among law enforcement agencies and to recover illicit assets. Its concept grew out of the Riyadh Initiative, which was linked to Saudi Arabia's G20 Presidency.

Q1.

According to the booklet, what is the focus of the Financial Intelligence Unit - India?

- (A) Disaster relief
- (B) Cross-border trade tariffs
- (C) Anti-money laundering
- (D) Seed certification

Q2.

Under which convention does the GlobE Network operate?

- (A) UN Convention Against Corruption
- (B) Convention on Biological Diversity
- (C) Paris Agreement
- (D) Montreal Protocol

Q3.

What duration range does the booklet give for VRR funds?

- (A) 1 to 3 days
- (B) 7 to 14 days
- (C) 30 to 60 days
- (D) 3 to 6 months

Q4.

Assertion (A): VRR funds are provided at fixed rates through auctions.

Reason (R): VRR funds are provided through auction-based repos.

- (A) Both A and R are true and R explains A
- (B) Both A and R are true but R does not explain A
- (C) A is true but R is false
- (D) A is false but R is true

Q5.

Match List I with List II:

List I	List II
I. Variable Rate Repo	A. Formally launched in 2021
II. Financial Intelligence Unit - India	B. Liquidity injection tool under the Liquidity Management Framework
III. Indian Cyber Crime Coordination Centre	C. Nodal ministry is the Ministry of Finance
IV. GlobE Network	D. Established in 2018

Rows are two lists side by side, not matched pairs; work out the correct pairing.

- (A) I-D, II-B, III-C, IV-A
- (B) I-A, II-D, III-C, IV-B
- (C) I-B, II-C, III-D, IV-A
- (D) I-D, II-C, III-B, IV-A

Q6.

Consider the following statements:

I. FIU-India was established in 2004.

II. Banks provide government securities as collateral to borrow short-term funds from the RBI under VRR.

III. The GlobE Network concept emerged from the Riyadh Initiative in 2019.

Which of the above statements is/are correct?

- (A) I and II only
- (B) I and III only
- (C) II and III only
- (D) I, II and III

Q7.

Consider the following statements:

1. FIU-India collects and analyses suspicious financial transaction reports.
2. FIU-India and the Indian Cyber Crime Coordination Centre signed an MoU to combat cyber-financial frauds.
3. The GlobE Network was formally launched in 2018.

How many of the above statements are correct?

- (A) Only one
- (B) Only two
- (C) Only three
- (D) All of the above

Nutrition, Medicine and Rankings

The health and nutrition block of this booklet links nutrition policy, BRICS health cooperation and higher-education rankings. A 15-day nationwide campaign aims to drive behavioural change and improve nutritional outcomes for women and children. This campaign is one of the nutrition measures covered in the block, and it runs for a fixed 15-day period. Traditional medicine is also part of the health agenda, since the booklet describes the promotion of traditional, complementary and integrative medicine. Among the BRICS health material, the booklet describes a Health Working Group and a Mission for Healthy Lifestyles. In higher education, the booklet reports on subject-wise global rankings. These rankings draw on academic and employer reputation, along with an international research network. Indian institutions entered the marketing rankings for the first time, which indicates a shift beyond the long-standing dominance of STEM subjects. In short, the block combines a nutrition campaign, traditional medicine, BRICS health work and university rankings. Both health and higher education appear in this single block.

Q1.

Which organisation publishes the QS World University Rankings by Subject 2026?

- (A) Times Higher Education
- (B) Shanghai Ranking Consultancy
- (C) Quacquarelli Symonds
- (D) National Institutional Ranking Framework

Q2.

Which Indian institute leads India in Engineering and Technology in the QS subject rankings?

- (A) IIT Delhi
- (B) ITM Ahmedabad
- (C) IIM Kozhikode
- (D) Jawaharlal Nehru University

Q3.

In which year was Mission POSHAN 2.0 launched?

- (A) 2016
- (B) 2019
- (C) 2024
- (D) 2021

Q4.

Assertion (A): The BRICS Mental Health and Wellness Initiative aims to increase stigma around mental healthcare.

Reason (R): The initiative aims to strengthen mental healthcare systems and reduce stigma.

- (A) A is true but R is false
- (B) A is false but R is true
- (C) Both A and R are true and R explains A
- (D) Both A and R are true but R does not explain A

Q5.

Match List I with List II:

List I	List II
I. BRICS Mission for Healthy Lifestyles	A. Integrated Nutrition Support System
II. Mission POSHAN 2.0	B. Prevention of non-communicable diseases
III. Integration of Traditional Medicine	C. IIM Kozhikode entered the Global Top 100
IV. QS World University Rankings by Subject 2026	D. AYUSH (India) systems

Rows are two lists side by side, not matched pairs; work out the correct pairing.

- (A) I-B, II-A, III-C, IV-D
- (B) I-C, II-D, III-B, IV-A
- (C) I-D, II-B, III-A, IV-C
- (D) I-B, II-A, III-D, IV-C

Q6.

Consider the following statements:

- I. India holds the 2026 BRICS Presidency.
- II. The BRICS Health Working Group met in New Delhi.
- III. The 15-day campaign is limited to women and children in rural areas.

Which of the above statements is/are correct?

- (A) I and II only
- (B) I and III only
- (C) II and III only
- (D) I, II and III

Q7.

Consider the following statements:

- 1. Citations per paper is one of the metrics used in the QS subject rankings.
- 2. The H-Index is one of the metrics used in the QS subject rankings.
- 3. The metrics include the number of Olympic medals won by each country.

How many of the above statements are correct?

- (A) Only one
- (B) All of the above
- (C) Only two
- (D) Only three

Type-in-the-answer passages

Katchatheevu: Claims and Agreements

Katchatheevu is a small island located in the Palk Strait between India and Sri Lanka. The island is uninhabited, yet its ownership remained a point of dispute between the two countries for a long time. Sri Lanka's claim rests on history, since the island was initially ruled by a kingdom of Sri Lanka in the early medieval period. Sri Lanka also argues that a European power which occupied the island for over a century exercised jurisdiction over the islet. India's claim, on the other hand, holds that control of the island later passed to a zamindari, which functioned under a ruling dynasty. Over the years, maritime agreements tried to settle the dispute and strengthen ties. One agreement allowed Indian fishermen continued access to the island, and a later additional agreement prevented both countries from fishing in each other's exclusive economic zones. After the civil war in Sri Lanka ended, tensions rose over Indian fishermen in Sri Lankan waters, leading to arrests, torture allegations and renewed demands over the island.

Q1.

What is the area of Katchatheevu Island, in acres?

Answer: _____

Q2.

In which year was the Indo-Sri Lankan Maritime Agreement signed that ceded Katchatheevu to Sri Lanka?

Answer: _____

Q3.

Which European power occupied the island during 1505-1658 CE?

Answer: _____

Q4.

Which dynasty of Madurai held the island under the Ramnad Zamindari in the 17th century?

Answer: _____

Q5.

Which kingdom initially ruled the island in the early medieval period?

Answer: _____

Q6.

Before the cession, which Indian presidency was Katchatheevu once part of?

Answer: _____

Q7.

What is the island's sole structure?

Answer: _____

Women's reservation: practice TITA

India has long had a small number of women in its elected bodies. Successive governments have debated reserving seats for women, and a women's reservation bill has been put before Parliament several times since 1996. The law that was finally enacted reserves seats for women in the Lok Sabha and in State Legislative Assemblies, and it also covers the National Capital Territory of Delhi. The reservation is meant to take effect only after a delimitation exercise is carried out and a census is conducted, so its timing depends on those steps. Supporters argue that the measure advances gender equality and brings a wider range of perspectives into decision-making. Critics note that the law does not extend the same reservation to the Rajya Sabha or to State Legislative Councils. Committees on the status of women have examined these questions since the 1970s. The reserved seats are also expected to change over time, so that different constituencies are available to women after each redrawing of boundaries.

Q1.

What percentage of total seats in the Lok Sabha and State Assemblies is reserved for women under the law? (in per cent)

Answer: _____

Q2.

For how many years is the women's reservation valid before Parliament may extend it? (in years)

Answer: _____

Q3.

Which Article inserts reservation for women in the Lok Sabha?

Answer: _____

Q4.

Which Article provides reservation for women in the National Capital Territory of Delhi?

Answer: _____

Q5.

How many different years are listed in the booklet as years when a women's reservation bill was introduced? (number)

Answer: _____

Q6.

Under which leader's committee on women was a committee constituted in 1987? (surname)

Answer: _____

Q7.

In which year was the Committee on the Status of Women in India set up? (year)

Answer: _____

Caste and census history typed answers

Counting people has a long history in India, and ancient texts such as the Arthashastra refer to population counts. The modern census was shaped under colonial rule, when national counts were first taken across the country. Early colonial censuses did not all follow the same method. A later one was designed to be synchronous, meaning that it was taken at one time across the whole country. Caste was recorded in colonial counts, and one of them is remembered as the last caste-based census. After Independence, caste data collection was narrowed, and the census recorded information only on Scheduled Castes and Scheduled Tribes. Other backward classes were left out of this official count. In recent years, several states have carried out their own surveys of caste. Another census stands out for a different reason. It is the only one in the modern series to show a decline in population across a decade, which makes it a notable point in demographic history. Since Independence, the country has conducted repeated censuses, and each has added to the record of how the population has changed over time. The census remains a comprehensive source of population data for assessing policies and welfare programmes.

Q1.

In which year was the last caste-based census in India conducted? (year)

Answer: _____

Q2.

Who was the Census Commissioner in 1931? (surname)

Answer: _____

Q3.

Who was the Census Commissioner in 1951? (surname)

Answer: _____

Q4.

Under which Lord was the synchronous census of 1881 conducted? (surname)

Answer: _____

Q5.

Which state is listed first among those that undertook independent caste surveys? (state name)

Answer: _____

Q6.

How many censuses has India held since Independence? (number)

Answer: _____

Q7.

Which census year is the only one to record a decadal population decline? (year)

Answer: _____

Decline and Response Check

In recent years, the number of districts affected by Left Wing Extremism has fallen sharply, and violence has declined in step. Security forces have moved into areas that were once hard to reach. Specialised units operating from bases closer to remote zones have pressed the movement hard, while the state has also tried to close the gap between remote regions and the rest of the country. Connectivity has played a major role. Better road links have reduced the geographical isolation in which insurgents once moved, and expanded mobile networks have helped counter propaganda and bring tribal regions into the digital world. The state has also gone after the money that sustains the movement. Investigation agencies have carried out operations and seized assets, which has disrupted the networks that supply funds from urban areas. The movement also had a parallel system of governance of its own. Administrative efforts have aimed to replace that system with state institutions, including residential schools and programmes for aspirational districts. Coordination between states has been another factor, making it harder for armed cadres to escape across state borders. A surrender and rehabilitation policy has encouraged many members to give up violence and take up a new life, with cash benefits and skill training on offer.

Q1.

How many districts were affected by Left Wing Extremism in 2014? (give the number)

Answer: _____

Q2.

Under infrastructure integration, how many km of all-weather roads were constructed? (give the number in km)

Answer: _____

Q3.

What figure, as stated in the booklet, is given for mobile (4G) towers deployed under information warfare? (give the number)

Answer: _____

Q4.

Apart from COBRA, which elite force is named for tactical dominance against Naxals?

Answer: _____

Q5.

What is the name of the Maoist parallel governance system that administrative expansion replaced?

Answer: _____

Q6.

How many cadres have surrendered since 2014 under the Surrender-cum-Rehabilitation Policy? (give the number)

Answer: _____

Q7.

In which state are the residual hotspots Bijapur, Sukma and Narayanpur located?

Answer: _____

Courts and Views on UCC

Indian courts have often been asked to decide whether personal laws can override individual rights. In one landmark case, the Supreme Court held that a Muslim woman could continue to claim maintenance from her husband under the criminal procedure law even after the period of waiting that follows divorce had ended. In a later case, the Court declared a form of instant divorce practised among Muslims unconstitutional, holding that it violated the dignity and equality of Muslim women, and it suggested that Parliament should frame a law to regulate Muslim marriages and divorces. Another judgment held that personal and customary laws must be tested against the fundamental rights, and that no religious practice can claim supremacy over the Constitution. The Supreme Court has also praised a state where a common civil code is already in force as a shining example for the country.

The views of other institutions have differed as well. A Law Commission in 2018 found that a uniform code was neither necessary nor desirable at that stage, and it recommended reforming family laws across religions instead. The Central Government, by contrast, favours a uniform code. Later, a fresh Law Commission issued a notification inviting public views on the subject. The framers of the Constitution did not intend total uniformity, which is why personal laws were placed in a list under which both Parliament and state legislatures can make laws.

Q1.

In which year did the Supreme Court decide Shah Bano Begum v Mohammad Ahmed Khan? (year)

Answer: _____

Q2.

In which year did the Supreme Court declare triple talaq unconstitutional in Shayara Bano v Union of India? (year)

Answer: _____

Q3.

Which numbered Law Commission, in its 2018 report, deemed a UCC unnecessary and undesirable? (give the number)

Answer: _____

Q4.

Which Indian state did the Supreme Court hail as a 'shining example' of a UCC in the Jose Paulo Coutinho case (2019)?

Answer: _____

Q5.

Under which Article of the Constitution did the Supreme Court place personal and customary law in the Indian Young Lawyers Association case (2018)? (number)

Answer: _____

Q6.

Name the retired judge associated with the five-member committee formed to give recommendations for implementing a UCC in Uttarakhand.

Answer: _____

Q7.

Which numbered Law Commission issued a notification to elicit views on the UCC? (give the number)

Answer: _____

Tribunal Status Check

The Mahanadi Water Disputes Tribunal has now reached a stage where the two states must act or face a judgment. The Tribunal has granted both Odisha and Chhattisgarh a final opportunity to arrive at a mutually agreed water-sharing formula within a deadline set for this year. If the states fail, the Tribunal has made clear that it will proceed to adjudicate the dispute on the basis of available evidence and legal principles. The Tribunal has also expressed serious dissatisfaction with repeated adjournments and a lack of substantive progress. It observed that no concrete proposals or narrowing of contentious issues have been placed on record, despite assurances of settlement efforts. The deadlock is attributed mainly to two causes: the absence of information that both sides accept as reliable, and a persistent trust deficit between the two states. These problems have made meaningful negotiation and consensus building difficult. Disputes of this kind are handled by tribunals set up for particular rivers and particular groups of states. The Odisha and Chhattisgarh dispute is one such case, and India has several other tribunals that deal with water sharing between neighbouring states. Each tribunal works within its own dispute and its own set of states.

Q1.

In which year was the Mahanadi Water Disputes Tribunal formed?

Answer: _____

Q2.

By which date were the two states asked to present a water-sharing settlement? (Month Day)

Answer: _____

Q3.

Which tribunal in the booklet's table was formed earliest? (name)

Answer: _____

Q4.

Which tribunal covers Odisha and Andhra Pradesh? (name)

Answer: _____

Q5.

Absence of reliable and mutually accepted ____ data has contributed to the deadlock. (one word)

Answer: _____

Q6.

How many River Boards have been created under the River Boards Act, 1956 so far? (as a number)

Answer: _____

Q7.

Who is the Chairman of a River Board under the River Boards Act, 1956? (position)

Answer: _____

Panchayati Raj committees

Rural development in India was shaped in the early 1950s by two government efforts, the Community Development Programme and the National Extension Service. Their performance needed a closer look, so the government set up a committee to examine how they were working and to suggest measures for their better functioning. Its most important proposal was a scheme of

democratic decentralisation. This scheme later came to be known as Panchayati Raj. The idea was first put into practice in one State before other States followed. Over the following decades, more committees reviewed how these institutions were functioning. Some studied the administrative arrangements behind rural programmes, while others examined whether panchayats should be recognised and protected in the Constitution. Each report reflected a continuing effort to make local governance more effective. Panchayati Raj thus became a subject of national discussion, not just of local administration. A later constitutional amendment gave panchayats a fixed place in the Constitution, turning them from an experiment into a permanent feature of Indian governance. The journey of Panchayati Raj therefore shows how policy ideas, early trials and expert reports together shaped a system of grassroots democracy.

Q1.

In which year was the Balwant Rai Mehta Committee constituted? (year)

Answer: _____

Q2.

Which state was the first to establish Panchayati Raj, at Nagaur on 2 October 1959? (one word)

Answer: _____

Q3.

How many tiers did the Ashok Mehta Committee (1977) recommend for Panchayati Raj? (in number)

Answer: _____

Q4.

Under which leader's government was the L.M. Singhvi Committee appointed in 1986? (name)

Answer: _____

Q5.

Which committee (1985) reviewed administrative arrangements for Rural Development and Poverty Alleviation Programmes? (name)

Answer: _____

Q6.

Which government appointed the Ashok Mehta Committee in 1977? (one word)

Answer: _____

Q7.

Who is known as the 'Father of Panchayati Raj'? (name)

Answer: _____

Tools of the Central Bank

Monetary policy works through a set of instruments that the central bank can adjust to influence borrowing, spending and investment. The most closely watched of these is the Repo Rate, which sets the cost at which banks borrow from the central bank when they face a short-term shortage of cash. The Reverse Repo Rate moves in the other direction, since it is the rate at which the central bank borrows from banks. Changes in these rates affect loan prices across the economy. When rates rise, businesses and households face costlier loans, and demand slows. When rates fall, borrowing becomes cheaper and spending tends to pick up. Central banks, however, do not rely on one tool alone. They also set rules on how much money banks must hold, buy and sell securities in the market, and provide special windows for banks that need overnight funds. Careful use of the instruments helps keep prices stable while supporting a healthy pace of economic expansion.

Q1.

Which liquidity requirement, a statutory minimum share of deposits held as cash, gold or other securities, does the RBI raise to tighten monetary policy? (abbreviation)

Answer: _____

Q2.

Which RBI lending rate is described as long-term, in contrast to the short-term Repo Rate? (two words)

Answer: _____

Q3.

Which window lets banks borrow overnight funds at a rate higher than the Repo Rate? (abbreviation)

Answer: _____

Q4.

What is the abbreviation of the operation in which the central bank buys or sells government securities to inject or absorb durable liquidity?

Answer: _____

Q5.

Which ratio requires banks to hold a proportion of their deposits as cash with the RBI? (abbreviation)

Answer: _____

Q6.

At what rate, in per cent, did the RBI's Monetary Policy Committee keep the Repo Rate unchanged in its latest review?

Answer: _____

Digital Trade Recall

Digital trade became one of the most debated areas at the recent WTO Ministerial Conference. For a long time, members had kept a standing commitment that stopped them from taxing electronic transmissions. That commitment ended at the conference because members could not agree to renew it, so the question of taxing digital goods and services is now open. The outcome also reflected a deep North-South divide among members on several issues. Some members have chosen a different route. A group of members has advanced talks on a plurilateral agreement on electronic commerce. The proposed agreement focuses on areas such as data flows, digital transactions and consumer protection. These talks have moved forward even though the moratorium itself was not renewed. Digital goods and services cover a broad range of activities. Software, music, films and digital services all fall within the moratorium's coverage. The Appellate Body, which reviews decisions made by dispute panels, has also been part of the wider debate about how the WTO resolves disputes. Dispute settlement reform is one of the agenda items that members could not conclude at the conference.

Q1.

In which year was the standing moratorium on customs duties on electronic transmissions first put in place? (year)

Answer: _____

Q2.

How many WTO members were in the coalition advancing talks on the plurilateral e-Commerce agreement? (number)

Answer: _____

Q3.

Which agreement's safeguard against non-violation complaints lapsed at MC14? (one word, acronym)

Answer: _____

Q4.

By which Ministerial Conference does the WTO aim to finalise its pending outcomes? (answer as MC number, e.g. MC12)

Answer: _____

Q5.

In which year was the Investment Facilitation for Development Agreement finalised? (year)

Answer: _____

Q6.

In which year did the Appellate Body become non-functional? (year)

Answer: _____

India's framework check

India manages air pollution through several tools that work at different stages. The first is a public information tool, a national index that converts complex pollution readings into simple categories from good to severe, so that citizens can understand the air they breathe. The second is an emergency framework. Its measures are triggered only when air quality worsens from one stage to a more dangerous one, and their purpose is to prevent further deterioration. The Supreme Court approved this emergency framework in a case concerning the environment. The third is a long-term national programme. It asks cities identified as non-attainment to reduce average particulate levels within a fixed period, and an online portal supports the tracking of its progress. The fourth is a monitoring initiative run by a government ministry, which provides city-wide and localised air quality information for major metropolitan areas and also issues weather forecasts and research. Each tool serves a different purpose, and none of them works alone. Public categories help people judge how careful to be on bad days, while emergency steps are reserved for the most severe deterioration. Long-term programmes address pollution that persists over many months and years, and monitoring tells authorities where action is needed. Together, these tools link public information, emergency response and long-term planning.

Q1.

Which central body launched the National Air Quality Index in 2014?

Answer: _____

Q2.

In which year did the Supreme Court approve the Graded Response Action Plan (GRAP)?

Answer: _____

Q3.

In which year was the National Clean Air Programme (NCAP) launched?

Answer: _____

Q4.

How many non-attainment cities does the National Clean Air Programme cover? (give a number)

Answer: _____

Q5.

What is the targeted reduction in average particulate matter concentrations under NCAP by 2026, in per cent?

Answer: _____

Q6.

Which ministry runs SAFAR, the city-wide air quality monitoring initiative?

Answer: _____

Q7.

Which portal was launched to track NCAP progress and regulate air pollution in non-attainment cities?

Answer: _____

India's energy programme

Energy security has become a central goal for any country that depends on imported fuel. Nuclear power is one tool for this goal, because a small amount of fuel can produce a large amount of electricity. Its expansion also raises questions about waste, safety and the long-term supply of raw material. Planners have therefore looked for ways to close the fuel cycle, so that used fuel is recycled rather than simply stored. Such a plan also aims to reduce dependence on imports, which is why it attracts so much attention.

Such a plan works best when the programme is carefully staged. Each stage is meant to make better use of the country's resources than the one before it. Every stage brings its own engineering challenges, from choosing the moderator and coolant to designing the reactor core. Staging also gives engineers time to build skills and test new technology before the next step.

Nuclear facilities in the country must follow national rules and are checked by a regulator that oversees nuclear and radiation activities. The programme is described as supporting a clean, low-carbon energy transition. Progress is therefore measured not only in megawatts but also in less waste, more domestic fuel and the building of skills that place the country among the world's advanced nuclear nations.

Q1.

Which country was the first to operate a commercial-scale Fast Breeder Reactor, before India? (name of the country)

Answer: _____

Q2.

What is the mass number of the uranium isotope that surrounds the PFBR core as a breeder blanket? (number only)

Answer: _____

Q3.

How many nuclear power reactors is India presently operating? (number)

Answer: _____

Q4.

Which plant is India's newest and largest nuclear power plant? (name of the plant)

Answer: _____

Q5.

Which Indian state hosts Tarapur, India's first and oldest nuclear power plant? (name of the state)

Answer: _____

Q6.

Which material serves as the coolant in Stage I (PHWR) reactors of India's programme? (two words)

Answer: _____

Q7.

Who formulated India's three-stage nuclear power programme? (full name)

Answer: _____

Arihant-Class Short Answer Set

Nuclear-powered submarines come in several types, and each type is built for a different role. One type carries conventional weapons, another carries guided missiles with conventional warheads, and a third carries ballistic missiles that may be nuclear armed. The third type is typically the largest and most complex of the group. Submarines of this kind are valued for stealth, which comes from low noise, along with extended submerged operations and improved survivability. India's Arihant-class submarines form part of this picture. The specifications of these submarines are classified, so any sketch of them is only an approximation, and readers should treat such drawings with caution. The programme behind these vessels aimed to create an indigenous submarine fleet with outside help. Taken together, these points show how the class fits into India's wider strategic planning. Readers studying this area often connect design features with the role each submarine plays in a country's defence. The booklet describes stealth as a benefit of these vessels, and it lists extended submerged operations and improved survivability alongside it. The class has been described in terms of its power, its launch capacity and its displacement, though some figures are not publicly confirmed. This is why sketches should be read as approximations rather than exact engineering drawings. Students should keep these categories distinct when answering questions on submarines.

Q1.

In which year was INS Arighaat commissioned? (year)

Answer: _____

Q2.

How many submarines does the booklet's Arihant-class comparison cover? (number)

Answer: _____

Q3.

Which submarine did India commission as its 3rd nuclear-powered ballistic missile submarine? (name)

Answer: _____

Q4.

What does SSGN stand for? (full expansion)

Answer: _____

Q5.

What does SSN stand for? (full expansion)

Answer: _____

Q6.

Which Arihant-class submarine is described as much more technologically advanced than INS Arihant? (name)

Answer: _____

Human spaceflight and Gaganyaan

Human spaceflight has a history that began in the early 1960s, when a cosmonaut from the Soviet Union became the first person to travel into space. Soon after, Alan Shepard became the first American in space as part of Project Mercury, and a woman later joined the list of people who have flown. Several other countries have since carried out their own human spaceflight efforts. India is preparing its own human spaceflight programme, called Gaganyaan, which will be India's first such programme and a new stage for the country's space work. The programme aims to send a crew into orbit for a short stay and bring them back safely. Its crew will be selected from a group of astronaut designates, and only some of them will fly on the final mission. Training for the crew takes place at a dedicated centre in an Indian city. An application named SAKHI will help the crew by monitoring their health, reminding them of their dietary schedules and keeping them connected with the ground.

Q1.

Who was the first human to travel into space? (name)

Answer: _____

Q2.

In which year did Valentina Tereshkova become the first woman to enter space? (year)

Answer: _____

Q3.

Which Indian astronaut flew to space aboard Soyuz T-11 in 1984? (name)

Answer: _____

Q4.

How many of the four Gaganyaan astronaut designates will be selected for the final mission? (number)

Answer: _____

Q5.

What is the name of the half-humanoid woman robot astronaut that will fly ahead of Gaganyaan? (name)

Answer: _____

Q6.

Which ISRO centre developed the SAKHI app? (full name of the centre)

Answer: _____

Q7.

In which city is the Human Space Flight Centre that trains Gaganyaan crew located? (city)

Answer: _____

India's recent chess results

Indian chess has produced a run of strong results in recent years. In 2024, the Indian men's and women's teams made history at the 45th Chess Olympiad by winning a gold medal, the first such gold for the country. The same year, Gukesh Dommaraju became the World Chess Champion after defeating Ding Liren of China. Later, he beat Magnus Carlsen in a classical game at Norway Chess 2025. Women's chess has also produced important results. Divya Deshmukh won the FIDE Women's World Cup 2025 by defeating Koneru Humpy in the final, and she became the third winner of the title. Humpy, India's highest-rated female chess player, has had a long career that includes a Women's World Rapid Chess Championship title. The junior ranks have also delivered results. GM Pranav Venkatesh won the FIDE World Junior Chess Championship 2025 in Montenegro, adding his name to the list of Indian champions in that event. Such wins show that Indian players are winning titles at several levels of the game. In 2025, Indian players also took

part in top events such as Norway Chess. India also hosted the Chess World Cup 2025, a major event on the global calendar.

Q1.

In which city in Georgia was the FIDE Women's World Cup 2025 held? (city)

Answer: _____

Q2.

Pranav Venkatesh was which numbered Indian to win the FIDE World Junior Chess Championship? (give the number)

Answer: _____

Q3.

In which city was the 45th Chess Olympiad held in 2024? (city)

Answer: _____

Q4.

In which year did Koneru Humpy win the Women's World Rapid Chess Championship title? (year)

Answer: _____

Q5.

Who was the first Indian to defeat Magnus Carlsen in classical chess? (name)

Answer: _____

Q6.

Anish Sarkar, the youngest chess player ever ranked by FIDE, is from which city? (city)

Answer: _____

Diplomacy Check

Diplomacy in April 2026 focused on two very different relationships. The United States and Iran agreed to a temporary ceasefire after a prolonged conflict, which paused the escalation of tensions in the region. Formal peace talks were planned to follow, and they were to be led by the United States Vice President. The arrangement remained fragile. The United States kept its military forces ready for combat, and Iran warned that it could close the Strait of Hormuz again if hostilities continued. The nuclear issue also stayed unresolved, with Washington demanding the complete dismantling of key nuclear sites.

India and South Korea, meanwhile, moved their ties forward during a visit by South Korean President Lee Jae-myung. The two countries elevated their relationship to a Futuristic Partnership under a Joint Strategic Vision. Several agreements were signed, including cooperation on maritime skills and training. The partners also agreed to work together on artificial intelligence, next-generation information technology and joint research and development. Trade between the two countries is large, and South Korea has become a major investor in India. Defence cooperation includes the co-production of the K9 Vajra-T gun system, and the two sides plan to mark a shared friendship year in the future.

Q1.

On what day of April 2026 were formal US-Iran peace talks to begin?

Answer: _____

Q2.

For how many weeks did the United States and Iran agree to a ceasefire? (in weeks)

Answer: _____

Q3.

What was the approximate India-South Korea trade volume in FY 2024-25? (in USD billion)

Answer: _____

Q4.

How many MoUs did India and South Korea sign during President Lee Jae-myung's visit?

Answer: _____

Q5.

Which international solar grouping did South Korea join?

Answer: _____

Q6.

From which year does the India-ROK Year of Friendship period begin?

Answer: _____

Q7.

Which country was excluded from the US-Iran ceasefire?

Answer: _____

International Groupings TITA

International cooperation in April 2026 covered energy, peacekeeping and economic governance. India's External Affairs Minister took part in a meeting of a regional platform that works on clean energy transition and energy security in Asia, where energy market disruptions were discussed. The platform was proposed by Japan and seeks to promote decarbonisation and sustainable energy systems across the region.

India also condemned the killing of Indonesian peacekeepers serving with a United Nations force in Lebanon. That force monitors the ceasefire between Israel and Lebanon, patrols the boundary between them, supports humanitarian access for civilians and assists the Lebanese Armed Forces. Its purpose includes verifying the withdrawal of Israeli forces from southern Lebanon.

At the United Nations, India was elected unopposed to four subsidiary bodies of the Economic and Social Council for the period 2026 to 2028. The Council is one of the principal organs of the United Nations and acts as a central platform for global economic, social and environmental issues.

The Group of Seven is an informal forum that works without a treaty and has no permanent secretariat. It brings together advanced economies along with the European Union, and its decisions are taken by consensus. India's External Affairs Minister was invited to the G7 Foreign Ministers' Meeting in France as a partner.

Q1.

In which year was the Asia Zero Emission Community (AZEC) launched? (year)

Answer: _____

Q2.

In which city is the headquarters of the UN Economic and Social Council located?

Answer: _____

Q3.

In which year did the G7 begin as the G6 forum? (year)

Answer: _____

Q4.

Which country joined the G6 in 1976, turning it into the G7? (country)

Answer: _____

Q5.

How many member States does the UN Economic and Social Council have? (number)

Answer: _____

Q6.

In which year did the UN Security Council create the UN Interim Force in Lebanon (UNIFIL)? (year)

Answer: _____

PIO and OCI Schemes: Typed Answer Practice

The booklet compares two schemes for people of Indian heritage living abroad: the Persons of Indian Origin (PIO) scheme and the Overseas Citizens of India (OCI) scheme. The OCI scheme began as an amendment to the Citizenship Act, and the two schemes were later merged into one arrangement.

A foreign citizen qualifies as a PIO when a parent, grandparent or great-grandparent was born in India and was a permanent resident of India. The definition also covers a foreign citizen who is the spouse of a citizen of India or of a PIO, and it excludes nationals of certain countries. PIO card holders have parity with NRIs in economic, financial and educational benefits.

OCI registration is open to certain foreign nationals with links to India. Minor children of an eligible person are also eligible. OCI holders are exempt from police reporting for any length of stay in the country. They enjoy parity with NRIs in the economic, financial and education fields, but they have no right to acquire agricultural or plantation properties.

The booklet describes both categories with their eligibility and benefits. It presents these rules for each scheme separately, under the heading PIO VS OCI, and lists the benefits of each category in turn.

Q1.

For how many years from the date of issue does a PIO card holder need no visa to visit India? (answer in years)

Answer: _____

Q2.

Up to what length of stay, in days, is a PIO exempt from registration at FRRO/FRO?

Answer: _____

Q3.

If a PIO's stay goes beyond that limit, within how many days must the PIO register with FRRO/FRO? (answer in days)

Answer: _____

Q4.

Persons who were eligible to become citizens of India on which date (DD.MM.YYYY) qualify for OCI registration?

Answer: _____

Q5.

Persons from a territory that became part of India after which date (DD.MM.YYYY) are eligible for OCI registration?

Answer: _____

Q6.

Apart from Pakistan, a person who was ever a citizen of which country is ineligible for OCI registration?

Answer: _____

Q7.

Besides 'multipurpose' and 'lifelong', what single word describes the entry type of the OCI visa?

Answer: _____

Sri Lanka Profile: Typed Answer Practice

The booklet covers Sri Lanka's leadership, currency and international relations. The country's President is Anura Kumara Dissanayake, and its currency is the Sri Lankan Rupee. The profile also names the Palk Strait as the border between India and Sri Lanka.

The Liberation Tigers of Tamil Eelam was formed in 1976 as a self-styled 'National Freedom Movement of People of Tamil Eelam'. The group undertook terrorist activities in Sri Lanka. The booklet also links the LTTE to the assassination of Rajiv Gandhi, a former Prime Minister of India.

India and Sri Lanka jointly commission a Maritime Rescue Coordination Centre in Sri Lanka. The booklet lists the Sampur Solar Power Plant under development cooperation, and it lists the naval exercises SLINEX and MILAN among joint exercises between the two countries. The booklet also records the completion of Phase III of the Indian Housing Project, and it lists Memoranda of Understanding signed under a Multi-Sectoral Grant Assistance Programme, with healthcare and women's empowerment as focus areas.

Sri Lanka's multilateral cooperation includes BIMSTEC, SAARC and the Indian Ocean Rim Association. The India-Sri Lanka Free Trade Agreement was signed in 2000, and Sri Lanka joined the International Big Cat Alliance during the Vice President's visit. This topic appears in the April 2026 issue of the booklet.

Q1.

Who is the Prime Minister of Sri Lanka?

Answer: _____

Q2.

Which city is the executive capital of Sri Lanka?

Answer: _____

Q3.

Which numbered amendment to the Sri Lankan Constitution led to the creation of Provincial Councils? (give the number only)

Answer: _____

Q4.

How many Chinese vessels are named in the booklet as conducting data collection? (answer as a number)

Answer: _____

Q5.

Which Sri Lankan city is being developed as a Regional Energy and Industrial Hub with Indian support?

Answer: _____

Q6.

Which port in Sri Lanka is part of China's growing influence through financial aid?

Answer: _____

Q7.

Which branch of the armed forces takes part in the India-Sri Lanka exercise MITRA SHAKTI?

Answer: _____

Delimitation and the Commission: Typed Answer Quiz

Delimitation is the process of drawing the boundaries of territorial constituencies so that representation stays fair as population changes. Over time, some constituencies grow much larger than others, which means that a vote in one area can carry less weight than a vote in another. For this reason, boundaries are not drawn once and left alone. Each redrawing exercise is carried out by a body called a Delimitation Commission, which is set up for that purpose. Such Commissions have been created under several Acts passed over a period of decades. They have not been appointed after every census, and at certain points the seat allocation among States was frozen to protect States that had controlled their population growth. Later changes to the Constitution continued these freezes. The same principle of fair representation also applies to the division of constituencies for State Assemblies, which follows its own constitutional provisions. Because the freeze was tied to population counts, the timing of the next redrawing has become a central question in the present debate over expanding the Lok Sabha. The question is not only how many seats exist but also how they are spread across regions. This makes the process both technical and politically sensitive, since every change in boundaries affects the candidates and voters in each area.

Q1.

In which year was the most recent Delimitation Commission listed in the booklet formed under an Act? (year)

Answer: _____

Q2.

Which body does the President consult before appointing the Delimitation Commission? (name)

Answer: _____

Q3.

Under which Article is the division of constituencies for State Assemblies governed? (Article number)

Answer: _____

Q4.

Apart from a retired Supreme Court judge, which constitutional office holder is a member of the Delimitation Commission? (title)

Answer: _____

Q5.

In which year was the earliest Delimitation Commission listed in the booklet formed? (year)

Answer: _____

Q6.

What quality is the Commission described as having, since it functions without executive influence? (one word)

Answer: _____

Q7.

Apart from Scheduled Castes and Scheduled Tribes, for which group does the Commission decide reservations? (one word)

Answer: _____

Concerns and Consequences: Typed Answer Quiz

The proposed expansion of the Lok Sabha has been debated mainly for its effects on different parts of the country. Supporters of the change argue that a larger House would bring elected representatives closer to the people they serve, making it easier for citizens to raise their problems and seek a response. Critics reply that the benefits are not shared evenly, because the new seat arrangement would affect States differently depending on how their populations have grown over time. Some argue that the population figures used for the exercise may no longer match present conditions, and that the effects could last for many years. Others point to the design of the framework itself and ask how much room the rules leave for choices made at different stages. The discussion has also drawn in committees, public commentary and political parties, each setting out its own view of the reform. Taken together, these views show a debate about how representation, federal balance and effective governance should be weighed against one another. Each side supports its position with a different set of concerns about the design of the change and its likely results in the years ahead. Local perspectives on the issue also vary across regions, and this variation is part of why the debate remains open.

Q1.

To what approximate percentage would the Southern States' share of Lok Sabha seats fall? (per cent)

Answer: _____

Q2.

Removing judicial review is said to carry a risk of which practice? (one word)

Answer: _____

Q3.

Population-based delimitation is said to violate which principle of federalism? (two words)

Answer: _____

Q4.

Census dependency is cited as a reason for delay in implementing which reservation? (two words)

Answer: _____

Q5.

Political weight tied to population may influence allocations by which Commission? (name)

Answer: _____

Q6.

Which constitutional amendment is cited as being supported by the expansion? (number)

Answer: _____

Q7.

In joint sittings, the dominance of the Lok Sabha dilutes the federal role of which chamber? (name)

Answer: _____

Constitutional and legal framework: short answer

India's census draws its legal backing from more than one source. The Constitution places the power to conduct a census with the Union, and the relevant entry appears in the list of matters on which the Union may legislate. A central Act provides the statutory mandate and makes participation compulsory for those being counted. Separate constitutional provisions deal with how Lok Sabha seats are distributed and how constituencies are delimited after a fixed date. A constitutional amendment from the early 2000s holds Lok Sabha seat allocation on older census figures for a set period. The census is managed by the Registrar General and Census Commissioner of India, a senior official whose name is given in the booklet. Results from the census also support the National Population Register, the planning of healthcare, education and infrastructure, and the work of other surveys, which can use the census as a benchmark. Taken together, these arrangements connect a national count to representation, administration and public planning in one legal framework. Each of these elements is set out separately in the booklet. Phase I of the census is a house listing and housing census, and the exercise is described as the world's largest fully digital enumeration.

Q1.

Under which Article of the Constitution does the Union get the power to conduct the census? (number)

Answer: _____

Q2.

Which entry of the Union List covers the power to conduct the census? (entry number)

Answer: _____

Q3.

Which two Articles deal with Lok Sabha seat distribution and delimitation after 2026? (give the two numbers)

Answer: _____

Q4.

In which year was the 84th Constitutional Amendment Act passed? (year)

Answer: _____

Q5.

In which year was the Census Act passed, giving the census its legal mandate? (year)

Answer: _____

Q6.

The 84th Amendment froze Lok Sabha seat allocation using data from which census? (year)

Answer: _____

NPR, CAA and NRC: short answer

Census 2027 is discussed alongside several related exercises that are often confused with it. The first is a national database of residents, which is linked to the census through the forms used to update it. The second is a law that concerns refugees who entered India from neighbouring countries and belong to certain religious communities, and it sets a date by which they must have arrived. The third is a list of people who are citizens of India and hold valid identity documents, and only one state is described as updating it. Concerns have been raised that the database overlaps with another national identity system, but the government has argued that the two have different aims. The Census Act provides the legal framework within which the census operates, and the Union government conducts it. The census itself covers the whole population and is organised in phases, with house listing first. The booklet presents these exercises as distinct, with different

coverage and purposes. Its table shows who is in scope and gives a definition for each exercise, which allows direct comparison. The booklet also lists the government's replies to public questions, and it treats the residence period and the arrival date as key conditions for coverage.

Q1.

By what date must minority refugees have come to India to be covered by the law? (date)

Answer: _____

Q2.

How many neighbouring countries are named as sources of minority refugees under the law? (number)

Answer: _____

Q3.

What is the short form of the law covering minority refugees from neighbouring countries? (abbreviation)

Answer: _____

Q4.

What is the short form of the register of citizens of India who hold valid identity documents? (abbreviation)

Answer: _____

Q5.

The government says the database of residents does not duplicate which other national identity system? (one word)

Answer: _____

Q6.

Which register covers every resident, including foreigners? (abbreviation)

Answer: _____

SAMADHAN and Tribal Schemes

The booklet presents the government's response to Left Wing Extremism in several parts. One part is a security doctrine named SAMADHAN, whose letters stand for a set of elements that guide planning and operations. Operations are also supported by Company Operating Bases, which are used to penetrate remote zones. The Greyhounds operate as an elite commando force, and the Bastariya Battalion is made up of local recruits who know the language and terrain. A second part of the response is a set of development programmes for tribal regions. The Dharti Aaba Janjatiya Gram Utkarsh Abhiyan works in tribal villages, the Van Dhan Vikas Kendra works through clusters, and PM-JANMAN is meant for tribal groups living in remote habitations. The Bandyopadhyay Committee, an earlier review of tribal conditions, highlighted governance gaps and discrimination. Its report recommended that land acquisition and rehabilitation be made friendlier to tribals. Special Central Assistance is provided to support public infrastructure and services. Financial action has also been taken, with agencies such as the National Investigation Agency and the Enforcement Directorate seizing assets and disrupting urban funding networks. The government set 31 March 2026 as the deadline to eliminate Left Wing Extremism. The Surrender-cum-Rehabilitation Policy offers cash benefits and skill training to those who give up.

Q1.

How many elements does the SAMADHAN doctrine contain? (give the number)

Answer: _____

Q2.

In which state is the Bastariya Battalion located?

Answer: _____

Q3.

PM-JANMAN targets how many PVTGs? (give the number)

Answer: _____

Q4.

In which year is the Bandyopadhyay Committee dated? (give the year)

Answer: _____

Q5.

What does the letter S stand for in the SAMADHAN doctrine? (give the two-word element)

Answer: _____

Q6.

What does the letter H stand for in the SAMADHAN doctrine? (give the two-word element)

Answer: _____

Q7.

What does the letter D stand for in the SAMADHAN doctrine? (give the element as written in the booklet)

Answer: _____

UCC Background: TITA Practice

Gujarat has passed the Uniform Civil Code Bill 2026, becoming the second state after Uttarakhand to enact such a code. The need for a uniform law was first considered during the colonial period, and the question has been debated in different forms ever since. Personal laws govern matters such as marriage, divorce and succession, and the Gujarat code aims to replace diverse religious personal laws on these matters. The Constitution contains a provision that urges the state to establish a uniform civil code for all citizens. Historically, the adoption of such a code has been controversial. The Law Commission has revived the idea in recent years and has gathered public views on it. Uttarakhand's code incorporates elements from existing laws but leaves out certain concepts found in other personal laws. The Supreme Court has also called for implementing a uniform code in many cases. The Gujarat law also seeks to ensure equal inheritance rights for sons and daughters, and its monogamy rule prohibits polygamy and bigamy. The booklet notes that the code is a progressive reform, but that it risks deepening societal divisions in the context of upcoming elections, where justice should take precedence over the pursuit of uniformity.

Q1.

Which report of 1840 first considered the need for a uniform law in India?

Answer: _____

Q2.

In which year did the colonial government form the B N Rau Committee?

Answer: _____

Q3.

How many Bills constituted the Hindu Code Bills?

Answer: _____

Q4.

The principle underlying a UCC is that laws should be religion-neutral and which other term?

Answer: _____

Q5.

Personal laws on marriage, divorce and succession are placed under which list of the Constitution?

Answer: _____

Q6.

Article 44 is part of which constitutional category that is not enforceable?

Answer: _____

Q7.

In which year was the Hindu Succession Act adopted to codify intestate succession?

Answer: _____

UCC Arguments: TITA Practice

Supporters present the Uniform Civil Code as a progressive goal, and the Gujarat Bill is part of that case. The Gujarat law seeks to replace diverse personal laws on marriage, divorce and inheritance with a single civil framework that applies across the state. The Gujarat Bill follows Uttarakhand, which was the first state after pre-Independence Goa to adopt such a code.

The case for the code rests on the idea that personal laws should not lead to unequal treatment of citizens in family life. Supporters also say the code can address unfair treatment within families, and that a common law would let citizens rely on the same rules in family matters, whatever their background.

The Central Government has described different property and matrimonial laws for different communities as a threat to the nation's unity, and it has favoured a common code. The Constitution also contains a provision that urges the state to work towards such a code, so the idea has a constitutional basis.

Critics, however, have raised concerns about the code's effect on individual freedoms in matters of faith. The booklet notes that the subject carries risks in the context of upcoming elections, and it argues that justice should come before uniformity.

Q1.

According to critics, some civil laws are inseparably connected with beliefs and practices of which kind? (one word)

Answer: _____

Q2.

What kind of practices against women does the UCC aim to eliminate?

Answer: _____

Q3.

Critics fear that UCC implementation could be politically exploited, leading to what?

Answer: _____

Q4.

The UCC is presented as a way to promote which kind of equality?

Answer: _____

Q5.

The UCC is presented as aligning the law with the nature of which kind of state?

Answer: _____

Q6.

Critics say a UCC might not adequately accommodate the unique what and sensitivities of different communities? (one word)

Answer: _____

Q7.

The UCC is presented as a way to reform which kind of practices?

Answer: _____

Legal framework: TITA practice

The Mahanadi dispute between Odisha and Chhattisgarh concerns how the river's water is shared, especially in the non-monsoon season, when water flowing downstream becomes critically important. The absence of a formal inter-state water-sharing agreement has added to the conflict, and Odisha has argued that upstream construction in Chhattisgarh has reduced the flow reaching its own territory. Chhattisgarh, for its part, maintains that it has a legitimate right to use river waters and that its projects serve regional development.

Such disputes are handled through a separate arrangement. The Constitution provides for them, and the law built on it allows a tribunal to be set up when a dispute needs adjudication. The tribunal then issues its decision, and the matter is decided on the basis of available evidence and legal principles.

The Mahanadi tribunal has expressed concern about repeated adjournments and the lack of substantive progress in talks. It has observed that no concrete proposals have been placed on record, despite assurances of settlement efforts. The tribunal has therefore given both states a final opportunity to agree on a formula.

Other river disputes in the country have also been handled through tribunals, each set up for a particular river. Read together, these cases show that water sharing between states is governed by a special framework rather than by routine legal channels.

Q1.

Under which Article of the Constitution can Parliament adjudicate disputes relating to inter-state rivers? (number)

Answer: _____

Q2.

Under which entry of the Union List can the Union regulate and develop inter-state rivers in public interest? (number)

Answer: _____

Q3.

Under which entry of the State List do states get powers over water supplies and irrigation? (number)

Answer: _____

Q4.

What is the minimum number of times per year that a River Board must meet? (numeral)

Answer: _____

Q5.

What does the Centre first try among aggrieved states before constituting a tribunal? (one word)

Answer: _____

Q6.

In which year was the River Boards Act enacted? (four digits)

Answer: _____

Q7.

According to the booklet, the Supreme Court cannot question a tribunal's award or formula but can question its _____. (one word)

Answer: _____

River course: TITA practice

The Mahanadi is at the centre of a long-running dispute because its water supports many activities along its course. Downstream areas rely on the river for irrigation, drinking water, fisheries and the wider ecology of the area. When flow declines, these uses come under strain, and the concern becomes most acute during the non-monsoon season.

The river is fed by a network of tributaries that join it along its length. Its waters therefore reflect conditions across a large catchment, and activities in upstream areas can affect what reaches the lower reaches. Upstream construction is one such activity, and it has been cited as a reason for falling downstream flow. Water reaching any point along the river thus depends on conditions upstream.

Large infrastructure also lies on the river. Among these works is a dam that has been a major point of attention in discussions of the river. The presence of such structures makes it harder to assess the river's flow without reliable information. Such works are discussed in relation to the river's flow and its sharing among states.

The booklet includes a map of the river, which helps readers follow its path through the region. Its course is described in a short section that covers the river's main features. The booklet's summary is brief, so the map and text together give a basic picture of the river.

Q1.

Name the hill where the Mahanadi originates. (name)

Answer: _____

Q2.

Into which water body does the Mahanadi finally empty? (name)

Answer: _____

Q3.

Which Indian state does the Mahanadi flow through before reaching the sea? (name)

Answer: _____

Q4.

How many tributaries join the Mahanadi from its left bank? (number)

Answer: _____

Q5.

Name the left bank tributary that is listed first in the booklet. (name)

Answer: _____

Q6.

Which bank of the Mahanadi do the Jonk, Ong and Tel tributaries join? (left or right)

Answer: _____

Q7.

In which Indian state is the origin of the Mahanadi located? (name)

Answer: _____

Other tribunals: TITA practice

India has several inter-state water tribunals, and each one has been set up for a particular river dispute. The booklet lists tribunals formed at different points over the years, and each entry links a tribunal to the states involved in that dispute. Several states appear in more than one tribunal, so disputes over different rivers can involve the same state.

The Mahanadi tribunal is one of the bodies in the table. It was set up to resolve the sharing of the Mahanadi's waters between the two states along the river. The tribunal has been dissatisfied with repeated adjournments and a lack of progress, and it has granted both states a final opportunity to reach a formula.

The booklet presents the tribunals in a table with three columns: the name of each tribunal, its year of formation, and the states involved. The table covers five tribunals in total. Each entry records the name, the year and the states, so the table gives a compact summary of the disputes it covers.

Taken together, these entries show that India has used separate tribunals for separate rivers, each tied to its own set of states. The table is part of a wider discussion in the booklet about inter-state river disputes and the legal framework for resolving them.

Q1.

In which year was the Krishna Water Disputes Tribunal II formed? (four digits)

Answer: _____

Q2.

In which year was the Ravi & Beas Water Tribunal formed? (four digits)

Answer: _____

Q3.

In which year was the Mahadayi Water Disputes Tribunal formed? (four digits)

Answer: _____

Q4.

Which tribunal covers Karnataka, Goa and Maharashtra? (name)

Answer: _____

Q5.

Which tribunal covers Rajasthan, Haryana and Punjab? (name)

Answer: _____

Q6.

How many states are involved in the Krishna Water Disputes Tribunal II? (as a number)

Answer: _____

Q7.

Which state, along with Chhattisgarh, is party to the Mahanadi Water Disputes Tribunal? (name)

Answer: _____

Event details of National Panchayati Raj Day

National Panchayati Raj Day is an occasion to reflect on local self-government in India. The day marks the enforcement of a constitutional amendment that was aimed at strengthening grassroots democracy and decentralised governance. The bill for this amendment was introduced in the Lok Sabha in September 1991, when a Congress government was in office. The amendment is described as having several important effects. Inclusive development ensures the participation of marginalised groups in local decisions. Localised planning promotes need-based development in villages and districts. Digital transformation is also listed among its significant effects. The amendment added a new Part to the Constitution, titled The Panchayats, and a new schedule that lists subjects for panchayats. It provides for a three-tier structure of panchayats at the village, intermediate and district levels. The amendment also provides that a state with a population not exceeding twenty lakh may skip the intermediate level of panchayats. It also provides for reservation of seats for Scheduled Castes and Scheduled Tribes. Madhya Pradesh was the first state to implement the amendment. The amendment's provisions are set out in Articles 243 to 243-O of the Constitution. Its provisions also deal with the term of panchayats, their finances and the conduct of their elections. Panchayats are the basic units through which these goals are pursued.

Q1.

On which day of April was the 17th National Panchayati Raj Day observed? (day of the month)

Answer: _____

Q2.

Which edition of National Panchayati Raj Day was observed in 2026? (number)

Answer: _____

Q3.

At which venue was the day observed? (name of venue)

Answer: _____

Q4.

Which ministry organised the event? (name of ministry)

Answer: _____

Q5.

Which index measures grassroots development and tracks panchayat performance? (name)

Answer: _____

Q6.

Which awards recognise best-performing panchayats? (name)

Answer: _____

Q7.

What is the first word of the theme of the 17th National Panchayati Raj Day? (one word)

Answer: _____

Elections, reservation and oversight in panchayats

Panchayati Raj institutions are the system of local self-government that the amendment established in rural areas. The amendment added a new Part to the Constitution, titled The Panchayats, and its provisions are set out in Articles 243 to 243-O. Under this framework, panchayats function at three levels, namely the village, intermediate and district levels. The framework also provides for reservation of seats for women, so that women hold a set share of seats and offices in panchayats at each level. A panchayat can be dissolved before it completes its period, and when this happens

fresh elections are needed to constitute a new panchayat. Such elections must be completed within a set period, and where the remaining period is short, an election need not be held. The amendment also added an 11th Schedule that lists subjects for panchayats. The bill for it was introduced in the Lok Sabha in September 1991 under a Congress government. The amendment's significance is described in three heads: inclusive development, which ensures the participation of marginalised groups; localised planning, which promotes need-based development; and digital transformation. Madhya Pradesh was the first state to implement the amendment. The framework was built to strengthen grassroots democracy and decentralised governance.

Q1.

After how many years does the Governor constitute a Finance Commission to review panchayat finances? (number of years)

Answer: _____

Q2.

Within how many months of a panchayat's dissolution must fresh elections be completed? (number of months)

Answer: _____

Q3.

Which body supervises the electoral rolls and the conduct of panchayat elections? (name)

Answer: _____

Q4.

For which state is reservation of seats for Scheduled Castes in panchayats not applicable? (name of state)

Answer: _____

Q5.

Which body determines the manner of electing the village-level chairperson? (name)

Answer: _____

Q6.

What is the minimum share of total seats reserved for women in panchayats? (fraction)

Answer: _____

Q7.

Under which Article are all members of panchayats at each level elected directly? (Article number)

Answer: _____

Exemptions, Union Territories and PESA

The Constitution's panchayat provisions do not apply uniformly to every part of India. Certain states and areas are exempted from the framework, and the amendment's rules set out these exemptions directly. These exemptions cover some states as well as some areas within other states. The framework was added as a new Part titled The Panchayats, consisting of provisions from Articles 243 to 243-O. Its provisions give panchayats a three-tier structure at the village, intermediate and district levels, and they provide for elections and for reservation of seats. The amendment also provides that a state with a population not exceeding twenty lakh may skip the intermediate level of panchayats. The amendment's significance is described under three heads: inclusive development, localised planning and digital transformation. The amendment also added an 11th Schedule that lists subjects for panchayats. Madhya Pradesh was the first state to implement it, and the bill was introduced in the Lok Sabha in September 1991 under a Congress government. Its provisions also deal with the duration of panchayats and their finances. The provisions are meant to strengthen grassroots democracy and decentralised governance. Each of

these features forms part of the framework described above.

Q1.

Under which Article may the President direct that the panchayat provisions apply to a Union Territory? (Article number)

Answer: _____

Q2.

Under which Article was the PESA Act enacted? (Article number)

Answer: _____

Q3.

In which year was the Act popularly known as PESA enacted? (year)

Answer: _____

Q4.

How many states are listed in the booklet as Sixth Schedule states? (number)

Answer: _____

Q5.

Which district of West Bengal is exempted because the Darjeeling Gorkha Hill Council exists? (name of district)

Answer: _____

Q6.

In which state are the Hill Areas exempted where District Councils exist? (name of state)

Answer: _____

Q7.

Apart from Nagaland and Mizoram, which state is named among the states exempted from the framework? (name of state)

Answer: _____

Repo Rate and the Economy: Short Answer

The Reserve Bank of India, which is the country's central bank, manages the financial system through several tools. One of the most watched is the Repo Rate, the rate that acts as the cost of money for the banking system. Changes to this rate travel through the economy. When the rate is set higher, banks face costlier loans, and interest rates for consumers and businesses rise as well. Spending and investment tend to slow in such a situation. When the rate is eased, borrowing becomes cheaper and the overall supply of money in the economy increases, which can help growth. The Monetary Policy Committee decides the rate, and its decisions are based on a majority vote. The Committee meets at least four times each year. In its most recent review, the Committee chose to keep the rate unchanged, as geopolitical tensions in West Asia raised uncertainty about energy prices and trade. Supply-side shocks from global energy and commodity markets can also raise prices without reflecting excess demand. The RBI's role in the financial system is wide, covering monetary authority, supervision of banks, banker to the government and custodian of reserves. The rate is one of several instruments that the RBI can use at different times, depending on conditions in the economy. The aim of policy is to balance price stability with support for economic growth.

Q1.

In which month and year did the RBI cut the Repo Rate by 25 basis points to 5.25%?

Answer: _____

Q2.

The December 2025 cut was which numbered reduction by the RBI? (word or numeral)

Answer: _____

Q3.

What was the total reduction in the Repo Rate by the RBI in 2025, in basis points? (number)

Answer: _____

Q4.

What does a higher Repo Rate do to excessive spending? (one word)

Answer: _____

Q5.

What does the RBI do to the Repo Rate when it needs to pump funds into the economy? (one word)

Answer: _____

Q6.

High levels of what lead the RBI to raise the Repo Rate? (one word)

Answer: _____

Inflation Targeting and the RBI: Short Answer

Inflation targeting is a monetary policy framework in which the central bank aims to keep the inflation rate within a range that is defined in advance. In India, the framework has been shaped by committee recommendations and by government decisions taken over time. The target and the permitted band around it are not chosen by the RBI alone. The government sets them in consultation with the Reserve Bank, and the arrangement is reviewed on a regular cycle. The RBI, for its part, works to maintain price stability while promoting economic growth. It carries out several roles in the financial system, and its supervisory functions also cover the issue of bank licences. It acts as the monetary authority of the country and as a supervisor of commercial banks, and it issues and destroys currency notes. It also acts as banker to the government and as the manager of foreign exchange. Retail inflation is watched against a mandated band set under the framework. The RBI was set up after a commission recommended its establishment, and the British government passed the Act that created it. The RBI also serves as lender of last resort for commercial banks. Taken together, these responsibilities place the RBI at the centre of the country's money and banking system.

Q1.

In which year did India adopt Flexible Inflation Targeting?

Answer: _____

Q2.

What is India's inflation target, in per cent?

Answer: _____

Q3.

Which committee formalised inflation targeting in India in 2014? (name of the committee)

Answer: _____

Q4.

In which city was the RBI established on April 1? (one word)

Answer: _____

Q5.

The 4% target with a 2% band was first proposed by the Chakravarty Committee during which years? (give the span of years)

Answer: _____

Q6.

Once every how many years is the inflation target set by the Government in consultation with the RBI? (number of years)

Answer: _____

Q7.

Retail inflation is required to stay within a mandated band of what range, in per cent?

Answer: _____

MC14 Disputes, Farm and Fisheries Talks

The 14th Ministerial Conference of the WTO was held in Yaoundé, Cameroon, and it ended without consensus. The disagreement reflected a deep North-South divide among members. Several agendas were left open when the meeting closed, and the matters that could not be settled were carried forward to a later meeting.

The dispute settlement system is central to the WTO because it helps members resolve trade disputes. Reform of the system was one of the main agendas before the conference, and the reform aims to restore a binding dispute system.

Agriculture and food security was another contested agenda. Food security was treated as a central concern, and positions on the topic differed among members. The agriculture agenda also covered the reduction of certain subsidies and the question of market access.

Fisheries was a third agenda. The negotiations dealt with subsidies given to the fishing sector, and members discussed how such support might be limited. Some of these subsidy questions remained open when the conference closed, and members agreed to keep negotiating them.

The Ministerial Conference, the organisation's highest decision-making body, is made up of trade ministers and senior officials from member nations and addresses global trade developments. The WTO's mandate covers trade in goods, services and intellectual property.

Q1.

How many tiers does the dispute settlement system that the reform aims to restore have? (one word)

Answer: _____

Q2.

To which WTO body were the issues left unresolved at MC14 deferred? (two words)

Answer: _____

Q3.

In agriculture talks, what does the acronym PSH stand for? (first two words)

Answer: _____

Q4.

Along with India, which group of nations reiterated the demand for a permanent solution on PSH? (one word)

Answer: _____

Q5.

For which fishing fleets did members agree to keep negotiating subsidy curbs? (one hyphenated word)

Answer: _____

Q6.

Besides overfishing, what problem do harmful fisheries subsidies cause? (one word)

Answer: _____

Q7.

Besides market access barriers, what kind of disruptions do developing countries face? (one word)

Answer: _____

Investment Facilitation Agreement Debate

The Investment Facilitation for Development Agreement is among the WTO's most debated pacts, and its place within the organisation has been contested. Supporters see it as part of a wider movement in the WTO toward arrangements among a subset of members. Some members question whether investment belongs within the organisation's core mandate.

The agreement aims to improve how investment procedures work, and it is linked to the broader question of how investment is governed globally, including the move toward standardised investment rules. Developing countries and least developed countries are part of this discussion.

The debate also touches on sovereignty. Members have to weigh the benefits of investment facilitation against the policy space that governments want to keep for their own regulation. A concern raised in the discussions is that the agreement could dilute core WTO principles and expand the organisation's mandate beyond trade facilitation. Such questions are central to the debate.

The WTO itself was established on January 1, 1995, and it facilitates trade in goods, services and intellectual property. Its Ministerial Conference, made up of trade ministers and senior officials, is the organisation's highest decision-making body. The organisation also has a Secretariat and a General Council. Members also have different views on how the agreement fits within the organisation's structure.

Q1.

Under what kind of initiative was the IFD launched? (acronym)

Answer: _____

Q2.

In which city was the MC11 Ministerial Conference, where the IFD was launched, held? (city)

Answer: _____

Q3.

On which principle is the IFD Agreement based? (acronym)

Answer: _____

Q4.

The firewall clause stops IFD rules from overriding which kind of treaties? (acronym)

Answer: _____

Q5.

On which principle does the WTO traditionally work, which JSIs were seen as bypassing? (one word)

Answer: _____

Q6.

Majority supporters of the IFD are linked to which initiative? (acronym)

Answer: _____

Q7.

What kind of tribunals must the IFD's appeal mechanism require for dispute review? (one word)

Answer: _____

Most Polluted Places in the 2025 Report

The World Air Quality Report 2025 was prepared by IQAir, a Swiss company that measures air quality. Its assessments are based on PM2.5, which refers to fine particulate matter measured in micrograms per cubic metre ($\mu\text{g}/\text{m}^3$). The report compares measured concentrations with the air quality guidelines set by the World Health Organisation. The findings are presented as lists of countries, cities and regions, arranged according to how polluted each place is. Each figure is an annual average, so the rankings reflect typical air over a full year rather than a single day. Such lists help readers see at a glance which places have the highest pollution levels. Among countries, the list begins with one nation whose annual PM2.5 level is many times the WHO limit, and several other nations follow it in the ranking. Among cities, the top of the list is a city located in India. The report also notes that many countries fail to meet safe air quality standards, so the problem is widespread rather than confined to a few places. The report also tracks national capitals and regions. One capital has appeared repeatedly at the top of the capitals list, and the regional comparisons show where the heaviest pollution burden falls. Such capital-level comparisons are part of the report's wider coverage.

Q1.

What was Pakistan's annual average PM2.5 level in the 2025 report, in $\mu\text{g}/\text{m}^3$?

Answer: _____

Q2.

Which Indian state contains the most polluted city in the 2025 report?

Answer: _____

Q3.

Which country was placed fourth in the 2025 list of most polluted countries, after Pakistan, Bangladesh and Tajikistan?

Answer: _____

Q4.

How many of the world's 10 most polluted cities in 2025 were located in India?

Answer: _____

Q5.

Name the Indian city, other than Loni, Byrnihat, Delhi and Ghaziabad, that appears among the world's 10 most polluted cities in 2025.

Answer: _____

Q6.

How many of the world's 100 most polluted cities in 2024 were in India?

Answer: _____

Q7.

Which national capital has repeatedly been named the world's most polluted capital in the 2025 report?

Answer: _____

Measures Against Pollution Sources

Air pollution is tackled through measures that target its different sources rather than through a single rule. One group of measures deals with vehicles, using emission standards that apply across the country and encouraging cleaner types of vehicles so that traffic exhaust is reduced. Another group deals with fuels, including clean cooking fuel for households that otherwise depend on biomass, and fuel produced from agricultural waste. Farming is another source covered by these measures. Waste left on fields after harvest has to be managed, and the report describes two tools developed for this purpose. Construction is also addressed, since one measure covers the way buildings are designed and run. Legal protection forms the final layer. Constitutional provisions and several central statutes deal with pollution of air and water and with the wider environment. The measures listed are not all new; some were introduced decades ago, while others are more recent. Some are aimed at households, others at farmers, and others at legal protection. Each measure comes with a short description of what it does, which helps readers compare the tools side by side. Taken together, the listed measures cover vehicles, fuels, farms, construction and the law. Readers can therefore see how each source of pollution is addressed separately.

Q1.

In which year was the Environment Protection Act enacted?

Answer: _____

Q2.

Which scheme provides LPG as a clean cooking fuel to reduce biomass-based cooking?

Answer: _____

Q3.

Which scheme promotes the adoption of electric and hybrid vehicles?

Answer: _____

Q4.

Which Article of the Constitution has been interpreted to include the right to a healthy environment?

Answer: _____

Q5.

In which year was the Clause protecting the natural environment inserted into Article 51A as a Fundamental Duty?

Answer: _____

Q6.

Which institute developed the Pusa Bio-Decomposer?

Answer: _____

Q7.

How many days does the Pusa Bio-Decomposer take to turn crop residue into manure?

Answer: _____

PFBR waste, fuel and efficiency

India's nuclear power programme is organised in three stages, and its purpose is to achieve long-term energy security using the country's uranium and thorium resources. The first is energy

security, which maximises the use of limited uranium reserves and unlocks India's large thorium reserves. The second is technological advancement, which positions India among the global leaders in advanced nuclear technology. The third is climate goals, since the programme supports a clean, low-carbon energy transition. The booklet's April 2026 current affairs item focuses on the reactor at Kalpakkam, which is described in its own technical section. That section covers the reactor's type, its design features and the materials used in its core and cooling system. The booklet also gives the reactor's installed capacity, the agency that built it and the department that acts as its nodal agency. A separate three-stage table compares reactor types, fuels, coolants, moderators and breeding processes across the stages. The programme is presented as a tutorial item in the booklet, under the chapter Science and Technology, Defence and Space. Other entries in the same booklet cover India's regulatory bodies, its existing reactors and the laws that govern nuclear facilities.

Q1.

What does the abbreviation PHWR stand for? (full name)

Answer: _____

Q2.

Spent fuel from which stage's reactors does the PFBR recycle? (Roman numeral)

Answer: _____

Q3.

Which long-term property of nuclear waste does the PFBR reduce? (one word)

Answer: _____

Q4.

Which physical measure of nuclear waste does the PFBR reduce? (one word)

Answer: _____

Q5.

What does the PFBR recycle in order to reduce nuclear waste? (two words)

Answer: _____

Q6.

Complete the sentence: The PFBR ___ more fuel than it consumes. (one word)

Answer: _____

Q7.

In the booklet's comparison of the PFBR with PHWRs, which aspect of performance is compared? (two words)

Answer: _____

Submarine Building Programmes: TITA

The booklet presents India's submarine programme as a long-term effort. After the Kargil War, the Cabinet Committee on Security approved a 30-year Submarine Building Plan with the aim of building conventional submarines indigenously. The booklet describes Project 75 as Phase I of the Indian Navy's 30-year indigenous submarine construction plan. Under this project, diesel-electric attack submarines of the Kalvari class were being built at Mazagon Dock Limited, and the booklet records the commissioning of one of them. Two production lines were planned, using transfer of technology from different foreign manufacturers. The booklet also notes that private Indian firms take part alongside foreign manufacturers under the Make in India initiative in defence. The booklet also lists Mazagon Dock Shipbuilders Limited, together with Larsen & Toubro Limited, as shortlisted to partner with foreign submarine manufacturers. Mazagon Dock appears in this section both as a builder and as a shortlisted partner. The booklet says conventional diesel-electric

submarines of this type come with improved stealth features. The Project 75 entry is followed by a separate entry for the later project. The topic appears in the booklet's April 2026 current affairs section. The booklet's submarine section sits alongside a note on the Indian Navy's ships and its history. Its page on the navy also gives a short history of the force.

Q1.

In which year was Project 75I approved as Phase II?

Answer: _____

Q2.

How many hours must conventional diesel-electric submarines surface every time to be recharged? (hours)

Answer: _____

Q3.

What does the abbreviation AIP stand for?

Answer: _____

Q4.

Under which model is Project 75I the first project?

Answer: _____

Q5.

Daewoo Shipbuilding & Marine Engineering is a foreign OEM from which country?

Answer: _____

Q6.

Rosoboronexport is a foreign OEM from which country?

Answer: _____

Q7.

For how many weeks can the AIP-based project's submarines stay submerged? (weeks)

Answer: _____

Artemis Accords: Practice Quiz (TITA)

NASA's Artemis Programme is named after the Moon Goddess of Greek mythology. Its stated objective is to land humans on the Moon, including the first woman and the first person of colour to stand on the lunar surface. The programme is being carried out in stages. Orion has a crew module and a service module. Artemis II is a crewed mission in which astronauts will travel around the Moon and return to Earth without landing on it. Its crew of four includes the first Canadian and the first non-American to fly on a lunar mission. The mission is expected to last about ten days, following a free-return trajectory before the spacecraft splashes down in the Pacific Ocean. It will lift off from the Kennedy Space Center in Florida, USA. The programme depends on partnerships. The European Space Agency and the Canadian Space Agency are named as its international collaborators. The planned Lunar Gateway Station is meant to serve as a docking point for astronauts and to facilitate scientific research. Artemis III is the stage meant to return humans to the Moon. The Artemis Accords form part of the same international picture.

Q1.

In which year did India join the Artemis Accords? (year)

Answer: _____

Q2.

In which year is the Outer Space Treaty, which the Artemis Accords build upon, dated? (year)

Answer: _____

Q3.

In which year did NASA announce the Artemis Accords? (year)

Answer: _____

Q4.

Besides the US State Department and NASA, how many other founding members did the Artemis Accords have? (number)

Answer: _____

Q5.

Which two major space nations are not part of the Artemis Accords? (two names)

Answer: _____

Q6.

Are the Artemis Accords legally binding? (yes or no)

Answer: _____

Q7.

Apart from the Moon, which planet do the principles of the Artemis Accords cover? (one word)

Answer: _____

Chandrayaan Missions: Practice Quiz (TITA)

India's lunar exploration missions are known as the Chandrayaan series. Chandrayaan-1 was India's first lunar mission, and it mapped the surface of the Moon in unprecedented detail. Chandrayaan-4 is India's fourth mission to the Moon, and it follows the earlier missions in the series. Its planned work includes two launches, the development and realisation of its spacecraft, and external Deep Space Network support. Instruments from NASA and the European Space Agency will also be mounted on a rover of Chandrayaan-5, which is planned as a further lunar exploration mission. The Soviet Union was the first nation to land on the Moon, and the United States followed with the Apollo mission, which took place in 1969 and carried astronauts to the lunar surface. Neil Armstrong became the first person to step onto the Moon, and he was joined by Edwin 'Buzz' Aldrin. The United States is also the only country to have landed humans on the Moon. China's Chang'e mission also landed on the Moon. Odysseus was a lander developed in the United States that achieved the first soft lunar landing by a private company. It was the second private attempt to land on the Moon, after the failure of the Peregrine lander.

Q1.

In which year did the Soviet Union's Luna 9 make the first lunar landing? (year)

Answer: _____

Q2.

In which year did China's Chang'e mission land on the Moon? (year)

Answer: _____

Q3.

Which company developed the Odysseus lander? (company name)

Answer: _____

Q4.

Which launch vehicle was used for the Odysseus lander? (name)

Answer: _____

Q5.

Which Indian agency is handling the lander for the Chandrayaan-5 mission? (acronym)

Answer: _____

Q6.

What is the acronym for the Chandrayaan-5 mission, which is also called Lunar Polar Exploration? (acronym)

Answer: _____

Q7.

Which launch vehicle is listed for the two launches of the Chandrayaan-4 mission? (abbreviation)

Answer: _____

FIDE: Leadership and Recent Results

FIDE (Fédération Internationale des Échecs) is the International Chess Federation. It oversees major international competitions and sets the rules and rating standards that players follow. The federation is led by a President, with a Deputy President supporting its work.

Indian players have a long record in the sport. Viswanathan Anand is India's most successful chess player and has won the FIDE World Chess Championship in 2000, 2007, 2008, 2010 and 2012, a span of more than a decade. Koneru Humpy is India's highest-rated female chess player and has won the Women's World Rapid Chess Championship title.

In 2026, R. Vaishali won the FIDE Women's Candidates Tournament, and her win came in the final round of the event. She became the first Indian woman to claim its title. She will now challenge the reigning champion, Ju Wenjun, who currently holds the Women's World Chess Championship title, later in 2026.

Gukesh Dommaraju, India's youngest Grandmaster, became the youngest World Chess Champion after defeating Ding Liren in the FIDE World Chess Championship 2024. Divya Deshmukh won the FIDE Women's World Cup 2025, defeating Humpy Koneru in the final, and she became the third winner of that title after Alexandra Kosteniuk and Aleksandra Goryachkina.

Q1.

Who is the President of FIDE? (full name)

Answer: _____

Q2.

In which year was FIDE established in Paris? (year)

Answer: _____

Q3.

What is the headquarters city of FIDE? (city)

Answer: _____

Q4.

Which Russian player did R. Vaishali defeat in the final round of the Women's Candidates Tournament 2026 to clinch the title? (surname)

Answer: _____

Q5.

How many points did R. Vaishali finish with in the Women's Candidates Tournament 2026, out of 14 total? (number)

Answer: _____

Q6.

What does the FIDE motto 'Gens una Sumus' mean in English? (words)

Answer: _____

Q7.

On which date is International Chess Day observed each year? (day and month)

Answer: _____

Chess History and Indian Records

Chess has a long history, and the World Chess Championship is one of the major titles in the game. The first official champion was the player who defeated Johannes Zukertort in the early contest for the title. Magnus Carlsen is a former World No. 1 in the sport.

Indian players have had strong results in recent years. Viswanathan Anand, India's most successful chess player, has won the FIDE World Chess Championship in several years, with titles spanning more than a decade. Koneru Humpy is India's highest-rated female chess player, and she has won the Women's World Rapid Chess Championship title.

Divya Deshmukh won the FIDE Women's World Cup 2025 in Georgia, defeating Humpy Koneru in the final. She became the third winner of that title, after Alexandra Kosteniuk and Aleksandra Goryachkina.

In 2026, R. Vaishali won the FIDE Women's Candidates Tournament and became the first Indian woman to claim its title. She clinched the title by defeating Kateryna Lagno of Russia in the final round. Vaishali will challenge Ju Wenjun, the reigning champion from China, for the Women's World Chess Championship later in 2026.

Gukesh Dommaraju, India's youngest Grandmaster, became the youngest World Chess Champion after defeating Ding Liren of China.

Q1.

Under which empire did chess originate in Northern India as 'Chaturanga'? (name)

Answer: _____

Q2.

In which year was the World Chess Championship established? (year)

Answer: _____

Q3.

Which Indian city hosted the Chess World Cup in 2002, before the 2025 edition in Goa? (city)

Answer: _____

Q4.

Who was the first official World Chess Champion, after defeating Johannes Zukertort? (surname)

Answer: _____

Q5.

Who won the Chess World Cup 2025 held in Goa? (surname)

Answer: _____

Q6.

In which tournament did Gukesh Dommaraju secure his first classical chess win over Magnus Carlsen? (tournament name with year)

Answer: _____

Q7.

How old was Anish Sarkar when he became the youngest chess player ever ranked by FIDE? (age in years)

Answer: _____

Schemes and Rural Roads: Typed Answer Practice

The Pradhan Mantri Gram Sadak Yojana is a centrally sponsored scheme whose objective is to provide all-weather road connectivity to rural habitations. Its third phase has been extended by the Union Cabinet for a further period, and funding is shared between the Centre and the states in fixed proportions, with the North-Eastern and Himalayan states receiving a higher central share. Implementation takes place through state-level agencies, supported by a central agency. The Namo Drone Didi Yojana aims to empower rural women by providing agricultural drones for crop spraying and precision farming. Drones are distributed to self-help groups, and the cost is met partly through a subsidy and partly through loans. The nodal authority for the drone scheme is the Department of Agriculture and Farmers Welfare. The remaining share of the cost comes through loans under the Agriculture Infrastructure Fund, and Karnataka has been named a top performer under the drone scheme. The PM Internship Scheme is open to candidates within a set age range, and it offers placements at large companies. It has been expanded to include final-year students. Insurance cover under two national life and accident schemes is also part of the internship package. Eligibility rules, including family income and government employment, decide who can apply.

Q1.

In which year was the Pradhan Mantri Gram Sadak Yojana launched?

Answer: _____

Q2.

Till which year has PMGSY-III been extended? (give the year)

Answer: _____

Q3.

What is the target number of drones for SHGs under the Namo Drone Didi Yojana? (number)

Answer: _____

Q4.

What is the upper age limit (in years) for the PM Internship Scheme?

Answer: _____

Q5.

What is the full name of the central agency that implements PMGSY?

Answer: _____

Q6.

The 2026 amendment amends the Andhra Pradesh Reorganisation Act of which year? (year)

Answer: _____

Q7.

In which year was the Prevention of Atrocities Act enacted? (year)

Answer: _____

Economy and Climate: Typed Answer Practice

Economic rankings depend on how an economy's output is valued. Countries are compared by nominal GDP in dollar terms, so the figures move with the exchange rate. When the domestic currency weakens, the same output is worth fewer dollars. Separately, the government uses a

special duty on petroleum products that is revised regularly, and its revenue is not divided with states the way GST revenue is. States therefore receive no share of that revenue, which goes to the Central Government. On the climate side, countries prepare national climate plans under the Paris framework, which are reported and updated over time. Such plans are not legally binding, but reporting is mandatory. The host of the annual UN climate conference is chosen through a rotation among regional groups. Finally, the use of synthetic gases in cooling and foam is being restricted under an international agreement aimed at reducing global warming. The ranking figures are therefore sensitive to currency movements and to statistical revisions. A fall in rank does not by itself signal an economic slowdown. India remains among the fastest-growing major economies.

Q1.

By what percentage (per cent) does NDC 3.0 aim to cut emission intensity from 2005 levels?

Answer: _____

Q2.

In which year was the Kigali Amendment adopted?

Answer: _____

Q3.

In which year did India ratify the Kigali Amendment?

Answer: _____

Q4.

In which city did India host COP8 in 2002?

Answer: _____

Q5.

In which year was the Central Excise Act, to which SAED is linked, enacted? (year)

Answer: _____

Q6.

Which company leads the first semiconductor fabrication SEZ at Dholera? (name)

Answer: _____

Q7.

Under the Kigali Amendment, from which year is HFC consumption to be frozen for India? (year)

Answer: _____

Sikh History and Reformers: Typed Answer Practice

Historical episodes in India are often remembered through anniversaries and observances. Sikh history is shaped by a line of Gurus whose teachings and institutions developed the community over more than two centuries. The first of them is regarded as the founder of the faith, while later Gurus built towns, established shared meals for visitors and oversaw the creation of sacred texts. A military campaign in the early sixteenth century is also part of this history. The invader who fought near Panipat had earlier held territory in Central Asia, and the battle is remembered as a turning point in medieval India. The battle is also linked to the later Mughal empire in India, and Panipat is in present-day Haryana. Reformers of the nineteenth and twentieth centuries also left a lasting mark. One opened a school for girls in Pune with his wife, while another campaigned against caste discrimination and later helped draft the Constitution. A young revolutionary generation is remembered too, including men who were executed in a Lahore jail in the 1930s and are honoured every year. Such figures are honoured on national days, with tributes from national leaders. The events and figures in this section show how faith, war and social reform shaped modern India.

Q1.

At what age (in years) did Babur seize Kabul in 1504?

Answer: _____

Q2.

In which year did Guru Gobind Singh found the Khalsa? (year)

Answer: _____

Q3.

In which year did Guru Arjun Dev compose the Adi Granth? (year)

Answer: _____

Q4.

In which year was the first indigenous girls' school in Pune, set up by the Phules, established? (year)

Answer: _____

Q5.

In which year did Dr B. R. Ambedkar convert to Buddhism? (year)

Answer: _____

Q6.

On which date is Shaheed Diwas observed? (day and month)

Answer: _____

Q7.

Which Sikh Guru founded Anandpur Sahib? (name)

Answer: _____

RBI Liquidity and Cyber Frauds

The Reserve Bank of India uses Variable Rate Repo auctions as a liquidity injection tool under its Liquidity Management Framework. The tool is meant for temporary liquidity shortages in the banking system. The RBI used it to ensure stability at the end of the year. Banks borrow short-term funds from the RBI, and the funds are provided through auction-based repos rather than fixed rates. Financial crime and cyber fraud are handled by specialised bodies. The Financial Intelligence Unit - India was established in 2004, and it collects and analyses suspicious financial transaction reports. It shares intelligence with law enforcement agencies and has signed an MoU with the Indian Cyber Crime Coordination Centre to combat rising cyber-financial frauds. The Indian Cyber Crime Coordination Centre serves as the central agency for cybercrime coordination in India, and it operates under the Ministry of Home Affairs. Cross-border cooperation is handled by the GlobE Network, which was formally launched in 2021. It is designed to facilitate swift cooperation among law enforcement agencies and to recover illicit assets, and it aims to combat transnational corruption.

Q1.

How much liquidity did the RBI infuse through VRR auctions for year-end banking stability? (in lakh crore)

Answer: _____

Q2.

What is the maximum duration, in days, of VRR funds? (number)

Answer: _____

Q3.

What is the nodal ministry of FIU-India? (name)

Answer: _____

Q4.

In which year was the Indian Cyber Crime Coordination Centre established under the Ministry of Home Affairs? (year)

Answer: _____

Q5.

In which year did Saudi Arabia hold the G20 Presidency whose Riyadh Initiative led to the Globe Network concept? (year)

Answer: _____

Q6.

What type of securities do banks provide as collateral to borrow from the RBI under VRR? (type)

Answer: _____

Health Cooperation and Subject Rankings

The booklet's health and nutrition block covers nutrition policy, BRICS health cooperation and higher-education rankings. A 15-day nationwide campaign aims to drive behavioural change and improve nutritional outcomes for women and children, and it is one of the nutrition measures in the block. Mission POSHAN 2.0 is also part of the nutrition agenda. Traditional medicine is part of the health agenda, and the booklet describes the promotion of traditional, complementary and integrative medicine. A BRICS Mental Health and Wellness Initiative aims to strengthen mental healthcare systems, raise awareness and reduce stigma. The BRICS Health Working Group is also part of this cooperation. In higher education, the booklet reports on subject-wise global rankings. These rankings consider academic and employer reputation, citations per paper, the H-Index and an international research network. Engineering and technology is one of the subject areas in these rankings. Indian institutions have also shown a shift beyond the long-standing dominance of STEM subjects, which the booklet reads as a new trend.

Q1.

In which year was Mission POSHAN 2.0 launched? (year)

Answer: _____

Q2.

In which city did India host the BRICS Health Working Group meeting? (city)

Answer: _____

Q3.

Which institute leads India in Engineering and Technology in the QS subject rankings? (name)

Answer: _____

Q4.

Which Indian institute entered the Global Top 100 in the QS World University Rankings by Subject 2026? (name)

Answer: _____

Q5.

What type of diseases does the BRICS Mission for Healthy Lifestyles focus on preventing? (phrase)

Answer: _____

Q6.

In which subject area did Indian institutions enter the QS rankings for the first time? (one word)

Answer: _____